



Test Release Support Document

2024

Grade 3 Mathematics and Reading
Grade 6 Mathematics and Reading
Grade 8 Science
Grade 10 Reading
Algebra 1 and Civics EOCs
Writing Prompts

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Introduction

[Section 1008.22\(8\)](#), Florida Statutes (F.S.), requires the Department to publish each statewide, standardized assessment administered, excluding retakes, at least once on a triennial basis, with the initial publication occurring after the Spring 2024 test administration. The initial publication of assessments must include, at a minimum, the grade 3 Mathematics and English Language Arts (ELA) Reading assessments, the grade 10 ELA Reading assessment and the Algebra 1 End-of-Course (EOC) Assessment. Per statute, released content must have appeared on tests in the administration year immediately preceding release. Based on those requirements, below is a proposed timeline for the release of operational tests beginning with the 2023–24 school year.

June 2024	June 2025	June 2026
Grade 3 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 5 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 4 Mathematics & ELA Reading
Grade 6 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 8 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 7 Mathematics & ELA Reading
Grade 8 Science	Grade 5 Science	Biology 1 EOC
Grade 10 ELA Reading	Grade 9 ELA Reading	
Algebra 1 EOC	Geometry EOC	
Civics EOC	U.S. History EOC	
Annually: Grades 4–10 Writing prompts and individual student responses		

The purpose of the released tests is to promote transparency in the statewide, standardized assessment program and to increase the comfort level of students and parents with the state assessments. Students, parents, and teachers should use the released tests to better understand the types of items on Florida’s K–12 statewide assessments.

Each released test will include content that represents an operational test blueprint for each respective assessment. The released tests can also be used to illustrate the length of an operational test and the difficulty of the questions on that test.

Each released test will include an answer key, the percentage of students that answered that item correctly, the reporting category that the item fits in, and the item benchmark information.

For more information about K–12 assessments, please visit <https://www.fldoe.org/accountability/assessments/k-12-student-assessment/>.

For questions related to this document or released tests in general, please contact Assessment@fldoe.org.



Grade 3 FAST Mathematics

Test Release: 2024

1. Anya has 12 grams of salt. She needs a total of 48 grams of salt to perform a science experiment.

How many more grams of salt does Anya need?

- Ⓐ 4
- Ⓑ 26
- Ⓒ 36
- Ⓓ 60

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Measurement, and Data Analysis and Probability

Benchmark: MA.3.M.1.2

Benchmark Description: Solve real-world problems involving any of the four operations with whole-number lengths, masses, weights, temperatures or liquid volumes.

2. An expression is given.

$$5 \times 3 \times 4$$

Complete the sentence to describe how to find the value of the expression.

First multiply [☒ A] 3 and 4 [☐ B] 3 and 5 [☐ C] 4 and 5], and then multiply the result by [☐ A] 3 [☐ B] 4 [☒ C] 5] to find a product of [☐ A] 19 [☐ B] 30 [☐ C] 49 [☒ D] 60].

Answer Key: A, C, D, the combinations of B, B, D and C, A, D are also accepted

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Multiplicative Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.AR.1.1

Benchmark Description: Apply the distributive property to multiply a one-digit number and two-digit number. Apply properties of multiplication to find a product of one-digit whole numbers.

3. Amari runs from 3:40 p.m. to 4:02 p.m. Tom runs twice the amount of time that Amari runs.

How long does Tom run?

- Ⓐ 22 minutes
- Ⓑ 38 minutes
- Ⓒ 44 minutes
- Ⓓ 1 hour and 2 minutes

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 40%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Measurement, and Data Analysis and Probability

Benchmark: MA.3.M.2.2

Benchmark Description: Solve one- and two-step real-world problems involving elapsed time.

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4. An expression is shown.

$$4,058 - 3,990$$

What is the value of the expression?

68

←

→

↶

↷

✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
0	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$	

Answer Key: 68, or any equivalent value

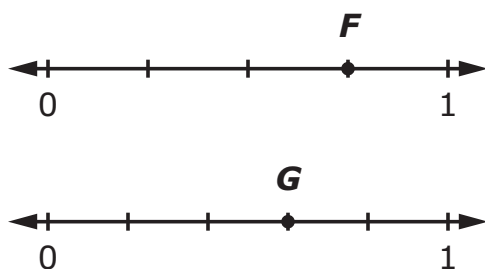
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 39%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Additive Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.NSO.2.1

Benchmark Description: Add and subtract multi-digit whole numbers including using a standard algorithm with procedural fluency.

5. Points F and G are shown on number lines.



Which statement correctly compares the values of points F and G ?

- Ⓐ point $G =$ point F
- Ⓑ point $F <$ point G
- Ⓒ point $G >$ point F
- Ⓓ point $F >$ point G

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

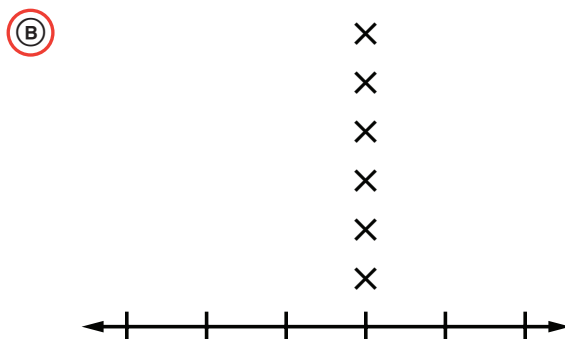
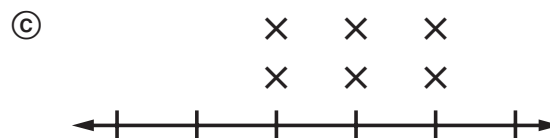
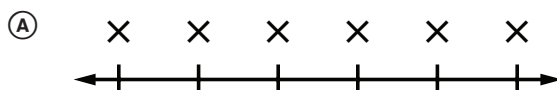
Reporting Category: Fractional Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.FR.2.1

Benchmark Description: Plot, order and compare fractional numbers with the same numerator or the same denominator.

6. Lilli measures 6 objects. Each object has the same length.

Which line plot could represent Lilli's data?



Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 31%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Measurement, and Data Analysis and Probability

Benchmark: MA.3.DP.1.1

Benchmark Description: Collect and represent numerical and categorical data with whole-number values using tables, scaled pictographs, scaled bar graphs or line plots. Use appropriate titles, labels and units.

7. What is the word form of the fraction $\frac{7}{10}$?

- Ⓐ seven tens
- Ⓑ ten sevens
- Ⓒ seven-tenths
- Ⓓ ten-sevenths

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 66%

Reporting Category: Fractional Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.FR.1.3

Benchmark Description: Read and write fractions, including fractions greater than one, using standard form, numeral-word form and word form.

8. What value is 984 rounded to the nearest ten?

- Ⓐ 970
- Ⓑ 980
- Ⓒ 990
- Ⓓ 1,000

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Additive Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.NSO.1.4

Benchmark Description: Round whole numbers from 0 to 1,000 to the nearest 10 or 100.

9. Select all the multiples of 7.

Ⓐ 18

Ⓑ 23

Ⓒ 28

Ⓓ 35

Ⓔ 38

Answer Key: C, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 69%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Multiplicative Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.AR.3.2

Benchmark Description: Determine whether a whole number from 1 to 144 is a multiple of a given one-digit number.

- 10.** The weight of 1 bag of flour is 5 pounds.

What is the total weight, in pounds, of 3 bags of flour?

A digital math input interface. At the top, a rectangular box displays the number 15 in red. Below this box is a toolbar with five circular icons: a left arrow, a right arrow, a circular arrow (undo), a curved arrow (redo), and a square with an 'X' (clear). Below the toolbar is a numeric keypad with buttons for digits 1 through 9, 0, and a fraction template icon (represented by a horizontal line with a small square above and below it). The keypad is arranged in four rows: the first row has 1, 2, 3; the second row has 4, 5, 6; the third row has 7, 8, 9; and the fourth row has 0 and the fraction icon.

Answer Key: 15, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 73%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Measurement, and Data Analysis and Probability

Benchmark: MA.3.M.1.2

Benchmark Description: Solve real-world problems involving any of the four operations with whole-number lengths, masses, weights, temperatures or liquid volumes.

11. Order the numbers from greatest to least.

	Greatest	Middle	Least
2,732	Ⓐ	Ⓑ	Ⓒ
2,853	Ⓓ	Ⓔ	Ⓕ
2,728	Ⓖ	Ⓗ	Ⓘ

Answer Key: B, D, I

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 82%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Additive Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.NSO.1.3

Benchmark Description: Plot, order and compare whole numbers up to 10,000.

- 12.** Elsa has a fraction. When she adds the fraction to itself 7 times, the sum is $\frac{7}{8}$.

What is the fraction that Elsa adds?

The interface shows a digital fraction input tool. The top display area contains the fraction $\frac{1}{8}$ in red. Below the display is a toolbar with five icons: a left arrow, a right arrow, an undo button (curved arrow), a redo button (curved arrow), and a clear button (X). Below the toolbar is a grid of buttons for digits 1 through 9, 0, and a fraction template icon (a box with a horizontal line and two smaller boxes above and below).

Answer Key: $\frac{1}{8}$, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 30%

Reporting Category: Fractional Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.FR.1.2

Benchmark Description: Represent and interpret fractions, including fractions greater than one, in the form of m/n as the result of adding the unit fraction $1/n$ to itself m times.

13. Select the place value of each digit in 4,572 to create an expression that represents its value.

- 4 [☐ A tens ☐ B ones
☐ C hundreds ☒ D thousands] +5 [☐ A tens ☐ B ones
☒ C hundreds ☐ D thousands]
- +7 [☒ A tens ☐ B ones
☐ C hundreds ☐ D thousands] +2 [☐ A tens ☒ B ones
☐ C hundreds ☐ D thousands]

Answer Key: D, C, A, B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 90%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Additive Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.NSO.1.2

Benchmark Description: Compose and decompose four-digit numbers in multiple ways using thousands, hundreds, tens and ones. Demonstrate each composition or decomposition using objects, drawings and expressions or equations.

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14. Ben has 6 bags of blocks. Each bag has 6 blocks.

Ben uses all the blocks to make 4 equal stacks.

How many blocks are in each stack?

9

←

→

↶

↷

✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
0	$\frac{\square}{\square}$	

Answer Key: 9, or any equivalent value

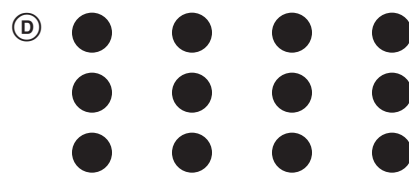
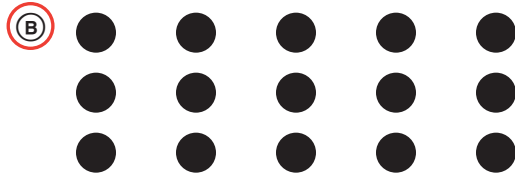
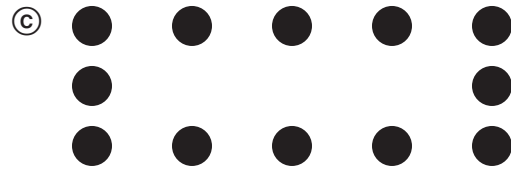
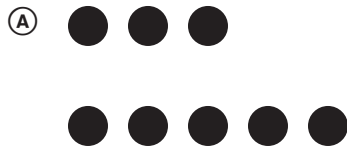
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 31%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Additive Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.AR.1.2

Benchmark Description: Solve one- and two-step real-world problems involving any of four operations with whole numbers.

15. Which array models 3×5 ?



Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 87%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Multiplicative Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.NSO.2.2

Benchmark Description: Explore multiplication of two whole numbers with products from 0 to 144, and related division facts.

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16. Match each fraction to an equivalent expression.

	$\frac{1}{4} + \frac{1}{4}$	$\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{2}{6} + \frac{2}{6}$	$\frac{1}{12} + \frac{1}{12} + \frac{1}{12} + \frac{1}{12}$
$\frac{2}{4}$	(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)
$\frac{4}{12}$	(E)	(F)	(G)	(H)

Answer Key: A, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Fractional Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.FR.1.2

Benchmark Description: Represent and interpret fractions, including fractions greater than one, in the form of m/n as the result of adding the unit fraction $1/n$ to itself m times.

17. An equation with a missing value is shown.

$$30 \div 5 = \square$$

Which equation can be used to find the missing value?

- Ⓐ $5 \times 5 = \square$
- Ⓑ $30 \times 5 = \square$
- Ⓒ $5 \times \square = 30$
- Ⓓ $30 \times \square = 5$

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 81%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Multiplicative Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.AR.2.1

Benchmark Description: Restate a division problem as a missing factor problem using the relationship between multiplication and division.

18. Arvin leaves his house at 7:17 a.m.

He arrives at his friend's house at 7:28 a.m.

How many total minutes does it take Arvin to get to his friend's house?

11

←

→

↶

↷

✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
0	$\frac{\square}{\square}$	

Answer Key: 11, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 72%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Measurement, and Data Analysis and Probability

Benchmark: MA.3.M.2.2

Benchmark Description: Solve one- and two-step real-world problems involving elapsed time.

19. Select all the odd numbers.

☐ (A) 14

☒ (B) 41

☒ (C) 235

☐ (D) 312

☒ (E) 463

Answer Key: B, C, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 64%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Additive Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.AR.3.1

Benchmark Description: Determine and explain whether a whole number from 1 to 1,000 is even or odd.

20. An equation is shown.

$$48 \div 4 = 4 \times 3$$

Complete the sentences describing the equation.

The left side of the equation has a value of [☐ A 4 ☒ B 12 ☐ C 16 ☐ D 24].

The right side of the equation has a value of [☐ A 3 ☐ B 7 ☒ C 12 ☐ D 16].

Therefore, the equation is [☒ A true ☐ B false].

Answer Key: B, C, A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 56%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Multiplicative Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.AR.2.2

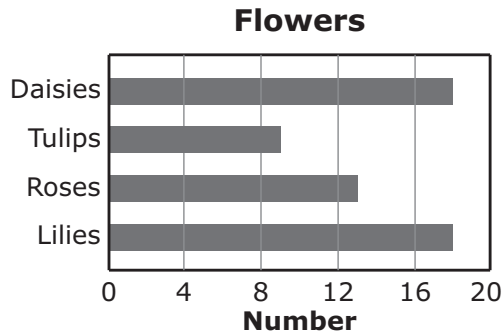
Benchmark Description: Determine and explain whether an equation involving multiplication or division is true or false.

21. The numbers of flowers in a garden are shown in the table.

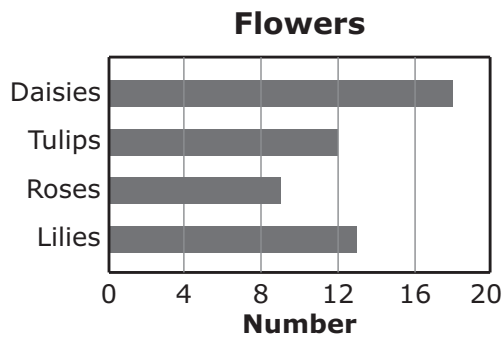
	Daisies	Tulips	Roses	Lilies
Number of Flowers	18	9	13	12

Which bar graph represents the data in the table?

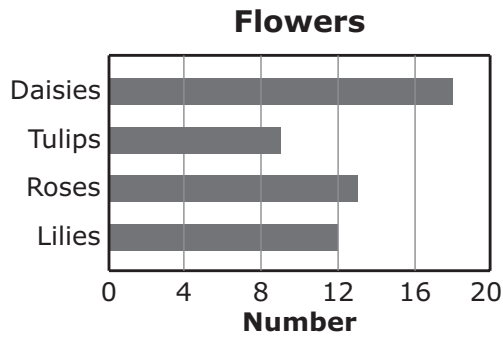
(A)



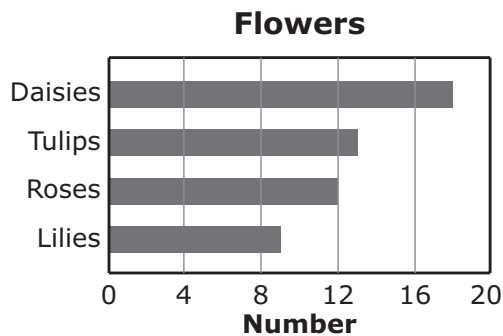
(B)



(C)



(D)



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Answer Key: C

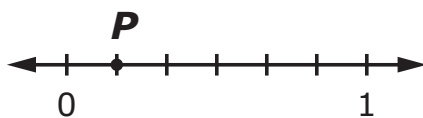
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 80%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Measurement, and Data Analysis and Probability

Benchmark: MA.3.DP.1.1

Benchmark Description: Collect and represent numerical and categorical data with whole-number values using tables, scaled pictographs, scaled bar graphs or line plots. Use appropriate titles, labels and units.

22. A number line from 0 to 1 is shown.



What value does point *P* represent?

(A) $\frac{1}{7}$

(B) $\frac{1}{6}$

(C) $\frac{1}{5}$

(D) $\frac{1}{4}$

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Fractional Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.FR.1.1

Benchmark Description: Represent and interpret unit fractions in the form $\frac{1}{n}$ as the quantity formed by one part when a whole is partitioned into n equal parts.

23. An equation with a missing number is shown.

$$2 \times 8 \times 4 = 2 \times \square \times 8$$

What is the value of the missing number?

4

←

→

↶

↷

✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
0	$\frac{\square}{\square}$	

Answer Key: 4, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 81%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Multiplicative Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.AR.1.1

Benchmark Description: Apply the distributive property to multiply a one-digit number and two-digit number. Apply properties of multiplication to find a product of one-digit whole numbers.

24. Which number between 10 and 15 is a multiple of 4?

12

← → ↶ ↷ ✖

1	2	3	
4	5	6	
7	8	9	
0	$\frac{\square}{\square}$		

Answer Key: 12, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Multiplicative Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.AR.3.2

Benchmark Description: Determine whether a whole number from 1 to 144 is a multiple of a given one-digit number.

25. What is the numeral-word form of $\frac{7}{5}$?

- Ⓐ 7 fives
- Ⓑ 7 fifths
- Ⓒ 5 sevens
- Ⓓ 5 sevenths

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 82%

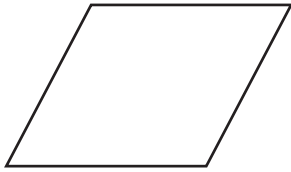
Reporting Category: Fractional Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.FR.1.3

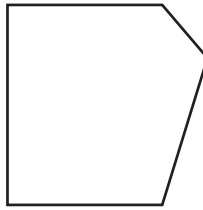
Benchmark Description: Read and write fractions, including fractions greater than one, using standard form, numeral-word form and word form.

26. Which shape is a trapezoid that has exactly one pair of parallel sides?

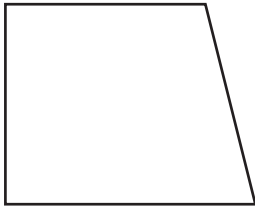
(A)



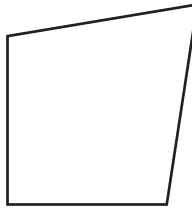
(C)



(B)



(D)



Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 34%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Measurement, and Data Analysis and Probability

Benchmark: MA.3.GR.1.2

Benchmark Description: Identify and draw quadrilaterals based on their defining attributes. Quadrilaterals include parallelograms, rhombi, rectangles, squares and trapezoids.

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27. Match each number written in expanded form with its value.

	4,602	4,620	4,062
$4,000 + 60 + 2$	(A)	(B)	(C)
$4,000 + 600 + 2$	(D)	(E)	(F)
$4,000 + 600 + 20$	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: C, D, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 72%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Additive Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.NSO.1.1

Benchmark Description: Read and write numbers from 0 to 10,000 using standard form, expanded form and word form.

28. What fraction of the figure is shaded?



$\frac{1}{4}$

←
→
↶
↷
✕

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
0	$\frac{\square}{\square}$	

Answer Key: $\frac{1}{4}$, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 83%

Reporting Category: Fractional Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.FR.1.1

Benchmark Description: Represent and interpret unit fractions in the form $\frac{1}{n}$ as the quantity formed by one part when a whole is partitioned into n equal parts.

29. What is 5 thousands + 4 tens written in standard form?

5040

←

→

↶

↷

✕

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
0	$\frac{\square}{\square}$	

Answer Key: 5,040 or any equivalent value

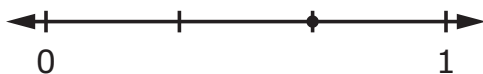
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 67%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Additive Reasoning

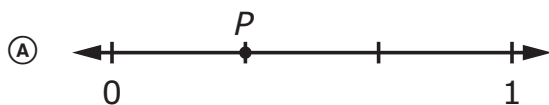
Benchmark: MA.3.NSO.1.2

Benchmark Description: Compose and decompose four-digit numbers in multiple ways using thousands, hundreds, tens and ones. Demonstrate each composition or decomposition using objects, drawings and expressions or equations.

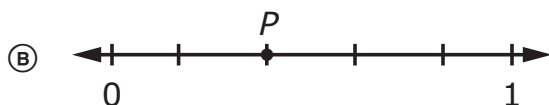
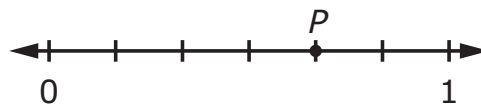
- 30.** A number line with a point that represents $\frac{2}{3}$ is shown.



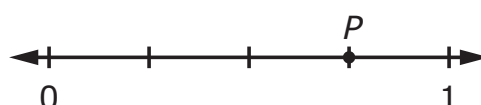
Which point represents a fraction that is equivalent to $\frac{2}{3}$?



(C)



(D)



Answer Key: C

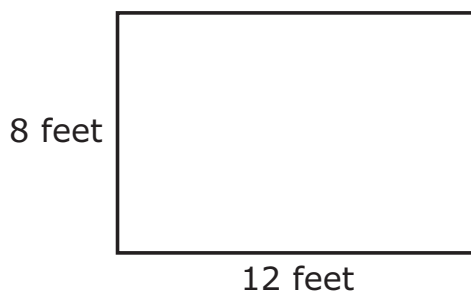
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 39%

Reporting Category: Fractional Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.FR.2.2

Benchmark Description: Identify equivalent fractions and explain why they are equivalent.

31. A model of a rectangular rug is shown, with measurements in feet.



What is the area, in square feet, of the rug?

96

←
→
↶
↷
✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
0	$\frac{\square}{\square}$	

Answer Key: 96, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Measurement, and Data Analysis and Probability

Benchmark: MA.3.GR.2.3

Benchmark Description: Solve mathematical and real-world problems involving the perimeter and area of rectangles with whole-number side lengths using a visual model and a formula.

32. Select all the expressions that equal 36.

- ☒ (A) 4×9
- ☒ (B) 6×6
- ☐ (C) 9×3
- ☐ (D) 6×9
- ☒ (E) 3×12

Answer Key: A, B, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

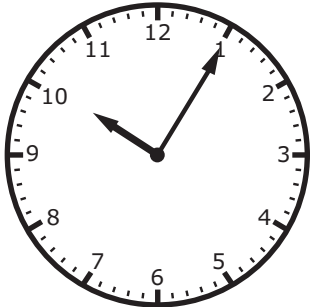
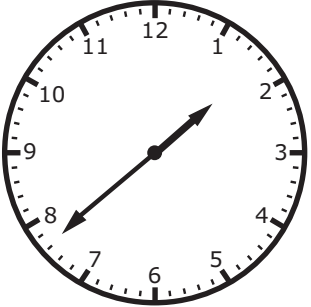
Reporting Category: Number Sense and Multiplicative Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.NSO.2.4

Benchmark Description: Multiply two whole numbers from 0 to 12 and divide using related facts with procedural reliability.

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33. Match each analog clock to the digital clock that shows the same time.

	1:38	1:50	7:08	10:05
	(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)
	(E)	(F)	(G)	(H)

Answer Key: D, E

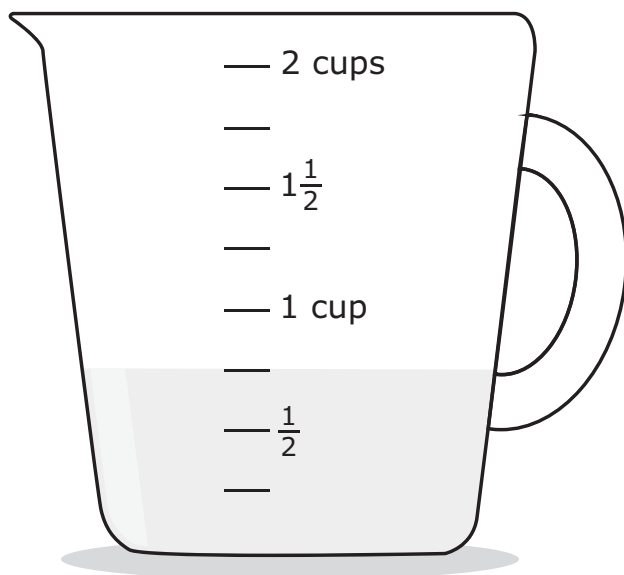
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Measurement, and Data Analysis and Probability

Benchmark: MA.3.M.2.1

Benchmark Description: Using analog and digital clocks tell and write time to the nearest minute using a.m. and p.m. appropriately.

34. A liquid measuring cup with water is shown.



What is the volume of water, in cups, in the measuring cup?

$\frac{3}{4}$

←
→
↶
↷
✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
0	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$	

Answer Key: $\frac{3}{4}$, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 21%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Measurement, and Data Analysis and Probability

Benchmark: MA.3.M.1.1

Benchmark Description: Select and use appropriate tools to measure the length of an object, the volume of liquid within a beaker and temperature.

35. The first three numbers in a number pattern are 24, 12, and 6.

What would be the fourth number in the pattern?

- Ⓐ 0
- Ⓑ 2
- Ⓒ 3
- Ⓓ 4

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Additive Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.3.AR.3.3

Benchmark Description: Identify, create and extend numerical patterns.



Grade 3 FAST ELA Reading

Test Release: 2024

from **Flight**

by Robert Burleigh

Permissions were not secured for the use of this passage on a public website. For your reference, the citation for the passage and for items 1, 2, 5, and 6 is as follows: Robert Burleigh, *Flight* (New York: Philomel Books, 1991), 8-28.

1. Read this paragraph from the passage.

56 He quickly unfolds a map across his knees.

What does the prefix *un-* in the word unfolds show about Lindbergh's actions?

- Ⓐ that he opens the map
- Ⓑ that he holds tightly to the map
- Ⓒ that he finds where he is on the map
- Ⓓ that he makes enough room for the map

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Identify and apply knowledge of common Greek and Latin roots, base words, and affixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words in grade-level content.

2. Read these paragraphs from the passage.

47 He spies a seagull.

48 Then fishing boats. Something quickens in Lindbergh's blood.

Why does the author include these paragraphs in the passage?

- Ⓐ to describe what is making Lindbergh sick
- Ⓑ to explain how Lindbergh is feeling as he nears land
- Ⓒ to give an example of the different ways to get to Paris
- Ⓓ to compare traveling to Paris with other kinds of activities

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 53%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the development of an author's purpose in an informational text.

3. What specific idea does the title help suggest?

- Ⓐ The passage will be about what pilots do before a flight.
- Ⓑ The passage will be about how flights have changed over time.
- Ⓒ The passage will be about what a pilot experiences on a certain flight.
- Ⓓ The passage will be about how flights have prepared people for other types of travel.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how text features contribute to meaning and identify the text structures of chronology, comparison, and cause/effect in texts.

4. What is the overall text structure in the passage?

- Ⓐ chronology
- Ⓑ comparison
- Ⓒ cause and effect
- Ⓓ problem and solution

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 40%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how text features contribute to meaning and identify the text structures of chronology, comparison, and cause/effect in texts.

5. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which claim does the author support about Lindbergh?

- Ⓐ He fits best in small planes.
- Ⓑ He begins to feel lonely on his flight.
- Ⓒ He wants people to give him a nickname.
- Ⓓ He needs more time to prepare for his flight.

Part B

Which detail from the passage supports the claim in Part A?

- Ⓐ “Lindbergh is nearly as tall as the plane itself.” (paragraph 8)
- Ⓑ “And yet—he is about to attempt what no one has done before:” (paragraph 9)
- Ⓒ “The day comes on, brighter and warmer.” (paragraph 41)
- Ⓓ “He hopes for a word. He longs for a wave,” (paragraph 51)

Answer Key: Part A: B and Part B: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 23%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Identify an author’s claim and explain how an author uses evidence to support the claim.

6. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which sentence is a central idea of the passage?

- Ⓐ Pilots receive support from people.
- Ⓑ Lindbergh has doubts about flying.
- Ⓒ Lindbergh makes his dream come true.
- Ⓓ Airplanes have greatly improved since the first flights.

Part B

Which moment from the passage supports the central idea in Part A?

- Ⓐ "He clicks on the engine. He listens as it catches, gurgles, and roars." (paragraph 15)
- Ⓑ "Sometimes he imagines he sees land. No: it is only the flickering shapes of the clouds." (paragraphs 42–43)
- Ⓒ "He guides the *Spirit of St. Louis* carefully down and down, to just above a boat." (paragraph 49)
- Ⓓ "I am here, I am here. A great joy wells up inside him." (paragraphs 70–71)

Answer Key: Part A: C and Part B: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 43%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Identify the central idea and explain how relevant details support that idea in a text.

7. What does the word huddled mean as it is used in paragraph 73?

- Ⓐ curled up
- Ⓑ tried moving
- Ⓒ traveled safely
- Ⓓ crowded together

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Use context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the meaning of multiple-meaning and unknown words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

8. Select **two** details that should be included in a summary of the passage.

- Ⓐ Charles Lindbergh flies over the coast of Ireland.
- Ⓑ Charles Lindbergh starts his flight while it is raining.
- Ⓒ Charles Lindbergh flies an airplane from New York to Paris.
- Ⓓ Charles Lindbergh can see cows and boats from his airplane.
- Ⓔ Charles Lindbergh plans to fly for more than a day without stopping.

Answer Key: C, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.2b

Benchmark Description: Include the central idea and relevant details for an informational text.

Passage 1: A Yummy Invention

by Tracy Vonder Brink

- 1 Oops! Frank Epperson forgot to bring his cup inside. He'd made a fruity drink by mixing a flavored powder and water together, but he left it on the porch overnight. The cup had his drink and the mixing stick still inside it.
- 2 The night was freezing cold. The next morning, Frank went outside and saw his cup. His drink had frozen. He pulled on the mixing stick. The frozen drink came out of the cup. It looked like a big, fruity icicle on a stick. Would it taste good? He licked the flavored ice. Yum!
- 3 Frank never forgot the icy treat he'd invented back in 1905, when he was 11 years old. When he grew up and had kids of his own, he made ice pops for them. Then he wondered . . . could he sell his dessert?
- 4 Frank took his ice pops to an amusement park. Everyone loved what he'd made! At first, he called his invention the Epsicle, because his last name was Epperson. But his kids didn't like the sound of that. They called their dad "Pop," so they came up with a different name, the Popsicle.
- 5 Popsicles were a hit! Frank made new flavors. People loved those too. Then a big company bought Frank's recipe. They made more and more Popsicles.
- 6 Today you can buy Popsicles on one stick or on two. They come in many fruit flavors and even in chocolate.

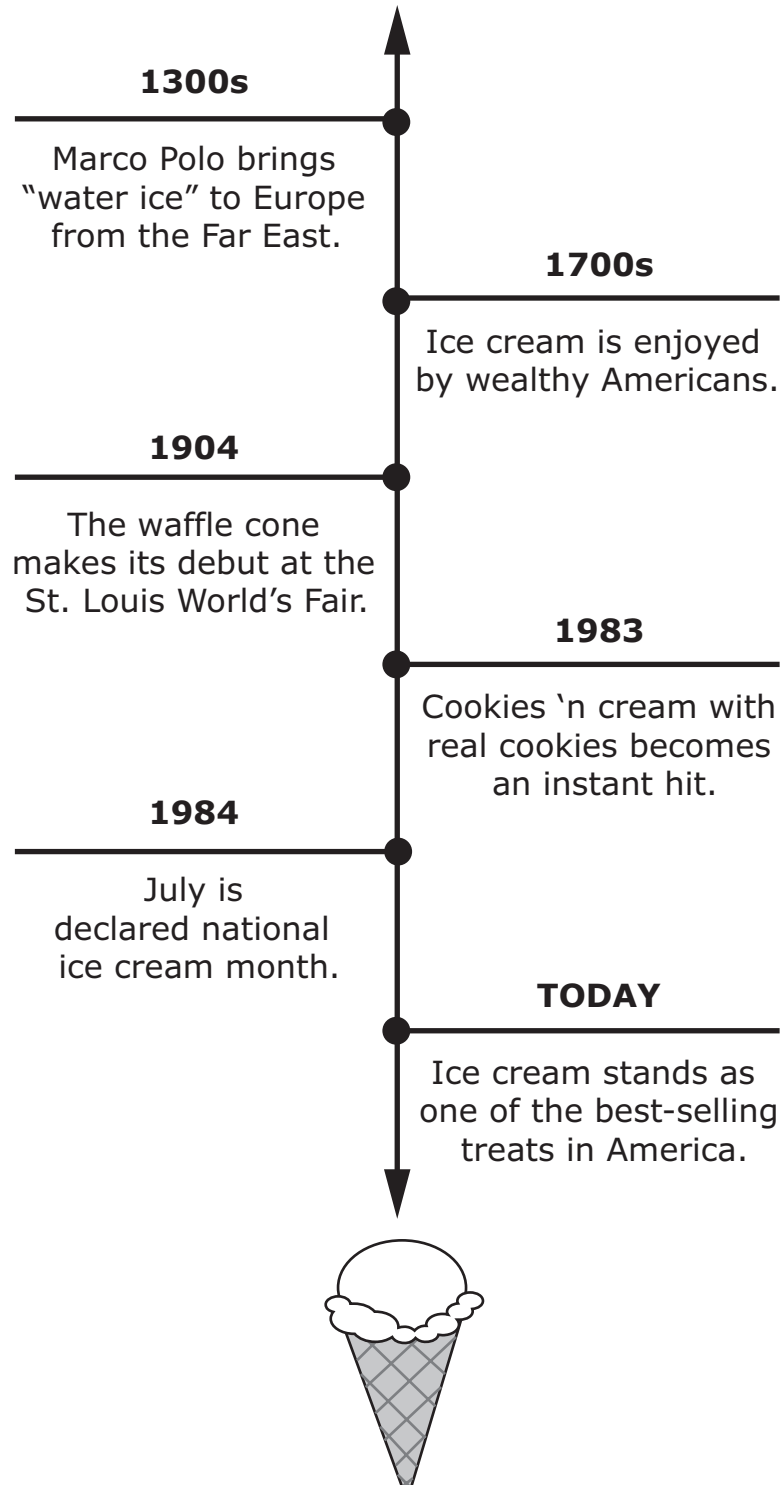
"A Yummy Invention" by Tracy Vonder Brink. Copyright © 2019 by Click Magazine. Reprinted by permission of Cricket Media, Inc., via Copyright Clearance Center.

Passage 2: Who Invented the Ice Cream Cone?

by Laurel Plausini

- 7 People all across America enjoy ice cream cones. They are an excellent way to enjoy a scoop or two of your favorite ice cream on a hot day.
- 8 But who invented this delicious treat?
- 9 No one knows for sure. Ice cream shops in Italy are said to have sold something similar to cones as far back as 1807. An ice cream maker in New York City is said to have made an edible cup for ice cream in 1903.
- 10 But the most popular story about the invention of the cone came a year later. The city of St. Louis was hosting a World's Fair in 1904. A vendor was selling scoops of his delicious ice cream at the fair. His ice cream was so popular on that day that he ran out of dishes to serve people. He was in a sticky situation.
- 11 Ernest Hamwi was selling crispy waffles at the booth next door. He saw the pickle his fellow businessman was in. He quickly thought of a solution. He took one of his waffles and rolled it up into the shape of a cone. He gave it to the vendor after it cooled off. The vendor put ice cream inside the cone and sold it to customers. Everyone soon wanted a taste of this new invention. Many believe this is the event that made the ice cream cone popular.
- 12 Hamwi's quick thinking resulted in great success. He soon started his own company called Cornocopia Waffle Oven Company. He promoted his cones to fairs all across America. They were a big hit.
- 13 No matter how the cone came to be, this happy invention has brought joy to millions of people.

History of Ice Cream



"Who Invented the Ice Cream Cone?" by Laurel Plausini. Written for educational purposes. "History of Ice Cream" graphic created for educational purposes.

9. Read the sentence from Passage 1.

“Popsicles were a hit!” (paragraph 5)

What is the meaning of the phrase were a hit as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ kept cold
- Ⓑ needed work
- Ⓒ tasted sweet
- Ⓓ became popular

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Use context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the meaning of multiple-meaning and unknown words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

10. Read the sentence from Passage 1.

“But his kids didn’t like the sound of that.” (paragraph 4)

Why did the author include this detail in the passage?

- ☒ Ⓐ to explain how the Popsicle was named
- ☐ Ⓑ to show how Frank Epperson invented the Popsicle
- ☐ Ⓒ to tell why so many flavors of Popsicles were made
- ☐ Ⓓ to describe why Frank Epperson sold Popsicles to a big company

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 69%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the development of an author’s purpose in an informational text.

11. Select **two** sentences that belong in a summary of Passage 1.

- Ⓐ Popsicles are usually sold at amusement parks.
- Ⓑ Popsicles look similar to icicles in the wintertime.
- Ⓒ Frank got the name for his treat from his children.
- Ⓓ Frank sold his invention to many small companies.
- Ⓔ Frank forgot his drink outside on a cold night as a boy.

Answer Key: C, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 28%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.2b

Benchmark Description: Include the central idea and relevant details for an informational text.

12. In Passage 1, how does the author support the claim that people really like Popsicles?

- Ⓐ by showing how Popsicles are made
- Ⓑ by explaining where Popsicles are sold
- Ⓒ by stating that Popsicles are still made today
- Ⓓ by telling about different types of sticks from Popsicles

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 45%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Identify an author's claim and explain how an author uses evidence to support the claim.

13. In Passage 1, which sentence supports the central idea that inventions can come from mistakes?

- Ⓐ "The night was freezing cold." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓑ "It looked like a big, fruity icicle on a stick." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓒ "Frank made new flavors." (paragraph 5)
- Ⓓ "Today you can buy Popsicles on one stick or on two." (paragraph 6)

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Identify the central idea and explain how relevant details support that idea in a text.

14. Read the sentence from Passage 2.

“He promoted his cones to fairs all across America.” (paragraph 12)

What is the meaning of promoted as it is used in the sentence?

- Ⓐ sold eagerly
- Ⓑ invented quickly
- Ⓒ returned carefully
- Ⓓ packaged differently

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Use context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the meaning of multiple-meaning and unknown words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

15. Read the sentence from Passage 2.

“He saw the pickle his fellow businessman was in.” (paragraph 11)

Why does the author use the phrase “the pickle” in this sentence?

- Ⓐ to describe the purpose of the cones
- Ⓑ to show that it was hard to sell waffles
- Ⓒ to describe the types of food sold at the fair
- Ⓓ to show that the ice cream vendor had a problem

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Identify and explain metaphors, personification, and hyperbole in text(s).

16. In Passage 2, how does the timeline support information from the passage?

- Ⓐ It explains where waffle cones are sold.
- Ⓑ It shows who the first person to eat ice cream was.
- Ⓒ It explains how different flavors were added to ice cream.
- Ⓓ It shows how waffle cones fit into the creation of ice cream.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how text features contribute to meaning and identify the text structures of chronology, comparison, and cause/effect in texts.

17. In Passage 2, why does the author include the story about Ernest Hamwi?

- ☒ Ⓐ to help explain the history of ice cream cones
- ☐ Ⓑ to show the reader that he was a busy vendor
- ☐ Ⓒ to describe the different types of waffles he made
- ☐ Ⓓ to persuade the reader that cones are better than dishes

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the development of an author's purpose in an informational text.

- 18.** Fill in the bubbles to show whether each sentence describes the topic of Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
A child invents something delicious.	☒ (A)	☐ (B)	☐ (C)
A person is successful because of an invention.	☐ (D)	☐ (E)	☒ (F)
A problem leads to a new invention.	☐ (G)	☒ (H)	☐ (I)

Answer Key: A, F, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 31%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how two authors present information on the same topic or theme.

When Seven DeSwapp Hopped

by Bronchelle Parker

- 1 Seven DeSwapp was so excited when she woke up early Saturday morning. She was going to the beach.
- 2 Every summer, the DeSwapps took a special family trip to the beach. And every summer, Seven's big brother, Ras, found the best treasures there. Last year, he saw dolphins diving into the ocean.
- 3 "**Eureka**," he would cry when he found a treasure.
- 4 Seven called him Ras the Terrific Treasure Finder. This year, she wanted to be a Terrific Treasure Finder, too.
- 5 "Eureka." She practiced on her way downstairs with Ras. The night before, she had made a list of all the treasures she wanted to find at the beach. A sandcastle with a moat. A starfish. And a cute baby crab.
- 6 But when Seven and Ras got to the living room, Ms. DeSwapp did *not* look ready for the beach. She was wearing sneakers. *Not* sandals. And she had on a big backpack. *Not* a bathing suit. Seven and Ras scratched their heads, trading puzzled looks.
- 7 "Surprise," sang Ms. DeSwapp. She tossed each of them a sleeping bag. "This year, we're kicking it up a notch. Bye-bye, beach. We're going camping in the mountains."
- 8 "Sweet." Ras jumped up and down, his dreadlocks dancing about his head.
- 9 Seven's heart sank.
- 10 "Are there sandcastles in the mountains, Mama?" she asked.
- 11 "No, silly," giggled Ras. . . .
- 12 It was a long drive to the mountains. Seven looked out the window. At first, the land looked as flat as the pancakes she ate for breakfast. Then the ground slowly started to rise into giant hills with pointy tops.
- 13 Seven closed her eyes and tried to imagine what kind of treasures she would find in the mountains. But all she could think of were sandcastles, starfish, and cute baby crabs. . . .
- 14 Ms. DeSwapp stopped at a perfect spot in the woods to camp. Then up, up went their tent. And up, up went their feet as they set out for a big hike.
- 15 Seven hiked very carefully, so she wouldn't miss any treasures.
- 16 "Eureka." She practiced while she searched for treasures over big rocks . . . and under little rocks, too. She searched between the bushy bushes . . . and around the tall, tall trees.

- 17 When they reached a tiny stream, Seven took a break from treasure hunting.
- 18 “Whew!” she huffed, squatting to sit on a rock.
- 19 But just as she did, the rock began to croak like a frog! “Ribbit,” croaked the rock. “Ribbit-ribbit.”
- 20 Suddenly, six green frogs hopped out from behind the rock.
- 21 “Ribbit,” they croaked, happily hopping high.
- 22 Soon, Seven joined in the frogs’ fun. “Ribbit,” she croaked, hopping up and down. “Ribbit-ribbit.”
- 23 Before long, the DeSwapps were playing a silly game of leapfrog. Seven hopped over Ras. Then she hopped over Ms. DeSwapp. She even hopped over the tiny stream.
- 24 Bright yellow butterflies greeted Seven on the other side of the stream. Their soft wings tickled her cheeks as they swirled around her head. Then off they flew towards a loud *SHHHH* coming from the distance.
- 25 It sounded like rain. *SHHHH*.
- 26 Slowly, Seven followed the sound. She crept down the trail on her tiptoes.
- 27 Closer and closer she came, until she was standing across from a beautiful waterfall. It looked like buckets of water falling from a big cliff with a *SHHHH* and landing, drop after drop, in a pool.
- 28 It was the most terrific treasure Seven had ever seen.
- 29 Just behind her, Ras and Ms. DeSwapp watched the waterfall in wide-eyed amazement.
- 30 “Sweet find, Seven,” squealed Ras.
- 31 Bursting with excitement, Seven threw her arms in the air. And in a voice loud enough to shake the mountains, she cried, “Eureka!”

Glossary

eureka: a cry of joy when someone finds or discovers something

Excerpt from “When Seven DeSwapp Hopped” by Bronchelle Parker, from *Ladybug* Magazine.
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19. Read this sentence from the passage.

“Then off they flew towards a loud *SHHHH* coming from the distance.”
(paragraph 24)

The word distance comes from the Latin root word meaning “standing apart.” Based on this information, what does distance mean as it is used in the sentence?

- ☒ Ⓐ a place that is far away
- ☐ Ⓑ a place that is full of wildlife
- ☐ Ⓒ a place that is unusually large
- ☐ Ⓓ a place that is good for gathering

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 77%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Identify and apply knowledge of common Greek and Latin roots, base words, and affixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words in grade-level content.

20. Read this sentence from the passage.

9 Seven’s heart sank.

What does this sentence show about Seven?

- Ⓐ She feels afraid of the mountains.
- Ⓑ She feels disappointed by the surprise.
- Ⓒ She feels bored by the idea of camping.
- Ⓓ She feels tired from making a list for the trip.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Identify and explain metaphors, personification, and hyperbole in text(s).

21. How does Ras feel about the trip to the mountains?

- Ⓐ He is ready to become the best at a new skill.
- Ⓑ He is happy to go on a different type of adventure.
- Ⓒ He is glad that he prepared for many different events.
- Ⓓ He is hoping to see some of the same treasures again.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain different characters' perspectives in a literary text.

22. How does the author develop the theme that something special can happen when you are not expecting it?

- Ⓐ by telling why Seven’s family decides to go on a trip
- Ⓑ by describing why Seven enjoys the car ride to the mountains
- Ⓒ by showing how Seven’s family finds a good place for camping
- Ⓓ by explaining how Seven discovers the waterfall during a game

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Explain a theme and how it develops, using details, in a literary text.

23. Read this sentence from the passage.

“It looked like buckets of water falling from a big cliff with a *SHHHH* and landing, drop after drop, in a pool.” (paragraph 27)

Why does the author describe the waterfall this way?

- ☒ Ⓐ to explain how much water is moving
- ☐ Ⓑ to show how the water is held at the top
- ☐ Ⓒ to explain what it feels like to be in the water
- ☐ Ⓓ to show that there are surprises hiding in the water

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Identify and explain metaphors, personification, and hyperbole in text(s).

24. Read this paragraph from the passage.

28 It was the most terrific treasure Seven had ever seen.

How does this paragraph show a change in Seven's character?

- Ⓐ She knows that working as a team can be helpful.
- Ⓑ She feels that past trips have actually been boring.
- Ⓒ She understands that visiting a different place was a good idea.
- Ⓓ She sees that people have their own opinions of what is special.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how one or more characters develop throughout the plot in a literary text.

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25. Complete the table to show whether each detail describes the perspective of Seven, Ms. DeSwapp, or both characters.

	Seven	Ms. DeSwapp	Both Characters
wants to work toward a certain goal	A	B	C
knows that a trip can lead to exciting moments	D	E	F
enjoys planning new things for the family to do	G	H	I

Answer Key: A, F, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 31%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain different characters’ perspectives in a literary text.

26. Which sentence from the passage supports the theme that it can be good to stay hopeful when plans change?

- Ⓐ "And every summer, Seven's big brother, Ras, found the best treasures there." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓑ "But when Seven and Ras got to the living room, Ms. DeSwapp did *not* look ready for the beach." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓒ "But all she could think of were sandcastles, starfish, and cute baby crabs." (paragraph 13)
- Ⓓ "She practiced while she searched for treasures over big rocks . . . and under little rocks, too." (paragraph 16)

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 40%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Explain a theme and how it develops, using details, in a literary text.

Passage 1: Punky Dunk and the Mouse

by Anonymous

- 1 Punky Dunk, very sly, with a wink of his eye
Strolled lazily all through the house;
To the cellar he went and the morning he spent
On a hunt for a fat little mouse.
- 5 “Over there by the coal,” he said, “Mouse has his hole,
So I’ll sit there beside it and wait.
There’s a trap with some cheese just as nice as you please,
And Mouse soon will come out for that bait.”

- Punky sat by the trap, and seemed taking a nap,
10 But you know that bold Punky was wise.
Though he looked half asleep he was taking a peep
For the gleam of two bright little eyes.

- Soon the mouse crept right out and went running about;
Punky smiled to himself and he said:
15 “I will just let him play in his own foolish way
Till I think that I need to be fed.”

- But the Mouse, too, was smart, and he got a good start,
Then he leaped, and he saved his wee hide,
For he dashed in a hole that was not near the coal
20 But was hidden away at one side.

- “Ha, Ha!” Punky said as he shook his white head.
“Well, Mouse, you may run if you please,
But I’ll eat just the same—’twas for that that I came.”
So he reached in the trap for the cheese.
- 25 Snip-snap! went the trap—Wasn’t that a mishap!
Punky’s black little paw was inside.
He leaped and he jumped and he ran and he bumped—
And the Mouse sat and laughed till he cried.

- Punky ran up the stairs and he knocked over chairs
30 And he sprang to the table and dropped,
He “Meowed!” in his fright, for the trap held him tight,
And it was a long time till he stopped.

- Baby's mama then came and she said: "What a shame!"
And she took off the trap from his paw,
35 And she wrapped it in silk and she fed him with milk
And she gave him some fish bones to gnaw.

"Punky Dunk and the Mouse" by Anonymous. In the public domain.

Passage 2: The Little Thief in the Pantry

by Anonymous

- 1 "MOTHER dear," said a little mouse one day, "I think the people in
our house must be very kind; don't you?" . . .
- 2 There was a twinkle in the mother's eye as she replied,—
- 3 "Well, my child, no doubt they are very well in their way, but
I don't think they are quite as fond of us as you seem to think. Now
remember, Greywhiskers, I have absolutely forbidden you to put your
nose above the ground unless I am with you, for kind as the people
are, I shouldn't be at all surprised if they tried to catch you."
- 4 Greywhiskers twitched his tail with scorn; he was quite sure he
knew how to take care of himself, and he didn't mean to trot meekly
after his mother's tail all his life. So as soon as she had curled herself
up for an afternoon nap he stole away, and scampered across the
pantry shelves.
- 5 . . . A large iced cake stood far back upon the shelf, and
Greywhiskers licked his lips as he sniffed it. Across the top of the cake
there were words written in pink sugar; . . . he did not know that he
was nibbling at little Miss Ethel's birthday cake. But he did feel a little
guilty when he heard his mother calling. Off he ran, and was back in
the nest again by the time his mother had finished rubbing her eyes
after her nap. . . .
- 6 The next day the naughty little mouse again popped up to the
pantry when his mother was asleep; but at first he could find
nothing at all to eat, though there was a most delicious smell of
toasted cheese.
- 7 Presently he found a dear little wooden house, and there hung
the cheese, just inside it.
- 8 In ran Greywhiskers, but, oh! "click" went the little wooden house,
and mousie was caught fast in a trap.

- 9 When the morning came, the cook, who had set the trap, lifted it from the shelf, and then called a pretty little girl to come and see the thief who had eaten her cake. . . .
- 10 “You didn’t know it was stealing, did you, mousie dear?” [the little girl] said.
- 11 “No,” squeaked Greywhiskers sadly; “indeed I didn’t.”
- 12 Cook’s back was turned for a moment, and in that moment tender-hearted little Ethel lifted the lid of the trap, and out popped mousie.
- 13 Oh! how quickly he ran home to his mother . . . and then she made him promise never to disobey her again, and you may be sure he never did.

Excerpt from “The Little Thief in the Pantry” by Anonymous. In the public domain.

27. What type of poem is Passage 1?

- Ⓐ haiku
- Ⓑ limerick
- Ⓒ free verse
- Ⓓ rhymed verse

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Identify types of poems: free verse, rhymed verse, haiku, and limerick.

28. Select **two** lines from Passage 1 that show how Punky Dunk changes throughout the poem.

- Ⓐ "Strolled lazily all through the house;" (line 2)
- Ⓑ "To the cellar he went and the morning he spent" (line 3)
- Ⓒ "'I will just let him play in his own foolish way'" (line 15)
- Ⓓ "'Well, Mouse, you may run if you please,'" (line 22)
- Ⓔ "Punky ran up the stairs and he knocked over chairs" (line 29)

Answer Key: A, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 25%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how one or more characters develop throughout the plot in a literary text.

29. How does Passage 1 support the theme of outsmarting others?

- Ⓐ by explaining why Punky Dunk seems so bold
- Ⓑ by showing that the mouse was scared of Punky Dunk
- Ⓒ by explaining how Punky Dunk came up with a successful plan
- Ⓓ by describing how the mouse gets away from Punky Dunk in the end

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Explain a theme and how it develops, using details, in a literary text.

30. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the Mouse's view of Punky Dunk in Passage 1?

- ☒ Ⓐ He is not afraid of Punky Dunk.
- ☐ Ⓑ He is curious about Punky Dunk.
- ☐ Ⓒ He is confused by what Punky Dunk does.
- ☐ Ⓓ He is not happy about what happens to Punky Dunk.

Part B

Which line from Passage 1 supports the answer in Part A?

- ☐ Ⓐ "Snip-snap! went the trap—Wasn't that a mishap!" (line 25)
- ☐ Ⓑ "Punky's black little paw was inside." (line 26)
- ☐ Ⓒ "He leaped and he jumped and he ran and he bumped—" (line 27)
- ☒ Ⓓ "And the Mouse sat and laughed till he cried." (line 28)

Answer Key: Part A: A and Part B: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 36%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain different characters' perspectives in a literary text.

31. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

“Oh! how quickly he ran home to his mother . . . and then she made him promise never to disobey her again, and you may be sure he never did.”
(paragraph 13)

What is the meaning of disobey as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ to get help with a task
- Ⓑ to not do what you are told
- Ⓒ to do something without thinking
- Ⓓ to think about what could happen

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Identify and apply knowledge of common Greek and Latin roots, base words, and affixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words in grade-level content.

32. Which **two** events in Passage 2 show that Greywhiskers changes in the passage?

- Ⓐ He forgets to save some of Ethel's birthday cake for his mother.
- Ⓑ He enjoys the company of humans who live in the house with him.
- Ⓒ He feels sorry when Ethel releases him and he returns to his mother.
- Ⓓ He acts sneaky and goes into the pantry without his mother's permission.
- Ⓔ He gives up searching for food once he cannot find any cheese that he likes.

Answer Key: C, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 36%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how one or more characters develop throughout the plot in a literary text.

33. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

“Greywhiskers twitched his tail with scorn; he was quite sure he knew how to take care of himself, and he didn’t mean to trot meekly after his mother’s tail all his life.” (paragraph 4)

What does this sentence show about how Greywhiskers feels?

- Ⓐ He wants to please his mother.
- Ⓑ He wants to move to a new house.
- Ⓒ He wants to make his own decisions.
- Ⓓ He wants to make others afraid of him.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how one or more characters develop throughout the plot in a literary text.

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- 34.** Fill in the bubbles to show the different viewpoints of the characters in Passage 2.

	Greywhiskers	Mother	Ethel
enjoys exploring alone	☒ (A)	☐ (B)	☐ (C)
thinks it is important to help those in need	☐ (D)	☐ (E)	☒ (F)
is careful about living with others in the house	☐ (G)	☒ (H)	☐ (I)

Answer Key: A, F, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain different characters' perspectives in a literary text.

35. Select **two** details that belong in a summary of Passage 2.

- ☒ (A) Greywhiskers regrets not listening to his mother.
- ☐ (B) Greywhiskers enjoys the smell of toasted cheese.
- ☐ (C) Greywhiskers sees pink icing on Ethel’s birthday cake.
- ☒ (D) Greywhiskers becomes trapped when looking for food.
- ☐ (E) Greywhiskers’s mother rubs her eyes after taking a nap.

Answer Key: A, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.2a

Benchmark Description: Include plot and theme for a literary text.

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36. Fill in the bubbles to show which lesson the main character learns in Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
Following rules is important.	☐ A	☒ B	☐ C
Attempting to harm others can lead to hurting oneself.	☒ D	☐ E	☐ F
Be certain about a plan before it is carried out.	☐ G	☐ H	☒ I

Answer Key: B, D, I

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 34%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how two authors present information on the same topic or theme.

37. How is Greywhiskers's experience in Passage 2 similar to Punky Dunk's experience in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ Both are given food in the end.
- Ⓑ Both are comforted by their mothers.
- Ⓒ Both are shown pity after they are caught.
- Ⓓ Both are able to get out of a trap on their own.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 39%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.3.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how two authors present information on the same topic or theme.



Grade 6 FAST Mathematics

Test Release: 2024

1. Jackson has a weekly reading goal. He needs to read for at least 2 hours to meet his goal this week.

Which inequality models r , the number of hours Jackson needs to spend reading this week?

Ⓐ $r < 2$

Ⓑ $r > 2$

Ⓒ $r \leq 2$

Ⓓ $r \geq 2$

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 36%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.1.2

Benchmark Description: Translate a real-world written description into an algebraic inequality in the form of $x > a$, $x < a$, $x \geq a$ or $x \leq a$. Represent the inequality on a number line.

2. The number 84 is 35% of what number?

- Ⓐ 2.4
- Ⓑ 29.4
- Ⓒ 240
- Ⓓ 2940

Answer Key: C

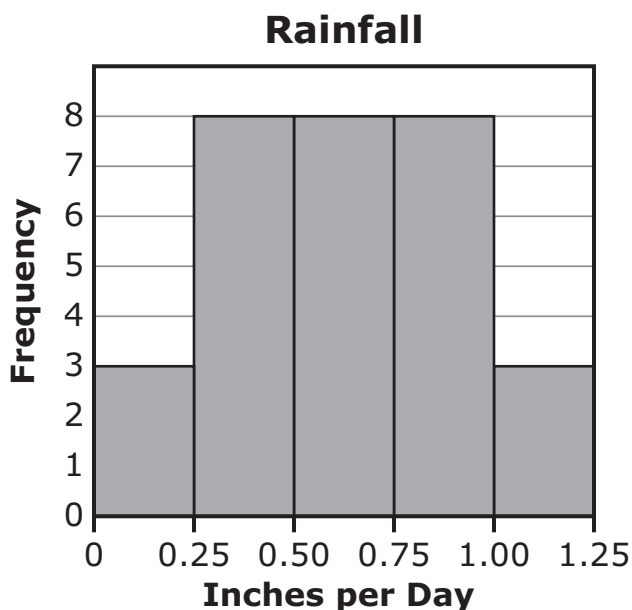
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 42%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.3.4

Benchmark Description: Apply ratio relationships to solve mathematical and real-world problems involving percentages using the relationship between two quantities.

3. The histogram shows the inches of rainfall per day in a town for one month.



Which sentence describes the distribution?

- Ⓐ The distribution has a gap.
- Ⓑ The distribution is skewed.
- Ⓒ The distribution is symmetric.
- Ⓓ The distribution contains an outlier.

Answer Key: C

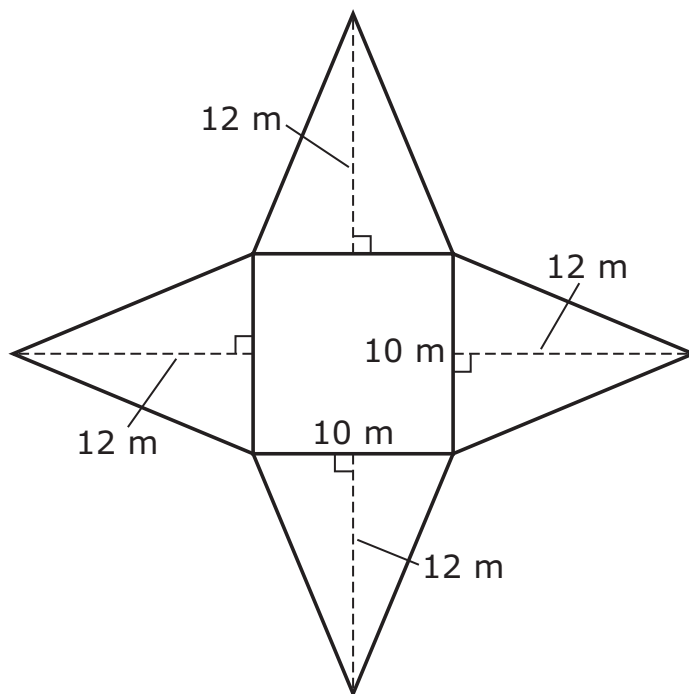
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.DP.1.4

Benchmark Description: Given a histogram or line plot within a real-world context, qualitatively describe and interpret the spread and distribution of the data, including any symmetry, skewness, gaps, clusters, outliers and the range.

4. The net of a square pyramid is shown, with dimensions in meters (m).



What is the surface area, in square meters, of the pyramid?

340

←
→
↶
↷
✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\square}{\square}$

Answer Key: 340, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 22%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.GR.2.4

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, find the surface area of right rectangular prisms and right rectangular pyramids using the figure's net.

5. Select all the expressions that have a value of 18.

- Ⓐ $14 - |4|$
- Ⓑ $|16| + |-2|$
- Ⓒ $|6| + |-24|$
- Ⓓ $|20| - |-2|$
- Ⓔ $|-27| + |9|$

Answer Key: B, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.1.4

Benchmark Description: Solve mathematical and real-world problems involving absolute value, including the comparison of absolute value.

6. On a baseball team, 7 players are in sixth grade and 10 players are in seventh grade.

What is the ratio of the number of players in sixth grade to the total number of players?

- Ⓐ 7:3
- Ⓑ 7:10
- Ⓒ 7:17
- Ⓓ 10:17

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 48%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.3.1

Benchmark Description: Given a real-world context, write and interpret ratios to show the relative sizes of two quantities using appropriate notation: a/b , a to b , or $a:b$ where $b \neq 0$.

7. What is the value of $-133 - 42$?

A digital math input interface. At the top, a rectangular box displays the answer -175 in red text. Below this box is a toolbar with five circular icons: a left arrow, a right arrow, a curved left arrow, a curved right arrow, and a square with an 'X' (clear). Below the toolbar is a numeric keypad with a grid of buttons. The buttons are arranged in five rows and three columns: the first row contains 1, 2, 3; the second row contains 4, 5, 6; the third row contains 7, 8, 9; the fourth row contains an empty box, 0, and an empty box; the fifth row contains a decimal point, a negative sign, and a fraction template icon (a box with a horizontal line and two smaller boxes above and below it). The entire keypad area is enclosed in a light blue border.

Answer Key: -175 , or any equivalent value

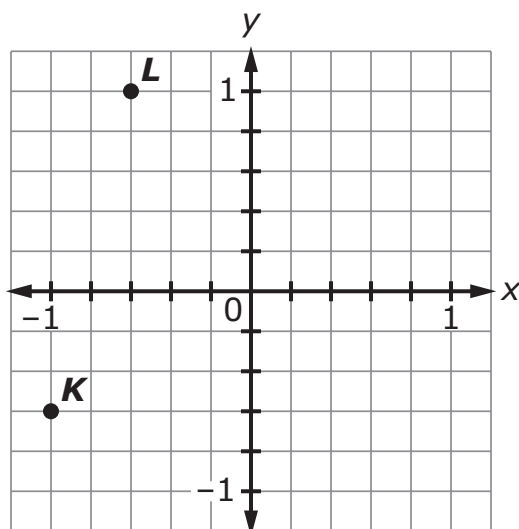
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 62%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.4.1

Benchmark Description: Apply and extend previous understandings of operations with whole numbers to add and subtract integers with procedural fluency.

8. Points L and K are shown on the coordinate plane.



Match each point with its coordinates.

	$(1, -0.6)$	$(-0.6, 1)$	$(-0.6, -1)$	$(-1, -0.6)$
Point K	(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)
Point L	(E)	(F)	(G)	(H)

Answer Key: D, F

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.GR.1.1

Benchmark Description: Extend previous understanding of the coordinate plane to plot rational number ordered pairs in all four quadrants and on both axes. Identify the x- or y-axis as the line of reflection when two ordered pairs have an opposite x- or y- coordinate.

9. Richard uploads $\frac{1}{6}$ of his photo library to a file sharing site in $\frac{1}{2}$ minute.

If the upload continues at the same constant rate, what fraction of Richard's photo library can he upload per minute to the file sharing site?

Ⓐ $\frac{1}{180}$

Ⓑ $\frac{1}{12}$

Ⓒ $\frac{1}{3}$

Ⓓ 3

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 40%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.3.2

Benchmark Description: Given a real-world context, determine a rate for a ratio of quantities with different units. Calculate and interpret the corresponding unit rate.

- 10.** Aisha records the outdoor temperature, in degrees Fahrenheit ($^{\circ}\text{F}$), each day for 5 days in the table shown.

Outdoor Temperature

Day	Temperature ($^{\circ}\text{F}$)
Monday	76.5
Tuesday	70.2
Wednesday	63.0
Thursday	71.9
Friday	73.4

What is the mean temperature of Aisha's data?

71

←
→
↶
↷
✕

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\square}{\square}$

Answer Key: 71, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 34%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.DP.1.2

Benchmark Description: Given a numerical data set within a real-world context, find and interpret mean, median, mode and range.

11. What is the value of 1^3 ?

- ☒ (A) 1
- ☐ (B) 3
- ☐ (C) 111
- ☐ (D) 1000

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 69%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.3.3

Benchmark Description: Evaluate positive rational numbers and integers with natural number exponents.

12. What is the value of the product of 3.42 and 0.11?

- Ⓐ 0.0342
- Ⓑ 0.03762
- Ⓒ 0.342
- Ⓓ 0.3762

Answer Key: D

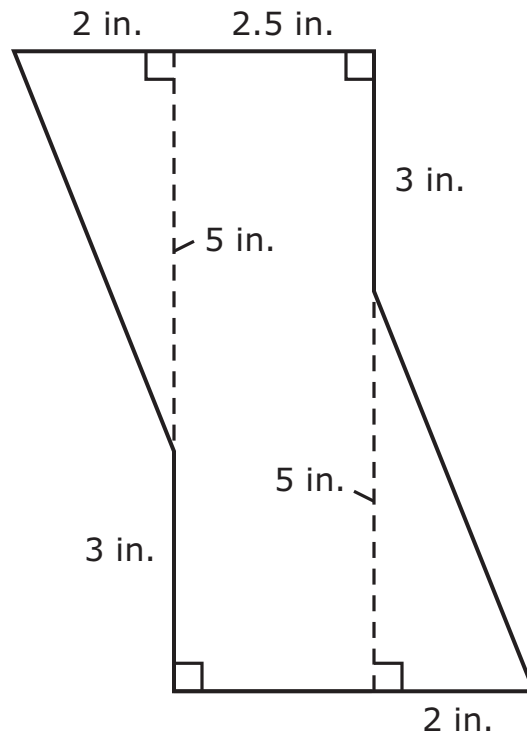
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.2.1

Benchmark Description: Multiply and divide positive multi-digit numbers with decimals to the thousandths, including using a standard algorithm with procedural fluency.

13. A figure is shown, with dimensions in inches (in.).



What is the area of the figure?

- Ⓐ 25 square inches
- Ⓑ 30 square inches
- Ⓒ 36 square inches
- Ⓓ 40 square inches

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 33%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.GR.2.2

Benchmark Description: Solve mathematical and real-world problems involving the area of quadrilaterals and composite figures by decomposing them into triangles or rectangles.

14. Select all the values for j that make $j + 2 < 17$ true.

- ☒ (A) -15
- ☒ (B) -10
- ☒ (C) 0
- ☐ (D) 15
- ☐ (E) 17
- ☐ (F) 20

Answer Key: A, B, C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.2.1

Benchmark Description: Given an equation or inequality and a specified set of integer values, determine which values make the equation or inequality true or false.

15. Malia has 2 bags of oranges and 1 bag of grapefruit.

- The first bag of oranges weighs 1.4 pounds, and the second bag weighs 2.8 pounds.
- The bag of grapefruit weighs 2.25 times as much as the two bags of oranges combined.

What is the weight, in pounds, of the bag of grapefruit?

9.45

←

→

↶

↷

✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$

Answer Key: 9.45, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.2.3

Benchmark Description: Solve multi-step real-world problems involving any of the four operations with positive multi-digit decimals or positive fractions, including mixed numbers.

- 16.** Claudia buys a 240-page book. She will read 20 pages of the book every week.

Which expression represents how many pages Claudia has left to read after w weeks?

- ☒ (A) $240 - 20w$
- ☐ (B) $240w - 20$
- ☐ (C) $240 + 20w$
- ☐ (D) $240w + 20$

Answer Key: A

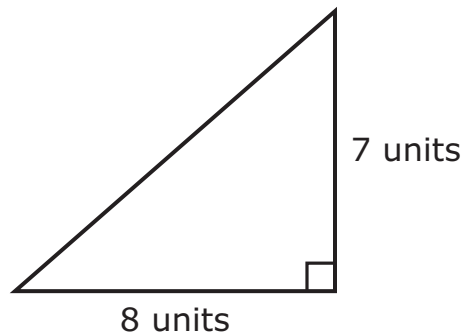
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 72%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.1.1

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, translate written descriptions into algebraic expressions and translate algebraic expressions into written descriptions.

17. A right triangle is shown.



What is the area, in square units, of the triangle?

28

←
→
↶
↷
✕

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\square}{\square}$

Answer Key: 28, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.GR.2.1

Benchmark Description: Derive a formula for the area of a right triangle using a rectangle. Apply a formula to find the area of a triangle.

18. Which decimal is equivalent to $3\frac{4}{5}$

- Ⓐ 0.345
- Ⓑ 0.38
- Ⓒ 3.45
- Ⓓ 3.8

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 45%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.3.5

Benchmark Description: Rewrite positive rational numbers in different but equivalent forms including fractions, terminating decimals and percentages.

19. An equation is shown.

$$2.75 = m - 0.5$$

What is the value of m in the equation?

3.25

← → ↶ ↷ ✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$

Answer Key: 3.25, or any equivalent value

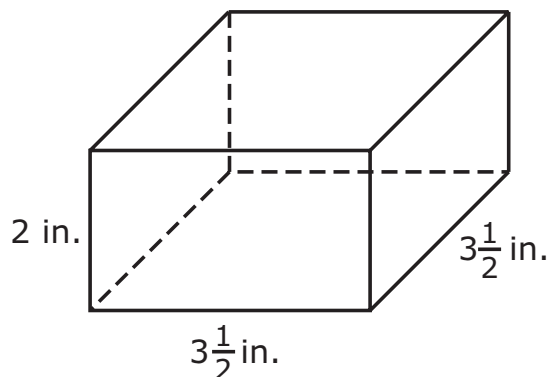
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.2.4

Benchmark Description: Determine the unknown decimal or fraction in an equation involving any of the four operations, relating three numbers, with the unknown in any position.

20. A package in the shape of a right rectangular prism is shown, with units in inches (in.).



What is the volume, in cubic inches, of the package?

- Ⓐ 9
- Ⓑ $12\frac{1}{4}$
- Ⓒ $18\frac{1}{4}$
- Ⓓ $24\frac{1}{2}$

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 38%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.GR.2.3

Benchmark Description: Solve mathematical and real-world problems involving the volume of right rectangular prisms with positive rational number edge lengths using a visual model and a formula.

21. What is $\frac{41}{20}$ written as a decimal?

2.05

←
→
↶
↷
✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\square}{\square}$

Answer Key: 2.05, any equivalent decimal value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.3.5

Benchmark Description: Rewrite positive rational numbers in different but equivalent forms including fractions, terminating decimals and percentages.

22. Marquis can plant 25 flowers in 10 minutes.

Which ratio can be used to evaluate the unit rate, in flowers per minute?

☒ (A) $\frac{25}{10}$

☐ (B) $\frac{10}{25}$

☐ (C) $\frac{10}{35}$

☐ (D) $\frac{25}{35}$

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 74%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.3.2

Benchmark Description: Given a real-world context, determine a rate for a ratio of quantities with different units. Calculate and interpret the corresponding unit rate.

23. An equation is shown.

$$\frac{5}{12} + x = \frac{11}{12}$$

What is the value of x ?

☒ Ⓐ $\frac{6}{12}$

☐ Ⓑ $\frac{7}{12}$

☐ Ⓒ $\frac{16}{24}$

☐ Ⓓ $1\frac{4}{12}$

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 86%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.2.4

Benchmark Description: Determine the unknown decimal or fraction in an equation involving any of the four operations, relating three numbers, with the unknown in any position.

- 24.** A farmer measures the heights, in inches, of randomly selected corn stalks. His data are shown.

$$\{38, 44, 35, 38, 41, 33\}$$

He measures another corn stalk that increases the range of his data set by exactly 8 inches.

What is a possible height for the corn stalk, in inches, that increases the range by 8 inches?

25

←
→
↶
↷
✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$

Answer Key: 25 or 52, or any equivalent values

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 28%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.DP.1.6

Benchmark Description: Given a real-world scenario, determine and describe how changes in data values impact measures of center and variation.

25. Which set of values is in order from least to greatest?

- Ⓐ $-13.4, -17.2, 11.03, 11.7$
- Ⓑ $-17.2, -13.4, 11.03, 11.7$
- Ⓒ $-13.4, -17.2, 11.7, 11.03$
- Ⓓ $-17.2, -13.4, 11.7, 11.03$

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 62%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.1.1

Benchmark Description: Extend previous understanding of numbers to define rational numbers. Plot, order and compare rational numbers.

26. At a factory, 2 cars are assembled every 36 hours of run time.

How many cars are assembled at the factory every 126 hours of run time?

The image shows a digital math input interface. At the top, a white rectangular box contains the number '7' in red. Below this box is a grey bar containing five circular navigation buttons: a left arrow, a right arrow, a curved left arrow (undo), a curved right arrow (redo), and a square with an 'X' (clear). Below the navigation bar is a large white area with a blue border, which serves as a keypad. The keypad is organized into rows: the first row has buttons for digits 1, 2, and 3; the second row for 4, 5, and 6; the third row for 7, 8, and 9; the fourth row for an empty box, 0, and another empty box; and the fifth row for a decimal point, a negative sign, and a fraction template button (represented by a square with a horizontal line and two smaller squares below it).

Answer Key: 7, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.3.5

Benchmark Description: Solve mathematical and real-world problems involving ratios, rates and unit rates, including comparisons, mixtures, ratios of lengths and conversions within the measurement system.

27. Which value for x makes the inequality $-3x > 18$ true?

- ☒ (A) -8
- ☐ (B) -6
- ☐ (C) 6
- ☐ (D) 8

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 27%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.2.1

Benchmark Description: Given an equation or inequality and a specified set of integer values, determine which values make the equation or inequality true or false.

- 28.** On a coordinate plane, point J is located at $(-6, 3)$ and point K is located at $(7, 3)$.

What is the distance, in units, between points J and K ?

13

←
→
↶
↷
✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\square}{\square}$

Answer Key: 13, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 38%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.GR.1.2

Benchmark Description: Find distances between ordered pairs, limited to the same x-coordinate or the same y-coordinate, represented on the coordinate plane.

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- 29.** The average temperatures, in degrees Celsius, in a city on 10 consecutive days are shown.

$\{7.1, 6.6, 10.1, 5.9, 7.9, 10.1, 9.2, 7.9, 7.1, 7.1\}$

Select a number and phrase to describe the range of the data.

The range of the data is

☐ (A) 10.1
☐ (B) 7.9
☐ (C) 7.5
☐ (D) 7.1
☐ (E) 5.8
☒ (F) 4.2

and it describes

☒ (A) the spread of
☐ (B) the middle value of
☐ (C) the maximum value of
☐ (D) the value most often found in

the data.

Answer Key: F, A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 26%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.DP.1.2

Benchmark Description: Given a numerical data set within a real-world context, find and interpret mean, median, mode and range.

30. What is the value of $|-12| - |5|$?

- Ⓐ -17
- Ⓑ -7
- Ⓒ 7
- Ⓓ 17

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.1.4

Benchmark Description: Solve mathematical and real-world problems involving absolute value, including the comparison of absolute value.

31. What is the product of 3.74 and 0.8?

- Ⓐ 2.982
- Ⓑ 2.992
- Ⓒ 29.82
- Ⓓ 29.92

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 50%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.2.1

Benchmark Description: Multiply and divide positive multi-digit numbers with decimals to the thousandths, including using a standard algorithm with procedural fluency.

32. Ana and Brett evaluate the expression $\frac{4}{5} \div 2\frac{5}{11}$.

- Ana's answer is $\frac{135}{44}$.
- Brett's answer is $3\frac{3}{44}$.

Who evaluated the expression correctly?

- Ⓐ Ana
- Ⓑ Brett
- Ⓒ both Ana and Brett
- Ⓓ neither Ana nor Brett

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.2.2

Benchmark Description: Extend previous understanding of multiplication and division to compute products and quotients of positive fractions by positive fractions, including mixed numbers, with procedural fluency.

33. An expression is shown.

$$435 + 105$$

Which is an equivalent expression?

- ☒ (A) $15 (29 + 7)$
- ☐ (B) $5 (87 + 20)$
- ☐ (C) $3 (135 + 35)$
- ☐ (D) $29 (15 + 105)$

Answer Key: A

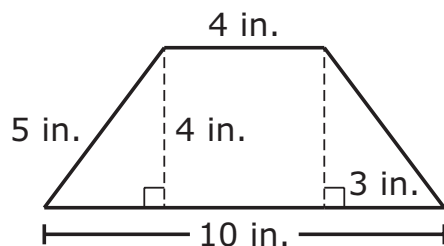
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.3.2

Benchmark Description: Rewrite the sum of two composite whole numbers having a common factor, as a common factor multiplied by the sum of two whole numbers.

34. Vanessa makes a shelf in the shape of an isosceles trapezoid for a corner bookcase. The shelf, with dimensions in inches (in.), is shown.



What is the area, in square inches, of the shelf?

- Ⓐ 28
- Ⓑ 40
- Ⓒ 43
- Ⓓ 46

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 42%

Reporting Category: Geometric Reasoning, Data Analysis, and Probability

Benchmark: MA.6.GR.2.2

Benchmark Description: Solve mathematical and real-world problems involving the area of quadrilaterals and composite figures by decomposing them into triangles or rectangles.

35. An equation is shown.

$$-6x = -72$$

What is the value of x ?

Ⓐ -432

Ⓑ -12

Ⓒ 12

Ⓓ 432

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Algebraic Reasoning

Benchmark: MA.6.AR.2.3

Benchmark Description: Write and solve one-step equations in one variable within a mathematical or real-world context using multiplication and division, where all terms and solutions are integers.

36. Select all the values that are located 3 units to the right of 0 on a number line.

- ☒ (A) 3
- ☐ (B) -3
- ☒ (C) $|3|$
- ☒ (D) $|-3|$
- ☐ (E) $-|3|$
- ☐ (F) $-|-3|$

Answer Key: A, C, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 32%

Reporting Category: Number Sense and Operations

Benchmark: MA.6.NSO.1.3

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, interpret the absolute value of a number as the distance from zero on a number line. Find the absolute value of rational numbers.



Grade 6 FAST ELA Reading

Test Release: 2024

Passage 1: **Mary Anderson: Windshield Wipers**

by Catherine Thimmesh

- 1 It was a dreadful day, weatherwise. Snow and sleet pelted the pavement, and people burrowed deep within their coats. Hoping to catch the sights and escape the blustery cold, Mary Anderson of Birmingham, Alabama, climbed aboard a New York City streetcar. The year was 1902. It turned out to be a ride she would never forget, but not because of the scenery. Instead, the ride would inspire her to invent the very first windshield wiper. And simply because she felt sorry for the streetcar driver, who struggled to see through the glass. The invention would not only improve conditions for all drivers, but would save countless lives as well.
- 2 Earlier, top-notch engineers had tackled the problem of poor visibility in bad weather and came up with a solution. They split the windshield. Once the glass became covered with rain or snow, the streetcar driver could fling open the middle for a clear view. Trouble was, it didn't work. At least not very well. Mary watched helplessly as the driver desperately tried to see. When he opened the split glass, he was greeted with a burst of icy cold air and a blast of heavy, wet snow.
- 3 *"Why doesn't someone create a device to remove the snow?" Mary reportedly asked the people around her.*
- 4 *"It's been tried many times," they told her. "Can't be done."*
- 5 Nonsense, thought Mary, as she scribbled in her notebook. Why can't there be a lever on the inside that would move an arm on the outside to swipe off the snow? . . .
- 6 Later, when she returned to her home in Birmingham, she studied her sketches. She spent some time refining her drawings—making them more elaborate, adding more details. Satisfied at last, she brought her design to a small manufacturing company in Birmingham and hired them to make a model. Then, she filed a patent application.
- 7 *"My invention relates to an improvement in window-cleaning devices in which a radially-swinging arm is actuated by a handle from inside of a car-vestibule," Mary stated in her patent specification.*
- 8 In other words, a lever on the inside that would move an arm on the outside. Mary's wiper was made of wooden strips and pieces of rubber. She designed it to be removed in good weather so that it would not interfere with the appearance of the streetcar. One of her most important elements was the addition of a counterweight.

9 *This was used, she writes, “to provide means for maintaining a uniform pressure upon the glass throughout the entire area swept by my improved window-cleaning device.”*

10 In other words, it would swipe off the snow. Mary was awarded a patent in 1903 for a window-cleaning device—a windshield wiper. Once the invention was protected by patent, she wrote a large Canadian company offering to sell her rights. They weren’t interested. After reviewing her proposal, they decided that her invention had little, if any, commercial value. They simply didn’t think it would sell. They encouraged her, however, to submit any other “useful patents” she might have for their consideration.

11 Mary put the patent in a drawer and, eventually, it expired. Several years later, someone else revived her idea, patented it, sold it, and made a very large sum of money. Every day, lives are saved due to increased visibility during bad weather. Even in our high-tech society, the windshield wiper remains one of the greatest safety inventions of the modern-day automobile.

Figure 1.

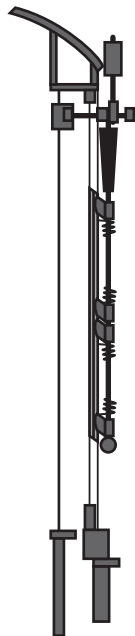
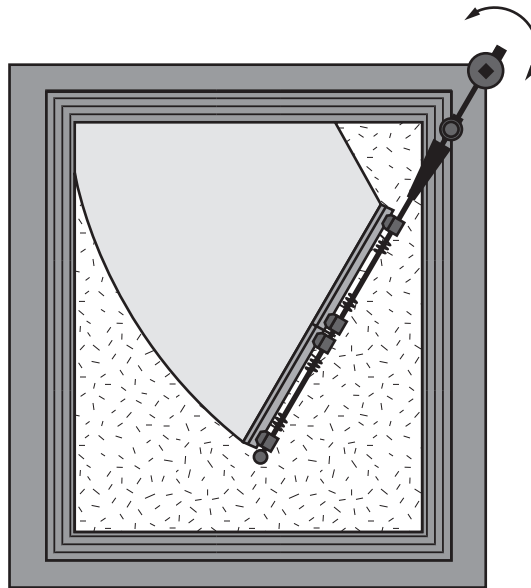


Figure 2.



Recreation of Mary Anderson's illustration for her window-cleaning device patent in 1903

Excerpt from “Mary Anderson” by Catherine Thimmesh, from *Girls Think of Everything*. Copyright © 2000 by Catherine Thimmesh. Reprinted by permission of Houghton Mifflin Harcourt Publishing Company via Copyright Clearance Center. Image created for educational purposes.

Passage 2: Alabama Woman Stuck in NYC Traffic in 1902 Invented the Windshield Wiper

by Joe Palca

The following passage is a transcript from a radio interview with Mary Anderson's great-great-niece, Sara-Scott Wingo.

12 RACHEL MARTIN, HOST:

13 We're now going to take a moment to think about technology that we use without thinking. NPR's Joe Palca is exploring the origins of many common items, including the windshield wiper.

14 JOE PALCA, BYLINE: It may seem hard to imagine a world without windshield wipers, but there was. Mary Anderson lived in that world. In 1902, she was visiting New York City.

15 SARA-SCOTT WINGO: She was riding a streetcar, and it was snowing. And she observed that the streetcar driver had to get out and continually clean off the windshield.

16 PALCA: That's Sara-Scott Wingo.

17 WINGO: Mary Anderson was my great-great-aunt.

18 PALCA: So Anderson was riding in the streetcar in the snow. And she thought it didn't make sense that the driver had to keep jumping out to clean off the windshield. What if there were some sort of blade that could do it for him?

19 WINGO: She went home, drew a sketch . . .

20 PALCA: . . . And wrote up a description of her idea. Then she thought, what the heck, I'll apply for a patent.

21 [VOICE ACTRESS]: (Reading) Be it known to all that I, Mary Anderson, a citizen of the United States residing in Birmingham, in the county of Jefferson in the state of Alabama, have invented a new and useful improvement in window-cleaning devices.

22 PALCA: The patent application describes how the wiper was operated by a handle inside the vestibule of the motor car and was easily removable.

23 [VOICE ACTRESS]: (Reading) . . . Thus, leaving nothing to mar the usual appearance of the car during fair weather.

24 PALCA: The application was filed June 18, 1903. On November 10 that same year, the United States Patent Office awarded Anderson patent number 743801 for her new device. Sara-Scott Wingo says Anderson tried to interest manufacturing firms in making her

windshield wipers for the emerging motor car industry, but no takers. A letter from the firm of Dinning and Eckenstein is one of Wingo's prized possessions.

25 WINGO: (Reading) Dear madam, we beg to acknowledge receipt of your recent favor with reference to the sale of your patent. In reply, we regret to state we do not consider it to be of such commercial value as would warrant our undertaking its sale.

26 They missed out, don't you think?

27 PALCA: Sara-Scott Wingo doesn't know for sure why Anderson's invention never went anywhere. But she suspects it might have been because Anderson was such an independent woman.

28 WINGO: She didn't have a father. She didn't have a husband. And the world was kind of run by men back then.

29 PALCA: It doesn't seem as if Mary Anderson was crushed by the rejections. She lived another 50 years, long enough to see windshield wipers become ubiquitous.¹ Wingo says her family is proud of Anderson's accomplishments.

30 WINGO: I have three daughters. We talk about Mary Anderson a lot. And we all sort of feel like we want to be open and receptive to sort of our own Mary Anderson moments.

31 PALCA: If Anderson didn't get any money for her invention, at least she finally got some credit. In 2011, she was inducted into the Inventors Hall of Fame.

¹ ubiquitous: found everywhere

Excerpt from "Alabama Woman Stuck in NYC Traffic in 1902 Invented the Windshield Wiper" by Joe Palca. Copyright © 2017 by National Public Radio (NPR). Reprinted by permission of National Public Radio via Copyright Clearance Center.

1. Read these sentences from Passage 1.

“Mary put the patent in a drawer and, eventually, it expired. Several years later, someone else revived her idea, patented it, sold it, and made a very large sum of money.” (paragraph 11)

What is the meaning of the word revived as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ lived out
- Ⓑ thought of
- Ⓒ brought back
- Ⓓ arranged again

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 81%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade-level content.

2. Select the sentence that is illustrated by the image in Passage 1.
- Ⓐ "And simply because she felt sorry for the streetcar driver, who struggled to see through the glass." (paragraph 1)
 - Ⓑ "Once the glass became covered with rain or snow, the streetcar driver could fling open the middle for a clear view." (paragraph 2)
 - Ⓒ "She spent some time refining her drawings—making them more elaborate, adding more details." (paragraph 6)
 - Ⓓ "Once the invention was protected by patent, she wrote a large Canadian company offering to sell her rights." (paragraph 10)

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 38%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey meaning in texts.

3. In Passage 1, what central idea is developed by describing Anderson's ride in a streetcar?
- Ⓐ Many important inventions have been created for the purpose of helping others.
 - Ⓑ Many people depended on professional drivers to get them to different places safely.
 - Ⓒ Anderson's curiosity about how to solve a common issue led to a major advancement.
 - Ⓓ Anderson's joy of traveling to new places influenced her to learn more about transportation.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s), implied or explicit, and its development throughout a text.

4. In Passage 1, what do the quotations from the patent application in paragraphs 7 and 9 reveal about Anderson?
- Ⓐ She was knowledgeable and could explain her invention.
 - Ⓑ She was focused on changing the outer appearance of a car.
 - Ⓒ She improved both the interior and exterior functions of a car.
 - Ⓓ She thought that her invention was similar to previous solutions.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey meaning in texts.

5. In Passage 1, how does the author develop the argument that the windshield wiper “remains one of the greatest safety inventions of the modern-day automobile” (paragraph 11)?
- Ⓐ by emphasizing how much money it made for its time period
 - Ⓑ by contrasting the way it originally worked with its present functions
 - Ⓒ by describing how troublesome it was for people in the past to design
 - Ⓓ by comparing how it improved visibility for drivers in the past and present

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Track the development of an argument, identifying the types of reasoning used.

6. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“When he opened the split glass, he was greeted with a burst of icy cold air and a blast of heavy, wet snow.” (paragraph 2)

How does this description emphasize the importance of Anderson’s invention?

- ☒ Ⓐ It shows that previous solutions were not good enough.
- ☐ Ⓑ It illustrates what it was like to ride a streetcar every day.
- ☐ Ⓒ It explains why engineers thought earlier ideas were successful.
- ☐ Ⓓ It reveals how streetcar drivers felt in different types of weather.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning in text(s).

7. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What conclusion can be made based on the descriptions of Anderson's personal life in paragraphs 24–28 of Passage 2?

- Ⓐ Anderson gained recognition as a result of waiting patiently for the right timing.
- Ⓑ Anderson understood that her ideas were hard to accept since they were unproven.
- Ⓒ Anderson focused on being successful so that she would be remembered by strangers.
- Ⓓ Anderson received less recognition than she deserved because of the time period in which she lived.

Part B

Select a sentence from Passage 2 that supports the answer in Part A.

- Ⓐ "On November 10 that same year, the United States Patent Office awarded Anderson patent number 743801 for her new device." (paragraph 24)
- Ⓑ "Sara-Scott Wingo says Anderson tried to interest manufacturing firms in making her windshield wipers for the emerging motor car industry, but no takers." (paragraph 24)
- Ⓒ "In reply, we regret to state we do not consider it to be of such commercial value as would warrant our undertaking its sale." (paragraph 25)
- Ⓓ "She didn't have a father. She didn't have a husband. And the world was kind of run by men back then." (paragraph 28)

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Answer Key: Part A: Option D and Part B: Option D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 34%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Track the development of an argument, identifying the types of reasoning used.

8. Read this paragraph from Passage 2.

29 PALCA: It doesn't seem as if Mary Anderson was crushed by the rejections. She lived another 50 years, long enough to see windshield wipers become ubiquitous. Wingo says her family is proud of Anderson's accomplishments.

What is the meaning of the word crushed as it is used in this paragraph?

- Ⓐ alarmed
- Ⓑ confused
- Ⓒ discouraged
- Ⓓ offended

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

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9. Select **two** ways Passage 2 develops the argument that Anderson deserved to be more widely known and supported during her lifetime.
- Ⓐ by describing how Anderson received a patent number from the “United States Patent Office” (paragraph 24)
 - Ⓑ by saying the manufacturing company “missed out” when it refused Anderson’s invention (paragraph 26)
 - Ⓒ by describing Anderson as an “independent woman” (paragraph 27)
 - Ⓓ by explaining that her current family members “talk about Mary Anderson a lot” (paragraph 30)
 - Ⓔ by explaining how Anderson “finally got some credit” when she was inducted into the Inventors Hall of Fame in 2011 (paragraph 31)

Answer Key: B, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Track the development of an argument, identifying the types of reasoning used.

- 10.** Fill in the bubbles to show each author’s purpose for writing about Anderson in Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
to show how Anderson’s achievements affected her family	☐ A	☒ B	☐ C
to describe how Anderson’s invention affected the world	☐ D	☐ E	☒ F
to give the scientific reasoning for the design elements of Anderson’s invention	☒ G	☐ H	☐ I

Answer Key: B, F, G

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze authors’ purpose(s) in multiple accounts of the same event or topic.

Passage 1: **from *To Sea: A Voyage of Discovery***

by Jeff Hendricks

Permissions were not secured for the use of this passage on a public website. For your reference, the citation for the passage and for items 11, 14, 15, and 16 is as follows: Jeff Hendricks, *To Sea: A Voyage of Discovery* (Columbus, OH: Highlights for Children, Inc. / Zaner-Bloser, Inc., 2019), 16-22.

Passage 2: Villanelle

by W. E. Henley

This poem was published in 1887.

1 Where's the use of sighing?
Sorrow as you may,
Time is always flying—

Flying!—and defying
5 Men to say him nay . . .
Where's the use of sighing?

Look! To-day is dying
After yesterday.
Time is always flying.

10 Flying—and when crying
Cannot make him stay,
Where's the use of sighing?

Men with by-and-bying,
Fritter life away.
15 Time is always flying,

Flying!—O, from prying
Cease, and go to play.
Where's the use of sighing,
“Time is always flying?”

*“Villanelle” by W. E. Henley, from *Ballades and Rondeaux, Chants Royal, Sestinas, Villanelles, &c.*, selected by Gleeson White. In the public domain.*

11. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“This was the beginning of a routine.” (paragraph 10)

What is the meaning of the word routine as it is used in the passage?

- Ⓐ agreeing to a plan with others
- Ⓑ developing a secret friendship
- Ⓒ making a decision to learn more
- Ⓓ following a repeated set of actions

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 83%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

12. How do the interactions between Juan and Ayva contribute to the development of Passage 1?

- Ⓐ They highlight the effects that music has on Juan and Ayva's relationship.
- Ⓑ They demonstrate how nature helps Juan and Ayva get to know each other.
- Ⓒ They allow Juan and Ayva to become friends despite having different backgrounds.
- Ⓓ They reveal that Juan and Ayva can form a connection when they speak the same language.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how the interaction between characters contributes to the development of a plot in a literary text.

13. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is a theme in Passage 1?

- ☒ Ⓐ Some friendships only last a short time.
- ☐ Ⓑ Generosity is given at unexpected times.
- ☐ Ⓒ Adventure provides hope for a better future.
- ☐ Ⓓ Holding on to regrets prevents success in life.

Part B

Which detail from Passage 1 helps develop the theme in Part A?

- ☐ Ⓐ Antonio's advice cheers up Juan.
- ☐ Ⓑ Juan is eager to sail with Antonio's crew.
- ☐ Ⓒ Ayva must offer Juan a gift equal to his flute.
- ☒ Ⓓ Juan must continue his journey without Ayva.

Answer Key: Part A: A and Part B: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the development of stated or implied theme(s) throughout a literary text.

14. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“She thought it would be like magic to wander across the ocean in those magnificent ships.” (paragraph 21)

What does the phrase “like magic” suggest about Ayva?

- Ⓐ She thinks sailing is strange.
- Ⓑ She likes the idea of adventure.
- Ⓒ She dreams of changing someday.
- Ⓓ She believes the ships are imaginary.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning in text(s).

15. Select **two** details from Passage 1 that show that Ayva is sad to see Juan go away.

- Ⓐ "When he finished, she turned to him and smiled broadly." (paragraph 15)
- Ⓑ "The fleet would be leaving tomorrow." (paragraph 16)
- Ⓒ "'*Gracias*, Juan,' she said. 'I . . . will miss you . . . very much.'" (paragraph 20)
- Ⓓ "They were so unlike her people's small canoes, carved from tree trunks." (paragraph 21)
- Ⓔ "'Here is something to remember me by,' she said and placed the necklace around Juan's neck." (paragraph 23)

Answer Key: C, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 76%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how the interaction between characters contributes to the development of a plot in a literary text.

16. Select **two** sentences from Passage 1 that show how Juan and Ayva became friends.

- Ⓐ "Then he looked up and saw a young native girl." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓑ "She didn't speak Spanish, and he didn't speak her language." (paragraph 7)
- Ⓒ "When he finished, she clapped her hands and giggled." (paragraph 7)
- Ⓓ "And each time Juan would head back to his ship, she would give him a warm smile." (paragraph 11)
- Ⓔ "The girl brushed her dark hair from her face, bowed her head slightly, and returned his greeting." (paragraph 14)

Answer Key: C, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how the interaction between characters contributes to the development of a plot in a literary text.

17. What effect does the repetition of the line “Where’s the use of sighing” have on Passage 2?

- Ⓐ It creates a desire to travel and visit new places.
- Ⓑ It emphasizes that focusing on the past is pointless.
- Ⓒ It notes that people will come and go as they please.
- Ⓓ It reminds everyone to find amusement in their situations.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Describe the impact of various poetic forms on meaning and style.

18. Read these lines from Passage 2.

“Men with by-and-bying,
Fritter life away.” (lines 13–14)

What does the author mean by the phrase “Fritter life away”?

- Ⓐ work toward goals
- Ⓑ eat and laugh merrily
- Ⓒ reflect on their wealth
- Ⓓ waste time and energy

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

19. In Passage 2, how does the author develop the theme that people should not regret the past?

- Ⓐ by sharing personal experiences
- Ⓑ by showing examples of a better life
- Ⓒ by asking if focusing on loss is helpful
- Ⓓ by explaining how relationships develop

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the development of stated or implied theme(s) throughout a literary text.

20. In Passage 2, what point is the author making by repeating the phrase “Time is always flying”?

- ☒ Ⓐ People should enjoy opportunities in life.
- ☐ Ⓑ People should reflect more on their past.
- ☐ Ⓒ People should pursue adventure in their lives.
- ☐ Ⓓ People should focus on preparing for future challenges.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 64%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Describe the impact of various poetic forms on meaning and style.

21. How does Passage 1 treat the idea of overcoming sad experiences differently than Passage 2 does?

- Ⓐ Passage 1 proves why it is important for people to mourn.
- Ⓑ Passage 1 shows how gifts allow people to hold on to memories.
- Ⓒ Passage 1 demonstrates that people’s feelings change over time.
- Ⓓ Passage 1 describes how a person’s attitude should be shaped by the past.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how authors from different time periods address the same or related topics.

from *The Phantom Tollbooth*

by Norton Juster

Permissions were not secured for the use of this passage on a public website. For your reference, the citation for the passage and for items 22, 24, 25, and 27 is as follows: Norton Juster, *The Phantom Tollbooth* (New York: Alfred A. Knopf, Inc., 1989), 171-176.

22. Read this sentence from the passage.

34 “That’s absurd,” objected Milo, whose head was spinning from all the numbers and questions.

How does the phrase “head was spinning” contribute to the meaning of the passage?

- Ⓐ It reveals that Milo thinks the Dodecahedron is funny.
- Ⓑ It expresses that Milo is confused by the math problems.
- Ⓒ It highlights that Milo is interested in discovering the truth.
- Ⓓ It implies that Milo thinks the Humbug needs help with math.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 78%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning in text(s).

23. What are **two** ways that the imagery in paragraph 7 contributes to the meaning of the passage?

- Ⓐ It reveals how unusual the Dodecahedron looks.
- Ⓑ It implies that Milo helped build the Dodecahedron.
- Ⓒ It describes how the Dodecahedron teaches numbers.
- Ⓓ It suggests that Milo and the Dodecahedron are similar.
- Ⓔ It introduces how the Dodecahedron expresses himself.

Answer Key: A, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning in text(s).

24. Read this sentence from the passage.

“‘That may be true,’ he acknowledged, ‘but it’s completely accurate, and as long as the answer is right, who cares if the question is wrong?’”
(paragraph 35)

The word “accurate” comes from the Latin root *accuratus*, meaning “done with care.” Based on the root, what is the definition of the word accurate?

- Ⓐ balanced
- Ⓑ correct
- Ⓒ finished
- Ⓓ interesting

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 74%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade-level content.

25. Which detail from the passage supports the theme that a person can learn to view the world differently through math?

- Ⓐ "As they argued, a most peculiar little figure stepped nimbly from behind the sign and approached them, talking all the while." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓑ "'Is that bad?' asked Milo, making sure it was still there." (paragraph 19)
- Ⓒ "'I never thought of it that way,' Milo admitted." (paragraph 23)
- Ⓓ "'I'm sure I don't know,' he replied, 'but if you did, you'd certainly know what to do with him.'" (paragraph 33)

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the development of stated or implied theme(s) throughout a literary text.

26. In paragraph 22, how does the Dodecahedron use a logical appeal?

- Ⓐ by describing why some shape names lead to frustration
- Ⓑ by suggesting how people ought to create their own names
- Ⓒ by suggesting why people should be named for their features
- Ⓓ by describing how authorities determine the names of objects

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Identify rhetorical appeals in a text.

27. Read this sentence from the passage.

“Perhaps if you look at the picture you’ll know what I mean.”
(paragraph 7)

How does the switch to addressing the reader affect the passage?

- Ⓐ It hints at the Dodecahedron’s opinions of other characters.
- Ⓑ It demonstrates the narrator’s feelings toward the Dodecahedron.
- Ⓒ It highlights the narrator’s limit of words to describe the Dodecahedron.
- Ⓓ It suggests that the other characters struggle to understand the Dodecahedron.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 38%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the influence of multiple narrators and/or shifts in point of view in a literary text.

28. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is revealed by the conversation between Milo, the Humbug, and Tock about the three different roads?

- Ⓐ The characters are tired from their long journey.
- Ⓑ The characters disagree about the right way to go.
- Ⓒ The characters are eager to meet new people in the city.
- Ⓓ The characters distrust the information presented on the sign.

Part B

How does the conversation in Part A affect the plot?

- Ⓐ It causes them to take a break.
- Ⓑ It causes them to take the shortest trip.
- Ⓒ It causes the Dodecahedron to talk to them.
- Ⓓ It causes the Dodecahedron to read the sign.

Answer Key: Part A: B and Part B: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 43%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how the interaction between characters contributes to the development of a plot in a literary text.

29. Which statement expresses a theme that is found in paragraphs 34–35 and 39–40?

- Ⓐ Difficult questions can lead to confusion.
- Ⓑ New people can make traveling impossible.
- Ⓒ Education is an easy way to make new friends.
- Ⓓ Choosing a path can be done without much thought.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the development of stated or implied theme(s) throughout a literary text.

Curious Kids: do cats and dogs understand us when we miaow¹ or bark?

by Quixi Sonntag

- 1 There's been a lot of research about communication between people and domestic animals like dogs and cats. But we don't yet have the answer to your very interesting question. We don't know what cats and dogs think or if they understand us when we use their noises.
- 2 As a veterinarian and animal behaviourist who studies different kinds of animals, my view is that we'd have to be very good at mimicking miaows and barks if we would really like to be understood by our pets. Our vocal cords are different to theirs, and they can hear that we make different sounds to what they do.
- 3 But we do know that dogs can definitely distinguish between different people's voices. They'll know when it's Mila who's talking, and when it's Alex. They're also sensitive to your tone of voice. They like high-pitched, friendly tones. And did you know that dogs can learn words?
- 4 Rico, a border collie, successfully learned more than 200 words representing different items. He could pick the correct item from all the items if asked to "fetch" whichever item. We do not think that he actually learnt the meaning of the words, but he was very good at associating different sounds with different objects.
- 5 When it comes to their own "voices," studies have shown that dogs and cats use different vocal signals to communicate different messages. A high-pitched, repetitive bark, for example, may mean your dog is anxious. A low-pitched bark may mean she's feeling aggressive. Cats also use certain sounds while hunting and others when relaxing.
- 6 But their "voices" are just one way in which dogs and cats communicate. They also use body language and tactile gestures—like coming to you for a pat, or nudging your hand with their nose when they want attention.
- 7 In the same way people also communicate using gestures and facial expressions. Research has shown that dogs are better than other species, like wolves, at interpreting our gestures and facial expressions.

¹miaow: an alternative spelling for the cat sound "meow"

Different communication forms

- 8 If you have dogs, you will have noticed that they're very sensitive to people's feelings and our ways of communicating. That's because they've evolved to live in close proximity with people.
- 9 Cats are not naturally social animals, but they also communicate with us and can be highly perceptive about what mood you're in and how you're feeling.
- 10 All of this is important when you think about the best ways to communicate with your dogs and cats. Since visual signals are really important to them, it's likely that they consider our body language, before listening to our sounds, so they can decide what it is that we're communicating.
- 11 Humans use language as our main means of communication. That's why we tend to want our pets to respond to our words. They certainly can learn to do this, as we have seen with Rico and thousands of other examples.
- 12 However, in many instances, they are actually responding to our body language cues and not the verbal cues we are using.
- 13 Take for example telling your dog to sit: most people say the word "sit," and at the same time point their finger at the dog. They think the dog sits because they are saying "sit"—but it's actually responding to the finger pointing. If you say the word "sit" without the hand gesture your dog will, in many cases, not sit. This proves how important body language is to dogs.
- 14 I would encourage everyone who owns pets, especially dogs, to learn more about their body language so that we can better interpret what they are trying to say to us. A common perception, for example, is that when a dog's tail is wagging it is always friendly. This is only true when the wag of the tail is wide and accompanied by a relaxed body. A dog whose tail is up in the air, with only the tip wagging, is actually saying "go away" and not "let's play."
- 15 The more time you spend learning your pets' body language and getting to know what different gestures mean, the more easily you'll be able to communicate with them—and you won't have to "miaow" or bark to do that.

"Curious Kids: do cats and dogs understand us when we miaow or bark?" by Quixi Sonntag, from theconversation.com. Licensed under the Creative Commons CC BY-ND 4.0 license.

30. Read this paragraph from the passage.

9 Cats are not naturally social animals, but they also communicate with us and can be highly perceptive about what mood you're in and how you're feeling.

The word "perceptive" comes from the Latin root *percipere*, meaning "obtain, gather," and the suffix *-ive*, meaning "tending to." Based on this information, what does perceptive mean as it is used in the passage?

- ☒ (A) aware
- ☐ (B) dependent
- ☐ (C) nosy
- ☐ (D) surprised

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 78%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade-level content.

31. How does the section **Different communication forms** contribute to the passage?

- Ⓐ It provides examples of ways pets express themselves when near other animals.
- Ⓑ It challenges the idea that animals use their own language when communicating with each other.
- Ⓒ It warns pet owners to listen closely to the sounds their pets make when responding to their commands.
- Ⓓ It shifts the discussion from verbal exchanges to other ways people and pets can understand one another.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey meaning in texts.

32. Ethos is an appeal used by writers to reveal their knowledge or credibility to the reader. Which detail from the passage uses an appeal to ethos?

- Ⓐ "As a veterinarian and animal behaviourist who studies different kinds of animals, my view is that we'd have to be very good at mimicking miaows and barks if we would really like to be understood by our pets." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓑ "But we do know that dogs can definitely distinguish between different people's voices. They'll know when it's Mila who's talking, and when it's Alex." (paragraph 3)
- Ⓒ "They certainly can learn to do this, as we have seen with Rico and thousands of other examples." (paragraph 11)
- Ⓓ "If you say the word 'sit' without the hand gesture your dog will, in many cases, not sit. This proves how important body language is to dogs." (paragraph 13)

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 62%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Identify rhetorical appeals in a text.

33. Select a way that paragraphs 6 and 7 add to the development of ideas in the passage.

- Ⓐ They provide the opinions of those who disagree with the author.
- Ⓑ They include a story from the author’s experience with her own pets.
- Ⓒ They introduce additional methods dogs and cats use to express messages to people.
- Ⓓ They explain people’s preference for keeping dogs and cats as pets instead of other animals.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 79%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey meaning in texts.

34. Which **two** details from the passage support the claim that imitating the sounds pets make is an ineffective way of communicating with them?

- Ⓐ "There's been a lot of research about communication between people and domestic animals . . ." (paragraph 1)
- Ⓑ "Our vocal cords are different to theirs, and they can hear that we make different sounds to what they do." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓒ "Cats also use certain sounds while hunting and others when relaxing." (paragraph 5)
- Ⓓ ". . . it's likely that they consider our body language, before listening to our sounds, so they can decide what it is that we're communicating." (paragraph 10)
- Ⓔ "That's why we tend to want our pets to respond to our words." (paragraph 11)

Answer Key: B, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Track the development of an argument, identifying the types of reasoning used.

35. What kind of rhetorical appeal does the author make in paragraph 4?

- Ⓐ an appeal to credibility by mentioning Rico's breed
- Ⓑ an appeal to logic by explaining the extent of Rico's abilities
- Ⓒ an appeal to ethics by suggesting that Rico made fair choices
- Ⓓ an appeal to emotion by telling how Rico made his owners proud

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 70%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Identify rhetorical appeals in a text.

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- 36.** Complete the table by matching each detail to the central idea it supports.

	People often misinterpret interactions with animals.	Pets observe and react to people's behavior.	Both Central Ideas
"If you have dogs, you will have noticed that they're very sensitive to people's feelings and our ways of communicating." (paragraph 8)	(A)	(B)	(C)
"However, in many instances, they are actually responding to our body language cues and not the verbal cues we are using." (paragraph 12)	(D)	(E)	(F)
"A common perception, for example, is that when a dog's tail is wagging it is always friendly. This is only true when the wag of the tail is wide and accompanied by a relaxed body." (paragraph 14)	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: B, F, G

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 27%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s), implied or explicit, and its development throughout a text.



Grade 8 Statewide Science Assessment

Test Release: 2024

1. Janice is learning about compounds. Which of the following **best** describes a compound?
- Ⓐ a substance made up purely of one element
 - Ⓑ a group of substances that are either acids or bases
 - Ⓒ a group of substances that can be separated by a physical change
 - Ⓓ a substance made up of two or more elements that are chemically combined

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 72%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

Benchmark: SC.8.P.8.8

Benchmark Description: Identify basic examples of and compare and classify the properties of compounds, including acids, bases, and salts.

2. Scientific theories are developed over time in all areas of science. Which statement **best** describes scientific theories?
- Ⓐ They are based on scientific laws that came first.
 - Ⓑ They are pieces of scientific evidence that support a hypothesis.
 - Ⓒ They are explanations of scientific events that may change based on continuous research.
 - Ⓓ They are predictions of events that usually remain constant because scientific ideas rarely change.

Answer Key: C

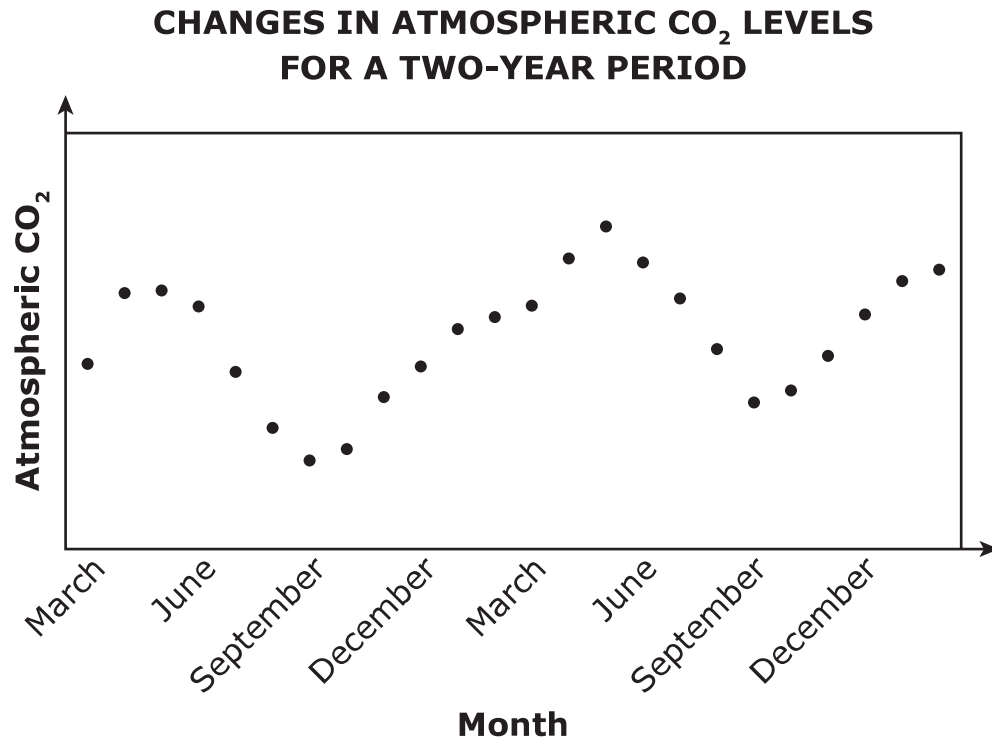
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: The Nature of Science

Benchmark: SC.8.N.3.2

Benchmark Description: Explain why theories may be modified but are rarely discarded.

3. Many interactions occur between the biosphere and the atmosphere. One of these interactions results in changes in atmospheric carbon dioxide (CO_2) levels. The graph below shows these changes over a two-year period.



Which of the following changes in the biosphere **most likely** caused these changes in the atmospheric CO_2 levels?

- Ⓐ Streams froze in the winter and melted in the spring.
- Ⓑ Plants grew leaves in the spring and lost leaves in the fall.
- Ⓒ Offspring were born in the summer and matured in the fall.
- Ⓓ Soil dried out in the summer and absorbed moisture in the winter.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.6.E.7.4

Benchmark Description: Differentiate and show interactions among the geosphere, hydrosphere, cryosphere, atmosphere, and biosphere.

4. Jordan adds some soil and plants to a large glass jar to build a terrarium. He waters the plants and then adds two snails, two crickets, and an earthworm to the jar. Jordan then places the lid tightly on the jar and sets it on a sunny windowsill. Based on the law of conservation of mass, which of the following is expected to occur inside Jordan's terrarium?
- Ⓐ The mass will increase as the plants grow and decrease when the snails eat the plants.
 - Ⓑ The mass will increase as the earthworm digests the soil.
 - Ⓒ The mass will decrease when the crickets die.
 - Ⓓ The mass will neither increase nor decrease.

Answer Key: D

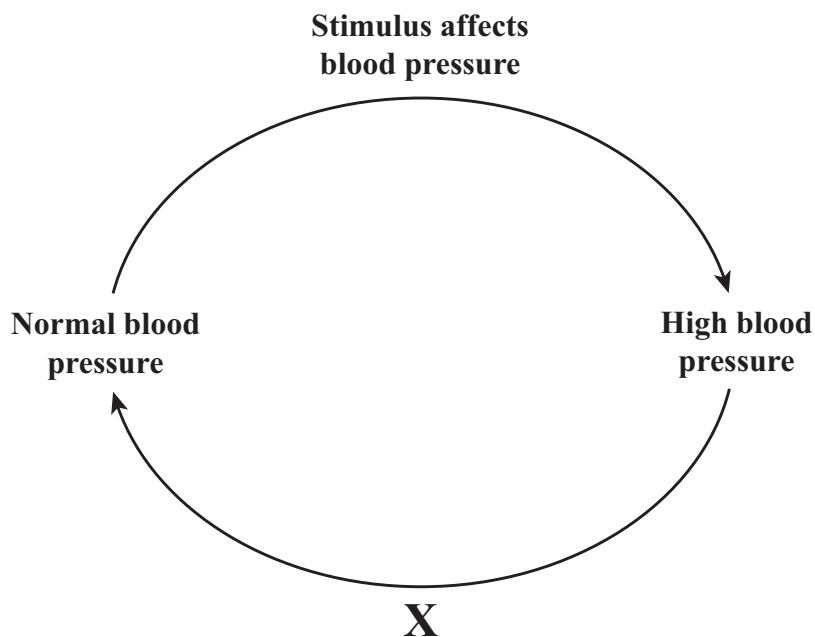
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 40%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.8.L.18.4

Benchmark Description: Cite evidence that living systems follow the Laws of Conservation of Mass and Energy.

5. Human body systems interact to keep blood pressure within a normal range. The diagram below represents this interaction.



Which of the following **best** describes what is occurring in part X of the diagram?

- Ⓐ Respiration remains high as other body systems work with the circulatory system.
- Ⓑ Blood pressure is regulated as the circulatory system shuts down other body systems.
- Ⓒ Blood pressure remains high as the circulatory system shuts down other body systems.
- Ⓓ Homeostasis is maintained as the other body systems work with the circulatory system.

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Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.6.L.14.5

Benchmark Description: Identify and investigate the general functions of the major systems of the human body (digestive, respiratory, circulatory, reproductive, excretory, immune, nervous, and musculoskeletal) and describe ways these systems interact with each other to maintain homeostasis.

6. The table below shows the range of frequencies, in Hertz (Hz), for part of the electromagnetic spectrum.

Region	Frequency (Hz)
Infrared	$3.0 \times 10^{12} - 4.3 \times 10^{14}$
Ultraviolet	$7.5 \times 10^{14} - 3.0 \times 10^{17}$
X-rays	$3.0 \times 10^{17} - 3.0 \times 10^{19}$
Gamma rays	$> 3.0 \times 10^{19}$

Which of the following types of radiation has the longest wavelength?

- Ⓐ Infrared
- Ⓑ Ultraviolet
- Ⓒ X-rays
- Ⓓ Gamma rays

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 25%

Reporting Category: Physical Science (Earth and Space Science)

Benchmark: SC.8.E.5.11

Benchmark Description: Identify and compare characteristics of the electromagnetic spectrum such as wavelength, frequency, use, and hazards and recognize its application to an understanding of planetary images and satellite photographs.

7. An astronomer observes a sunspot. Which of the following describes this feature of the Sun?
- Ⓐ a location where heat rises to the Sun's surface
 - Ⓑ a location that produces most of the Sun's heat energy
 - Ⓒ a location that is cooler than other parts of the Sun's surface
 - Ⓓ a location where energy and matter leave the Sun's atmosphere

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 36%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.8.E.5.6

Benchmark Description: Create models of solar properties, including rotation, structure of the Sun, convection, sunspots, solar flares, and prominences.

8. Ricky wants to finish constructing a chart that helps classify two organisms. The chart is shown below.

Question	Organism X	Organism Y
1. Does it require nutrients to survive?		
2. Does it have DNA?		
3. Do its cells lack cell walls?		
4. Can it reproduce?		

Accurately answering which question would **best** help distinguish these organisms as members of the animal kingdom rather than the plant or fungi kingdom?

- (A) 1
- (B) 2
- (C) 3
- (D) 4

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.6.L.15.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze and describe how and why organisms are classified according to shared characteristics, with emphasis on the Linnaean system combined with the concept of Domains.

9. Atoms are made up of subatomic particles, including neutrons. Which of the following describes a neutron?
- Ⓐ has a greater volume than the electron cloud
 - Ⓑ has more mass than the nucleus
 - Ⓒ has no charge
 - Ⓓ has no mass

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 62%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

Benchmark: SC.8.P.8.7

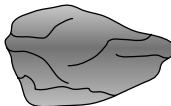
Benchmark Description: Explore the scientific theory of atoms (also known as atomic theory) by recognizing that atoms are the smallest unit of an element and are composed of sub-atomic particles (electrons surrounding a nucleus containing protons and neutrons).

10. Two groups of students hypothesized that rocks on Earth’s surface are damaged by acid rain.

- Group X tested the hypothesis by examining properties of some rocks and pouring a weak acid, vinegar, on each of the rocks.
- Group Y later repeated the same procedure with a different group of rocks.

The rocks used for the investigations and the results from each student group are shown below.

ROCKS TESTED

Group	Rock 1	Rock 2	Rock 3	Rock 4
X	 Calcite	 Dolostone	 Shale	 Limestone
Y	 Calcite	 Dolostone	 Dolostone	 Calcite

OBSERVATIONS OF THE ROCKS

Group	Number of Rocks Used	Average Mass of Rocks Used (grams)	Texture of Rocks	Reaction to Vinegar
X	4	46	3 rocks smooth 1 rock rough	3 rocks bubbled
Y	4	42	2 rocks smooth 2 rocks rough	4 rocks bubbled

Which of the following **best** describes an advantage Group X has over Group Y in supporting the hypothesis?

- Ⓐ Group X tested the rocks before Group Y did.
- Ⓑ Group X tested more rocks that are smoother.
- Ⓒ Group X tested rocks with a greater average mass.
- Ⓓ Group X tested a greater variety of rocks than Group Y did.

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Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 50%

Reporting Category: The Nature of Science

Benchmark: SC.6.N.1.4

Benchmark Description: Discuss, compare, and negotiate methods used, results obtained, and explanations among groups of students conducting the same investigation.

11. Mandy applies the brakes on her bicycle and stops quickly to avoid hitting a basketball that bounces into the street. Which of the following **best** explains what happens to the bicycle's kinetic energy?

- Ⓐ It increases because the tires make a screeching noise.
- Ⓑ It is destroyed because Mandy stops the bicycle quickly.
- Ⓒ It remains the same because Mandy is the source of energy.
- Ⓓ It is transformed to heat because the tires are slowed by friction.

Answer Key: D

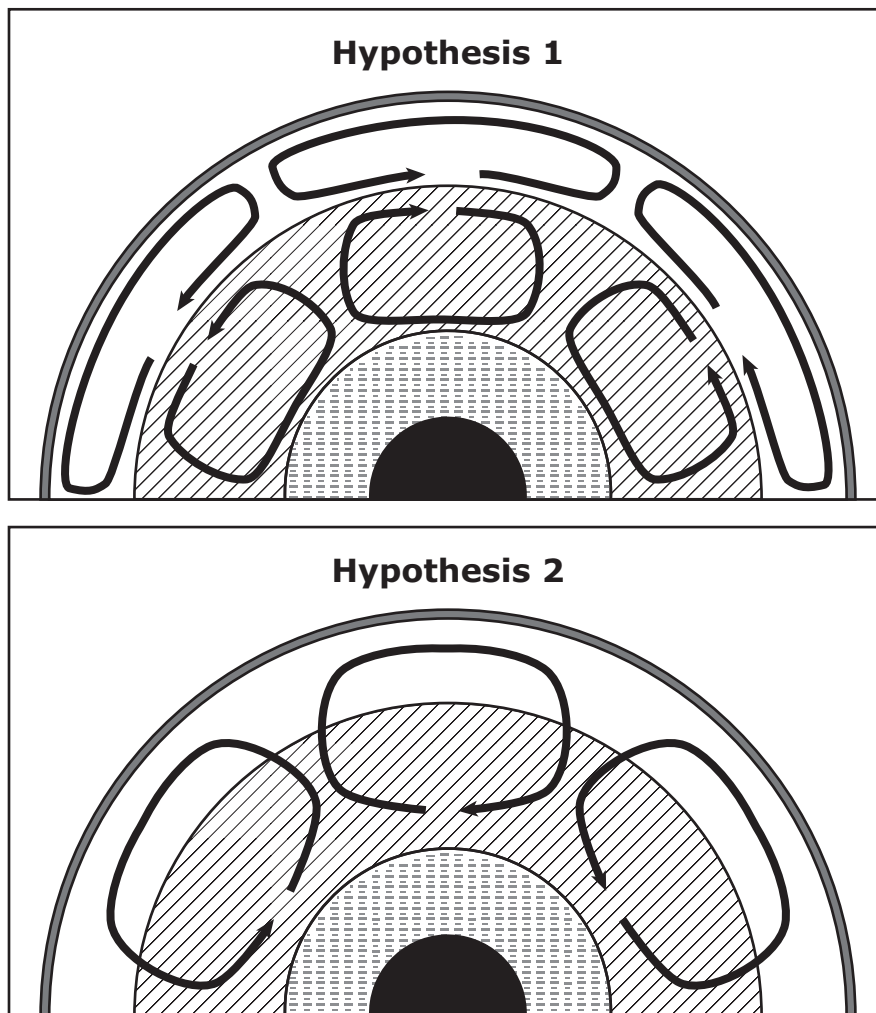
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

Benchmark: SC.7.P.11.3

Benchmark Description: Cite evidence to explain that energy cannot be created nor destroyed, only changed from one form to another.

12. The diagram shows two hypotheses for the same process that occurs beneath Earth's surface.



Which of the following processes is represented by these hypotheses?

- Ⓐ convection current movement in Earth's mantle
- Ⓑ plate movements in Earth's outer core
- Ⓒ layer separation in Earth's inner core
- Ⓓ rock formation in Earth's lithosphere

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.7.E.6.1

Benchmark Description: Describe the layers of the solid Earth, including the lithosphere, the hot convecting mantle, and the dense metallic liquid and solid cores.

13. North Atlantic right whales live in the ocean near the east coast of the United States and Canada. Fewer than 500 of these whales exist. Which of the following would contribute to the extinction of the North Atlantic right whales?

- Ⓐ Species that compete with right whales move to new habitats.
- Ⓑ Humans develop breeding programs for right whales in aquariums.
- Ⓒ The environment changes faster than right whale populations can adapt.
- Ⓓ New technologies prevent right whales from being caught in fishing gear.

Answer Key: C

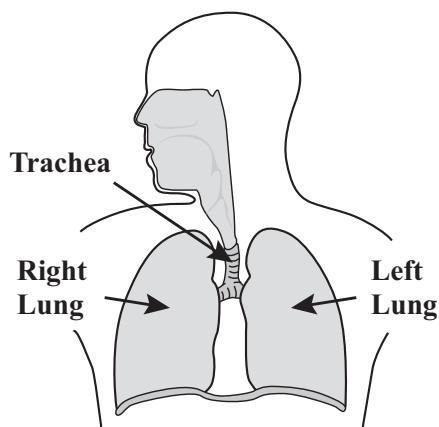
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.7.L.15.3

Benchmark Description: Explore the scientific theory of evolution by relating how the inability of a species to adapt within a changing environment may contribute to the extinction of that species.

14. The diagram below identifies three structures found in the human body.



Which level of organization describes each of these three structures?

- Ⓐ cell
- Ⓑ organ
- Ⓒ organism
- Ⓓ tissue

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 73%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.6.L.14.1

Benchmark Description: Describe and identify patterns in the hierarchical organization of organisms from atoms to molecules and cells to tissues to organs to organ systems to organisms.

15. A space probe lands on a planet that has half the pull of gravity as Earth. What effect does this have on the space probe's weight and mass?

- ☒ Ⓐ Its weight is reduced to half its weight on Earth, and its mass remains the same as on Earth.
- ☐ Ⓑ Its weight remains the same as on Earth, and its mass is reduced to half its mass on Earth.
- ☐ Ⓒ Both its weight and mass are half of what they are on Earth.
- ☐ Ⓓ Both its weight and mass remain the same as on Earth.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

Benchmark: SC.8.P.8.2

Benchmark Description: Differentiate between weight and mass recognizing that weight is the amount of gravitational pull on an object and is distinct from, though proportional to, mass.

16. Cells experience similar processes. One of these processes involves controlling cellular wastes. Why do cells undergo processes that control cellular wastes?

- Ⓐ All cells must release cellular wastes to maintain homeostasis.
- Ⓑ Plant cells eliminate cellular wastes to regulate the rate of cell reproduction.
- Ⓒ Animal cells extract energy from cellular wastes to perform cellular functions.
- Ⓓ All cells must release cellular wastes to provide a means of maintaining cell size.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.6.L.14.3

Benchmark Description: Recognize and explore how cells of all organisms undergo similar processes to maintain homeostasis, including extracting energy from food, getting rid of waste, and reproducing.

17. Nancy observes the Moon from the same location outside each night for one week. She notices that when it first appears each night, the Moon is a little farther east than it was the night before. Which of the following is one explanation for her observation?

- Ⓐ The Moon's speed of rotation changes as it revolves around Earth.
- Ⓑ The Moon revolves around Earth as Earth revolves around the Sun.
- Ⓒ The Moon and Earth take the same amount of time to complete one rotation.
- Ⓓ The Moon completes one rotation each time Earth completes one revolution.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.8.E.5.9

Benchmark Description: Explain the impact of objects in space on each other including:
1. the Sun on the Earth including seasons and gravitational attraction
2. the Moon on the Earth, including phases, tides, and eclipses, and the relative position of each body.

- 18.** Brittany is investigating plant growth. She completes the following activities in class.

Activity 1	Activity 2
1. Plant three identical seeds in each of four cups containing the same amount and type of soil. 2. Add different amounts of the same fertilizer to three of the cups and 50 milliliters (mL) of water to all of the cups. 3. When the seeds sprout, measure the height of the plants in each cup. 4. Record your data in a table.	1. Plant three identical seeds in each of four cups containing the same amount and type of soil. 2. Add 50 milliliters (mL) of water to each cup. 3. After the seeds sprout, examine the sprouts carefully with a magnifying lens. 4. Record a drawing of each of the sprouts in a chart.

Which statement **best** describes why activity 1 is an experiment and activity 2 is an investigation?

- ☒ (A) Only activity 1 has a control and variables.
- ☐ (B) Only activity 1 requires the adding of fertilizer.
- ☐ (C) Activity 1 requires more trials than activity 2 does.
- ☐ (D) Activity 1 takes more time to set up than activity 2 does.

Answer Key: A

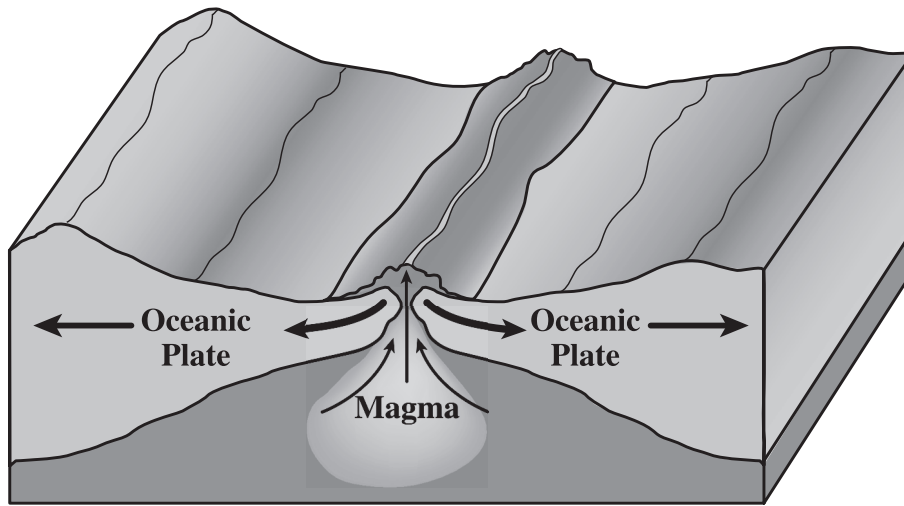
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 53%

Reporting Category: The Nature of Science

Benchmark: SC.7.N.1.3

Benchmark Description: Distinguish between an experiment (which must involve the identification and control of variables) and other forms of scientific investigation, and explain that not all scientific knowledge is derived from experimentation.

19. At a mid-ocean ridge, plates are pulled apart. Fracturing in the sea floor allows magma to move up from the mantle. The diagram below shows two plates that are moving apart



Which process in the rock cycle does this diagram **best** represent?

- Ⓐ chemical weathering of rocks
- Ⓑ erosion of sedimentary rocks
- Ⓒ compaction of melted rock
- Ⓓ formation of igneous rock

Answer Key: D

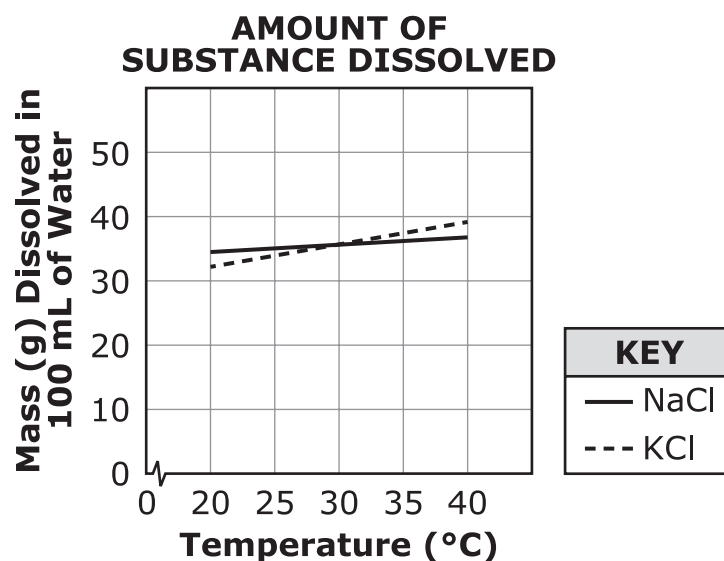
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.7.E.6.2

Benchmark Description: Identify the patterns within the rock cycle and relate them to surface events (weathering and erosion) and subsurface events (plate tectonics and mountain building).

20. Students compared the solubility of sodium chloride (NaCl) and potassium chloride (KCl) in water at different temperatures. They recorded their results as mass, in grams (g), dissolved in 100 milliliters (mL) of water at different temperatures, in degrees Celsius ($^{\circ}\text{C}$), as shown in the graph below.



Which statement **best** compares the solubility of these substances?

- Ⓐ KCl is more soluble at 20°C than NaCl is.
- Ⓑ Both substances are equally soluble at 30°C .
- Ⓒ KCl will become less soluble at temperatures greater than 40°C .
- Ⓓ Both substances have the same solubility from 20°C through 40°C .

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

Benchmark: SC.8.P.8.4

Benchmark Description: Classify and compare substances on the basis of characteristic physical properties that can be demonstrated or measured; for example, density, thermal or electrical conductivity, solubility, magnetic properties, melting and boiling points, and know that these properties are independent of the amount of the sample.

21. Alligators are found throughout Florida. Some of the characteristics of alligators are listed below.

- They are usually found in slow-flowing rivers.
- Females live in a small area.
- They eat fish, snails, birds, frogs, and mammals.
- Males live in areas of more than five square kilometers.
- They reduce their level of activity during winter.
- Females make large nests and protect their young.

Which limiting factor in an ecosystem would have the **greatest** impact on the alligator populations in Florida?

- ☒ (A) reduction of shelter and nesting sites
- ☐ (B) diseases that affect a certain frog species
- ☐ (C) competition among male alligators for a mate
- ☐ (D) increase in the rate of water flowing in a river

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 56%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.7.L.17.3

Benchmark Description: Describe and investigate various limiting factors in the local ecosystem and their impact on native populations, including food, shelter, water, space, disease, parasitism, predation, and nesting sites.

22. Wanda lists some heat transfers that can occur in an ocean, as shown below.

1. Warm water moves upward, and cold water moves downward.
2. Energy from the Sun heats the ocean's surface.
3. Warm air transfers heat to the ocean as it blows across the ocean's surface.
4. A stream of hot water from an opening on the ocean floor heats the water that touches the stream.

Which description from Wanda's list **best** represents radiation?

- Ⓐ 1
- Ⓑ 2
- Ⓒ 3
- Ⓓ 4

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 66%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.6.E.7.1

Benchmark Description: Differentiate among radiation, conduction, and convection, the three mechanisms by which heat is transferred through Earth's system.

23. Scientists who investigate microscopic fossils are known as micropaleontologists. Which of the following would these scientists **most likely** study?

- Ⓐ the rocks that identify the location of ancient continents
- Ⓑ the evidence of changes in the climate of ancient Earth
- Ⓒ the different elevations of the surface of ancient Earth
- Ⓓ the rocks that contain evidence of ancient organisms

Answer Key: D

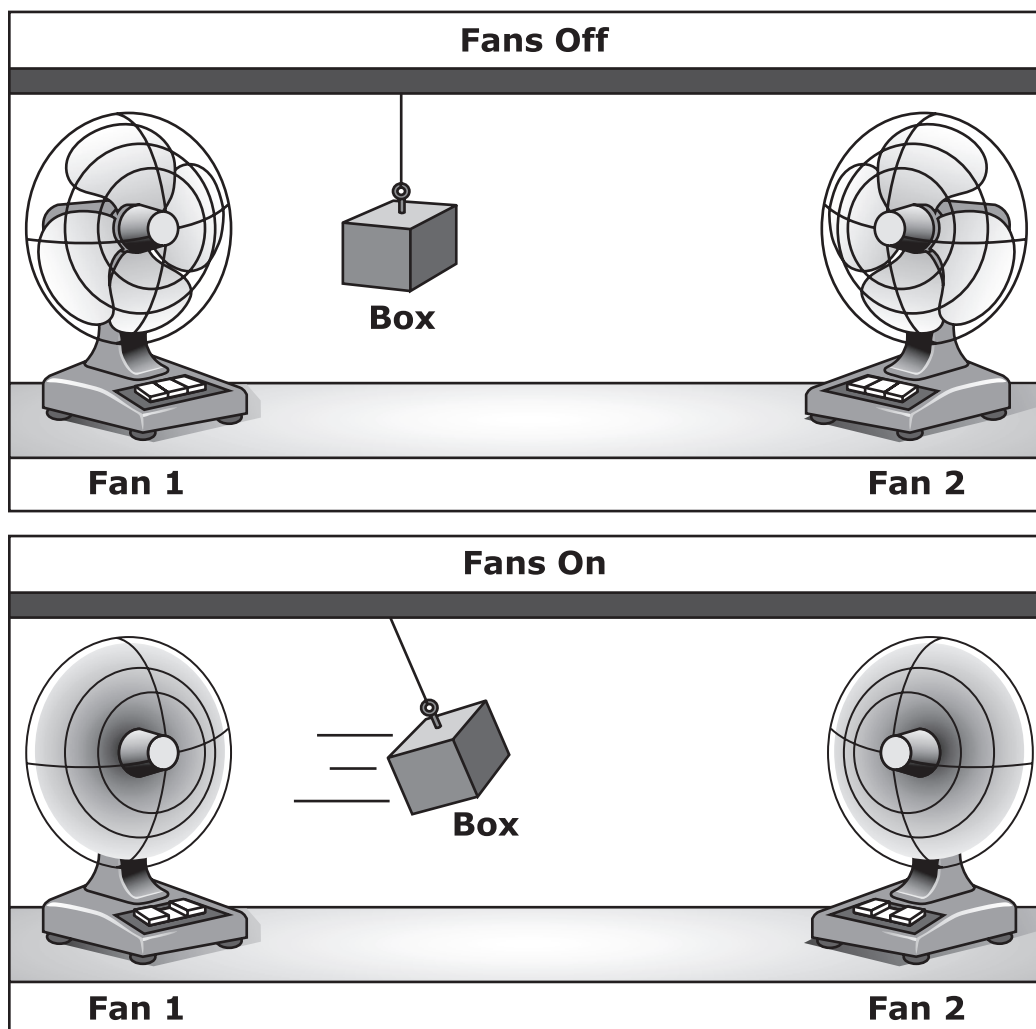
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 72%

Reporting Category: The Nature of Science

Benchmark: SC.7.N.1.5

Benchmark Description: Describe the methods used in the pursuit of a scientific explanation as seen in different fields of science such as biology, geology, and physics.

24. Joanna and Mason hang a small box from a string and place two identical electric fans near the box. When they turn on both fans to the same setting, Joanna and Mason observe that the box begins to swing toward the right, as shown in the illustration below.



Joanna claims that she can balance the forces on the box without turning off the fans. Which of the following would **most likely** produce the change in motion necessary to support Joanna's claim?

- Ⓐ Change the angle of Fan 2 so that it is blowing air onto the bottom of the box.
- Ⓑ Move Fan 2 so that both fans are blowing air onto the left side of the box.
- Ⓒ Change the setting of Fan 2 so that it is blowing less air than Fan 1 is.
- Ⓓ Move Fan 2 so that it is the same distance from the box as Fan 1 is.

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Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 77%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

Benchmark: SC.6.P.13.3

Benchmark Description: Investigate and describe that an unbalanced force acting on an object changes its speed, or direction of motion, or both.

25. The Andromeda Galaxy was previously called the Great Andromeda Nebula because astronomers thought this patch of light was composed of glowing gases. In the 1900s, scientists determined the nebula was actually a spiral galaxy. Which of the following describes the relationship between this galaxy and other astronomical bodies?

- Ⓐ This galaxy is the largest star and is found in the universe.
- Ⓑ This galaxy is surrounded by thousands of stars in the universe.
- Ⓒ This galaxy includes a universe that is composed of millions of stars.
- Ⓓ This galaxy is one of billions of galaxies in the universe and contains billions of stars.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.8.E.5.2

Benchmark Description: Recognize that the universe contains many billions of galaxies and that each galaxy contains many billions of stars.

26. Throughout history, scientific knowledge has changed. Which of the following resulted in an important change in scientific knowledge?

- Ⓐ the observation of phase changes of the Moon
- Ⓑ the discovery of the function of the DNA molecule
- Ⓒ the development of a hypothesis describing possible life on Mars
- Ⓓ the prediction of when a comet would be most clearly visible from Earth

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 56%

Reporting Category: The Nature of Science

Benchmark: SC.7.N.2.1

Benchmark Description: Identify an instance from the history of science in which scientific knowledge has changed when new evidence or new interpretations are encountered.

27. Cassandra flashes a beam of white light toward a prism. The prism separates the white light into different colors. Which of the following causes the separation of the white light?

- Ⓐ The white light is concentrated.
- Ⓑ The white light is absorbed.
- Ⓒ The white light is refracted.
- Ⓓ The white light is reflected.

Answer Key: C

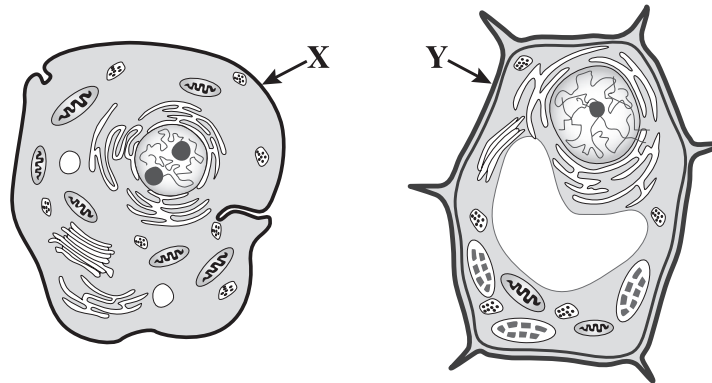
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

Benchmark: SC.7.P.10.2

Benchmark Description: Observe and explain that light can be reflected, refracted, and/or absorbed.

- 28.** Nyles used a microscope to observe two different types of cells. Drawings of the two cells are shown below.



Which of the following **best** contrasts the functions of the cell parts labeled X and Y?

- Ⓐ Part X stores water for future use, whereas part Y releases water out of the cell.
- Ⓑ Part X holds the structures in place in the cell, whereas part Y keeps all molecules from leaving the cell.
- Ⓒ Part X provides energy for the cell, whereas part Y helps with photosynthesis in the presence of sunlight.
- Ⓓ Part X regulates substances that enter or exit the cell, whereas part Y provides protection and support to the cell.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 56%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.6.L.14.4

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast the structure and function of major organelles of plant and animal cells, including cell wall, cell membrane, nucleus, cytoplasm, chloroplasts, mitochondria, and vacuoles.

29. A student claims that studying rock layers on the side of a mountain would show that Earth has changed over geologic time. Which type of evidence from the rock layers **best** supports this claim?

- Ⓐ Some rock layers are solid, and other rock layers have holes that store water.
- Ⓑ Rock layers that are composed of sand and silt are found in different locations.
- Ⓒ Rock layers that are thick and smooth are deeper than rock layers that are thin and rough.
- Ⓓ Some rock layers contain fossils of plants, and other rock layers contain fossils of marine animals.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.7.E.6.4

Benchmark Description: Explain and give examples of how physical evidence supports scientific theories that Earth has evolved over geologic time due to natural processes.

30. In 1980, a scientific journal published an article describing the observations that led to a hypothesis. The hypothesis stated that an asteroid striking Earth brought about the extinction of the dinosaurs. Which of the following would **best** provide support for a scientific hypothesis?

- Ⓐ opinions and personal beliefs
- Ⓑ new evidence and personal opinions
- Ⓒ new evidence and additional observations
- Ⓓ additional observations and informed predictions

Answer Key: C

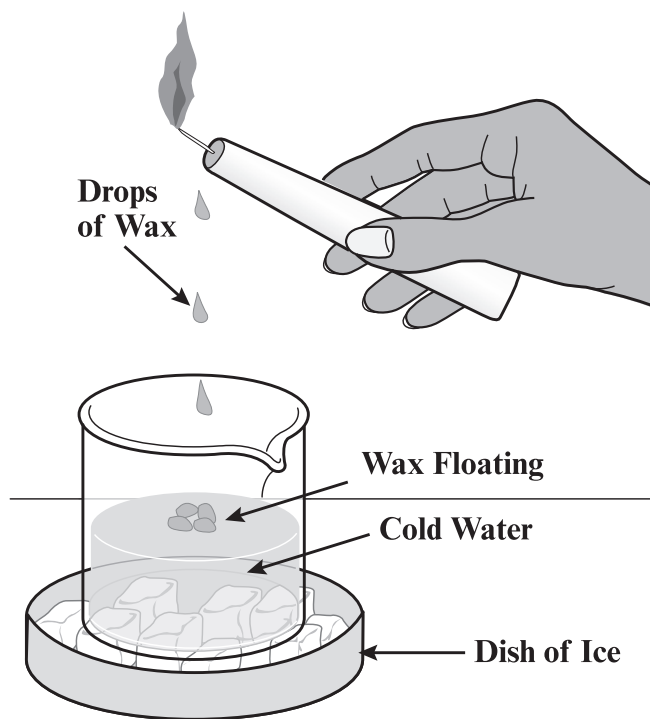
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: The Nature of Science

Benchmark: SC.8.N.1.6

Benchmark Description: Understand that scientific investigations involve the collection of relevant empirical evidence, the use of logical reasoning, and the application of imagination in devising hypotheses, predictions, explanations and models to make sense of the collected evidence.

31. Ms. Brooks demonstrated phase changes to her class. She lit a candle and let the melting wax drop into a beaker of cold water, as shown below. The temperature of the water was four degrees Celsius (4°C).



Which statement **best** explains what happened to the wax as it came in contact with the cold water in the beaker?

- Ⓐ The wax changed from a liquid to a solid as it gave off heat to its surroundings.
- Ⓑ The wax changed from a liquid to a solid as it increased in temperature.
- Ⓒ The wax remained in the liquid phase as it decreased in temperature.
- Ⓓ The wax remained in the liquid phase as it absorbed heat.

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Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

Benchmark: SC.7.P.11.1

Benchmark Description: Recognize that adding heat to or removing heat from a system may result in a temperature change and possibly a change of state.

32. The planet Saturn takes 10,747 Earth days to complete one orbit around the Sun. Why does Saturn take longer to complete one orbit around the Sun than Earth does?

- Ⓐ Saturn has stronger gravity.
- Ⓑ Saturn is farther from the Sun.
- Ⓒ Saturn has a thicker atmosphere.
- Ⓓ Saturn is the only planet with rings.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 76%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.8.E.5.7

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast the properties of objects in the Solar System, including the Sun, planets, and moons to those of Earth, such as gravitational force, distance from the Sun, speed, movement, temperature, and atmospheric conditions.

33. A group of students slowly poured 100 milliliters (mL) of vegetable oil, 100 mL of colored water, and 100 mL of corn syrup into a 500-mL beaker. The students observed the beaker after 5 minutes and recorded their observations in their science notebooks. Which of the following are the students **most likely** trying to compare?

- Ⓐ the volume of the liquids
- Ⓑ the density of the liquids
- Ⓒ the weight of the liquids
- Ⓓ the color of the liquids

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: The Nature of Science

Benchmark: SC.8.N.1.1

Benchmark Description: Define a problem from the eighth grade curriculum using appropriate reference materials to support scientific understanding; plan and carry out scientific investigations of various types, such as systematic observations or experiments; identify variables; collect and organize data; interpret data in charts, tables, and graphics; analyze information; make predictions; and defend conclusions.

34. A chemist observes a reaction between two substances in a closed container. Which of the following would **most likely** happen if the temperature is increased inside the container?

- Ⓐ The rate of the reaction would increase.
- Ⓑ The mass of each of the atoms would increase.
- Ⓒ The two substances would release nuclear energy.
- Ⓓ The two substances would not change into different compounds.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

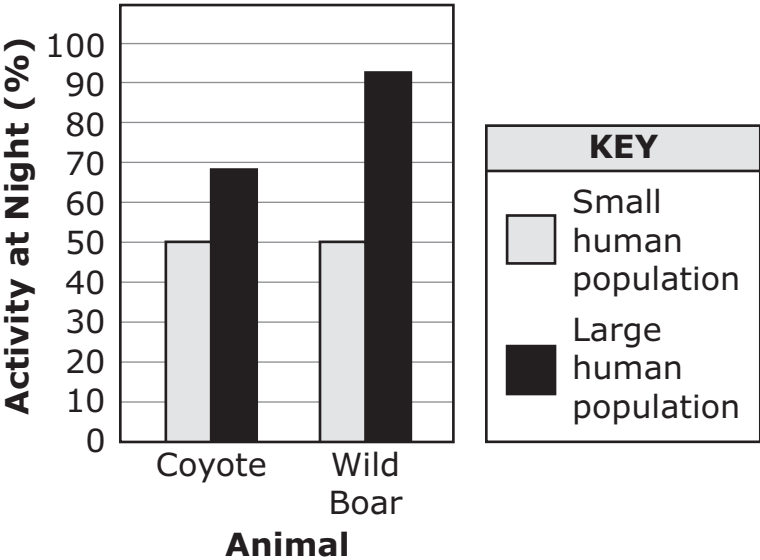
Benchmark: SC.8.P.9.3

Benchmark Description: Investigate and describe how temperature influences chemical changes.

Animal Activity

Coyotes and wild boars are animals that are active during the day and night. Both animals live in areas where human populations are increasing. Scientists collected data from various areas worldwide and concluded that the amount of coyote and wild boar activity is related to the population size of humans. The percentage of activity that occurs at night in different habitats is shown in Figure 1.

FIGURE 1: ANIMAL ACTIVITY IN TWO HABITATS



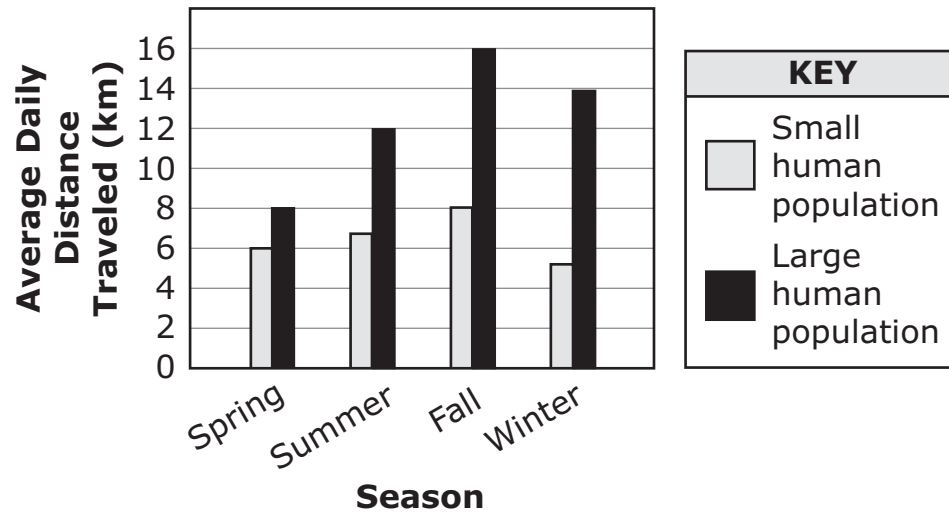
Scientists in California collected coyote droppings in habitats with small and large human populations. They used these data to determine the time of day and night that coyotes consumed prey. The scientists’ data are shown in Table 1.

TABLE 1: PREY EATEN BY COYOTES IN TWO HABITATS

Human Population in Habitat	Percentage of Droppings That Contained Each Type of Prey	
	Prey Active during the Day	Prey Active during the Night
Small population	68%	81%
Large population	47%	100%

Scientists in Poland used radio collars to track the movements of wild boars in each type of habitat during different times of year. The average daily distances wild boars traveled in each habitat, in kilometers (km), are shown in Figure 2.

FIGURE 2: AVERAGE DAILY DISTANCE TRAVELED BY WILD BOARS



35. To answer this question, refer to the “Animal Activity” passage, figures, and table.

Which of these is the **most** important role of technology in the wild boar study?

- Ⓐ reducing bias during analysis and interpretation of the data
- Ⓑ producing graphs from the averages calculated by researchers
- Ⓒ collecting data over long periods of time and across great distances
- Ⓓ controlling external variables that are difficult for researchers to observe

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 56%

Reporting Category: The Nature of Science (Earth and Space Science)

Benchmark: SC.8.E.5.10

Benchmark Description: Assess how technology is essential to science for such purposes as access to outer space and other remote locations, sample collection, measurement, data collection and storage, computation, and communication of information.

36. To answer this question, refer to the “Animal Activity” passage, figures, and table.

Coyotes share their habitats with gray foxes, which are related to coyotes and are active at night. Gray foxes eat plants and animals, including some of the same animals that coyotes eat. Which of the following describes the **most likely** effect that coyotes have on gray foxes in locations with large human populations?

- Ⓐ decreased exposure to parasites and disease
- Ⓑ increased protection from larger predators
- Ⓒ decreased cooperation when finding food
- Ⓓ increased competition over prey species

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.7.L.17.2

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast the relationships among organisms, such as mutualism, predation, parasitism, competition, and commensalism.

37. To answer this question, refer to the “Animal Activity” passage, figures, and table.

Which statement describes how humans in an expanding city **most likely** affect the wild boars that live nearby?

- Ⓐ Humans decrease the effect that natural predators have on wild boars.
- Ⓑ Humans remove the plants that wild boars rely on for food and shelter.
- Ⓒ Humans create new ponds and lakes that wild boars must travel around.
- Ⓓ Humans increase the area of fields available for wild boars and other wildlife.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.7.E.6.6

Benchmark Description: Identify the impact that humans have had on Earth, such as deforestation, urbanization, desertification, erosion, air and water quality, and changing the flow of water.

38. All plants and animals have threadlike structures in the nucleus of each cell. These structures contain a set of instructions in the form of DNA. Which of the following terms identifies these threadlike structures?

- Ⓐ alleles
- Ⓑ chromosomes
- Ⓒ cytoplasm
- Ⓓ mitochondria

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.7.L.16.1

Benchmark Description: Understand and explain that every organism requires a set of instructions that specifies its traits, that this hereditary information (DNA) contains genes located in the chromosomes of each cell, and that heredity is the passage of these instructions from one generation to another.

39. Earth's atmosphere is important to the living organisms of the biosphere. Which of the following describes how the atmosphere **best** protects living organisms?

- Ⓐ by providing enough carbon dioxide in the ocean to support sea animals
- Ⓑ by changing oxygen into nitrogen, which can be used as a nutrient for animals
- Ⓒ by refracting visible light, allowing certain animals to see and capture their prey
- Ⓓ by trapping electromagnetic radiation, keeping temperatures within a range best suited for animal life

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.6.E.7.9

Benchmark Description: Describe how the composition and structure of the atmosphere protects life and insulates the planet.

- 40.** A yeast is a single-celled organism that can reproduce sexually or asexually. Which of the following would confirm that a yeast had reproduced asexually?
- Ⓐ offspring with its own unique genetic information unlike that of the parent
 - Ⓑ offspring with the same genetic information as each of its two parents
 - Ⓒ offspring with half the genetic information from each of two parents
 - Ⓓ offspring with the same genetic information as the parent

Answer Key: D

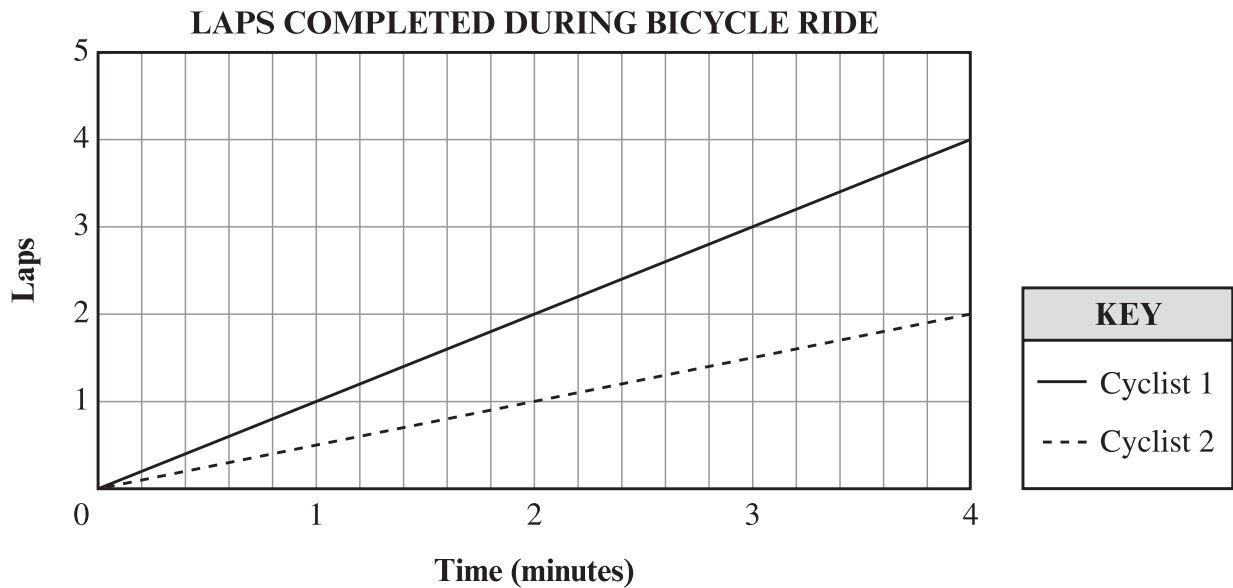
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.7.L.16.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast the general processes of sexual reproduction requiring meiosis and asexual reproduction requiring mitosis.

41. Two Olympic cyclists rode their bicycles on an oval track. The graph below represents the number of 500-meter laps they completed.



Based on the graph, which statement **best** describes the motion of the cyclists as they rode their bicycles?

- Ⓐ Both cyclists made stops about halfway through their rides.
- Ⓑ Both cyclists rode their bicycles at about the same speed.
- Ⓒ Cyclist 1 rode about twice as fast as Cyclist 2.
- Ⓓ Cyclist 2 made more stops than Cyclist 1.

Answer Key: C

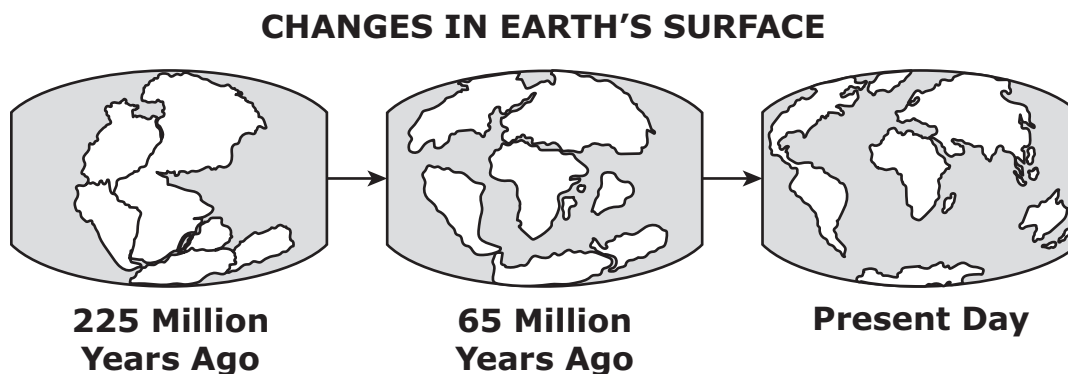
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 77%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

Benchmark: SC.6.P.12.1

Benchmark Description: Measure and graph distance versus time for an object moving at a constant speed. Interpret this relationship.

42. Scientists have collected large amounts of evidence that support the idea shown in the illustration below.



Which of the following is a scientific theory that is **best** supported by this evidence?

- Ⓐ evolution
- Ⓑ superposition
- Ⓒ plate tectonics
- Ⓓ universal gravitation

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 66%

Reporting Category: The Nature of Science

Benchmark: SC.7.N.3.1

Benchmark Description: Recognize and explain the difference between theories and laws and give several examples of scientific theories and the evidence that supports them.

43. A scientist observes six lady beetles of the same species that live in the same location. Each of the lady beetles is a different shade of orange or yellow, and each has a different number of black spots. Which statement **most likely** explains how these differences relate to the evolution of the lady beetle species?

- Ⓐ These differences show that the species may learn to adapt to a warmer and drier climate.
- Ⓑ These differences show that damage to plants in the habitat has caused the species to develop additional spots.
- Ⓒ These differences show that mutations have developed in the population as the species was exposed to pollutants.
- Ⓓ These differences show that there is genetic variation in the population that may allow the species to survive changes to its habitat.

Answer Key: D

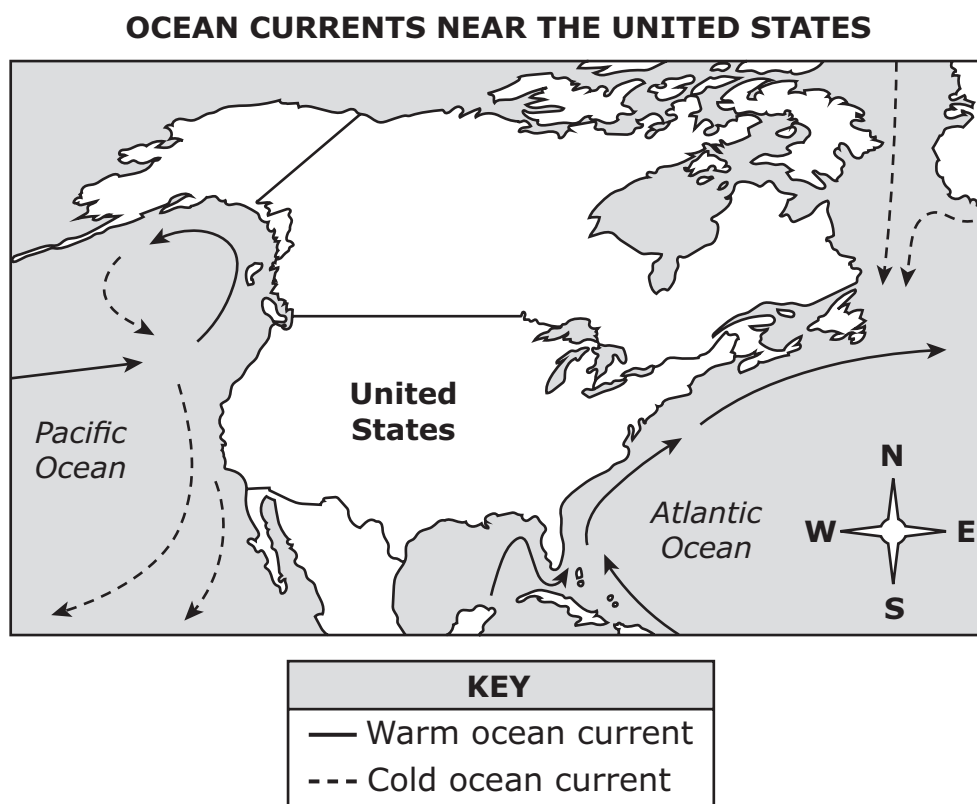
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 70%

Reporting Category: Life Science

Benchmark: SC.7.L.15.2

Benchmark Description: Explore the scientific theory of evolution by recognizing and explaining ways in which genetic variation and environmental factors contribute to evolution by natural selection and diversity of organisms.

44. Ocean currents in the Pacific Ocean and the Atlantic Ocean affect climate and weather patterns in the United States. The map below shows some of these ocean currents.



A student researches climate data and determines that the eastern United States usually has higher humidity than the western United States does. Based on the ocean currents shown, which statement **best** explains the difference in humidity?

- Ⓐ The air mass in the Atlantic Ocean is warmer than the air mass in the Pacific Ocean is, and a warmer air mass holds more water vapor than a colder air mass does.
- Ⓑ The air mass in the Pacific Ocean is colder than the air mass in the Atlantic Ocean is, and a colder air mass causes more evaporation than a warmer air mass causes.
- Ⓒ The cold ocean current in the Pacific Ocean causes stronger winds than the warm ocean current in the Atlantic Ocean causes, and moisture evaporates from the Pacific Ocean air mass.
- Ⓓ The warm ocean current in the Atlantic Ocean produces denser air masses than the cold ocean current in the Pacific Ocean produces, and the dense air mass in the Atlantic Ocean cannot release precipitation.

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Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Earth and Space Science

Benchmark: SC.6.E.7.3

Benchmark Description: Describe how global patterns such as the jet stream and ocean currents influence local weather in measurable terms such as temperature, air pressure, wind direction and speed, and humidity and precipitation.

- 45.** Dionne observes her science teacher testing a sample of an unknown substance. She recorded her observations in the table shown below.

Test	Characteristic Observed	Yes	No
1	Melts when heated		X
2	Breaks into smaller pieces	X	
3	Dissolves in water		X
4	Reacts with vinegar	X	

Which test would provide evidence of a chemical change?

- Ⓐ 1
- Ⓑ 2
- Ⓒ 3
- Ⓓ 4

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Physical Science

Benchmark: SC.8.P.9.2

Benchmark Description: Differentiate between physical changes and chemical changes.



Grade 10 FAST ELA Reading

Test Release: 2024

Passage 1: from *Gods and Heroes*

by Carl Friedrich Becker and Ferdinand Schmidt

This is the myth of Sisyphus, who tried to outsmart the Greek gods and was sentenced to push a boulder up a mountain for all eternity.

1 Sisyphus was in the same dreadful place. In the upper world he had been guilty of thefts both among men and the gods. In the very hour of his death he perpetrated an evil deed. He seized and bound Thanatos, the god of death, with brazen bands, and for a long time no one died on earth. The gods of the underworld sent to Zeus this message: "Behold Thanatos, who went to the upper world to bring Sisyphus here, has not returned. For several days no shade¹ has entered our dark kingdom." Thereupon Zeus sent for the powerful war god, Ares, and ordered him to find the god of death. He soon found and released him from his fetters, and Sisyphus was taken to the underworld by Thanatos. Even then he continued his deceitful deeds. He said to his wife: "Do not bury my body and make the customary death offering to the gods of the underworld." Then he appeared before Hades and Persephone and said: "My wife has not buried my body and has neglected to make the death offering. Let me go to her and remind the faithless one of her duty. Then I surely will return."

2 His wish was granted and he returned to the upper world. As he did not come back, word was again sent to Zeus, who dispatched the swift-flying Hermes to take the deceiver back. When Sisyphus saw the divine messenger, his courage gave way, for he knew that no mortal could outdo him in cunning. Hermes took him back to the dark kingdom, where a fearful penalty awaited him. He had to roll a huge block of marble up a high mountain which no sooner reached the top than it went thundering down. He had to begin his task over again with sweat of toil and anguish dropping from his brow to the earth.

¹shade: spirit

Excerpt from *Gods and Heroes* by Carl Friedrich Becker and Ferdinand Schmidt. In the public domain.

Passage 2: Scarabaeus Sisyphus

by Mathilde Blind

This poem describes the scarab, a type of beetle that creates balls of mud in order to feed.

1 I've watched thee, Scarab! Yea, an hour in vain
I've watched thee, slowly toiling up the hill,
Pushing thy lump of mud before thee still
With patience infinite and stubborn strain.
5 Strive as thou mayest, spare neither time nor pain.
To screen thy burden from all chance of ill;
Push, push, with all a beetle's force of will,
Thy ball, alas! rolls ever down again.

Toil without end! And why? That after thee
10 Dim hosts of groping Scarabs too shall climb
This self-same height? Accurséd progeny
Of Sisyphus, what antenatal crime
Has doomed us too to roll incessantly
Life's Stone, recoiling from the Alps of time?

"Scarabaeus Sisyphus" by Mathilde Blind, from Poetical Works of Mathilde Blind. In the public domain.

Passage 3: Sisyphus's Confession

In this poem, the author imagines what Sisyphus might have said if he could explain his actions and his understanding of the Greek mythological afterlife.

15 I'll admit, the first few times were agony (pure anguish).
I could barely move that rock and felt my hope near-extinguish.
Slow step by step, I heaved my burden and tried to set my will.
Drip, drap, drop, the gods cackled as I sweated on that hill.

I let them laugh, even stumbled a bit to encourage them to jest.
20 I made a great show of huffing and heaving and all the rest.
They bought it, of course, thanks to their hubris.
They assume I suffer—that no mortal would choose this.

Why do you think I wanted to outwit death—
that I cared if I took another breath?
25 Here, my lungs toil tirelessly, my limbs are lead,
but what an alternative to being dead!

In body and in flesh, no man can truly live forever.
But let the world know my deeds, or simply that I was clever.
Whether here or there, all will know the name
30 of Sisyphus, who nearly beat the gods at their own game.

Who—no, what would I be had I accepted my lot?
A dark shadow, incapable of even a single thought.
Give me the struggle, then the satisfaction,
Even resentment is better than facing oblivion.

35 Now I set my hardened, calloused shoulder
into the familiar dips and valleys of my boulder.
I feel a smirk threaten to spread across my face.
Finally, the kind of storied destiny I can truly embrace.

But this quiet kind of contentment, I dare not let show.
40 What would the gods do next, should they know?

"Sisyphus's Confession" written for educational purposes.

1. Read these sentences from Passage 1.

“. . . ‘My wife has not buried my body and has neglected to make the death offering. Let me go to her and remind the faithless one of her duty. Then I surely will return.’” (paragraph 1)

How does Sisyphus’s statement add irony to the passage?

- Ⓐ He is shaming her for neglect even though he abandoned her.
- Ⓑ He is asking to remind her even though he is the one who forgot.
- Ⓒ He is calling his wife faithless even though he is the deceitful one.
- Ⓓ He is speaking of duty even though he is avoiding his responsibility to her.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how key elements enhance or add layers of meaning and/or style in a literary text.

2. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which **two** universal themes are present in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ teamwork as salvation
- Ⓑ accountability for actions
- Ⓒ trickery as rebellious behavior
- Ⓓ change of fate as a result of devotion
- Ⓔ the emptiness of attaining an immoral goal

Part B

How are the universal themes in Part A related?

- Ⓐ They connect emotions to decisions.
- Ⓑ They link decisions to condemnation.
- Ⓒ They show the effects of achievement.
- Ⓓ They demonstrate a method of achievement.

Answer Key: B, C and B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 24%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze and compare universal themes and their development throughout a literary text.

3. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“When Sisyphus saw the divine messenger, his courage gave way, for he knew that no mortal could outdo him in cunning.” (paragraph 2)

How does this description create a hopeless mood?

- ☒ (A) It shows that Sisyphus yields because he realizes his future is inescapable.
- ☐ (B) It reveals that Sisyphus relents because he has already proven his strength.
- ☐ (C) It implies that Sisyphus resists because he knows the messenger is powerful.
- ☐ (D) It shows that Sisyphus surrenders because he does not have time to make a plan.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 50%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how figurative language creates mood in text(s).

4. Read the excerpt from Passage 2.

"I've watched thee, Scarab! Yea, an hour in vain
I've watched thee, slowly toiling up the hill," (lines 1–2)

What does the repetition in these lines reveal?

- Ⓐ the importance of the beetle's work
- Ⓑ the speaker's fascination with the beetle
- Ⓒ the attention that the beetle pays to its task
- Ⓓ the relationship of the speaker to the beetle

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 42%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze how authors create multiple layers of meaning and/or ambiguity in a poem.

5. Read these lines from Passage 2.

“This self-same height? Accurséd progeny / Of Sisyphus, what
antenatal crime” (lines 11–12)

The root word “ante” means “previous.” What does antenatal crime reference in these lines?

- Ⓐ the fault of those born over time
- Ⓑ the error of those born before us
- Ⓒ the offense of being born on time
- Ⓓ the injustice of being born too soon

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of etymology and derivations to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade level content.

6. Passage 2 offers an alternative interpretation of Sisyphus’s struggle from Passage 1. How does this reinterpretation affect the meaning of Passage 2?
- Ⓐ It affirms how important the struggle is.
 - Ⓑ It reveals the difficulty of the experience.
 - Ⓒ It exposes the insignificance of the struggle.
 - Ⓓ It highlights that the experience is universal.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 21%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze how mythical, classical, or religious texts have been adapted.

7. How does stanza 2 of Passage 3 develop a different aspect of Sisyphus's experience than the version in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ In Passage 3 he is continuing to fool the gods.
- Ⓑ In Passage 3 he is steadily improving at his task.
- Ⓒ In Passage 3 he is putting in more physical effort.
- Ⓓ In Passage 3 he is enjoying the happiness of the gods.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze how mythical, classical, or religious texts have been adapted.

8. What does the word oblivion mean as it is used in line 34 of Passage 3?

- Ⓐ the state of being confused
- Ⓑ the state of being forgotten
- Ⓒ the shape and length of time
- Ⓓ the position and order of loss

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 50%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

9. What idea is left unclear in the final stanza of Passage 3?

- Ⓐ what consequence would truly punish Sisyphus
- Ⓑ what motivates Sisyphus to continue his deception
- Ⓒ whether Sisyphus truly suffered while doing his task
- Ⓓ whether Sisyphus brought about his own punishment for glory

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze how authors create multiple layers of meaning and/or ambiguity in a poem.

10. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the mood in Passage 3?

- Ⓐ peaceful
- Ⓑ smug
- Ⓒ vengeful
- Ⓓ weary

Part B

Which line from Passage 3 shows how the mood in Part A is developed through figurative language?

- Ⓐ “Drip, drap, drop, the gods cackled as I sweated on that hill.” (line 18)
- Ⓑ “Here, my lungs toil tirelessly, my limbs are lead” (line 25)
- Ⓒ “into the familiar dips and valleys of my boulder.” (line 36)
- Ⓓ “Finally, the kind of storied destiny I can truly embrace.” (line 38)

Answer Key: B and D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 21%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how figurative language creates mood in text(s).

11. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

How has the character of Sisyphus in Passage 3 changed from the original work in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ Sisyphus rests in peace.
- Ⓑ Sisyphus ends his suffering.
- Ⓒ Sisyphus retains his free will.
- Ⓓ Sisyphus disrespects the gods.

Part B

Select **two** lines from Passage 3 that support the answer in Part A.

- Ⓐ "I'll admit, the first few times were agony (pure anguish)." (line 15)
- Ⓑ "I could barely move that rock and felt my hope near-extinguish." (line 16)
- Ⓒ "Drip, drap, drop, the gods cackled as I sweated on that hill." (line 18)
- Ⓓ "Who—no, what would I be had I accepted my lot?" (line 31)
- Ⓔ "But this quiet kind of contentment, I dare not let show." (line 39)

Answer Key: C and D, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 18%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze how mythical, classical, or religious texts have been adapted.

Remarks at the 1964 Dedication of the Smithsonian Institution's Museum of History and Technology

by Lyndon B. Johnson

- 1 The gathering of knowledge is the supreme achievement of man.
- 2 Four hundred years ago, Francis Bacon could immodestly declare:
"I have taken all knowledge to be my province." Bacon would find this
new Museum of History and Technology of the Smithsonian Institution
to his taste, and to his aims.
- 3 For I believe this new museum will do that which causes us all to
celebrate: it will excite a thirst for knowledge—and to promote it for
all the people.
- 4 My earliest predecessor, George Washington, in a letter to the
officers of the American Philosophical Society, founded in Philadelphia
by Franklin, wrote these words:
- 5 "If I have a wish ungratified, it is that the arts and sciences may
continue to flourish with increasing lustre."
- 6 It was also Washington who said, in his Farewell Address:
- 7 "Promote, then, as an object of primary importance, institutions
for the general diffusion of knowledge. In proportion as the
structure of a government gives force to public opinion, it should be
enlightened."
- 8 So it pleases me a great deal tonight to come here to perform
the role of dedicator in this building of knowledge which is the inheritor
of all that has gone before.
- 9 Here, for all to see and for all to absorb, will be exhibited the
pageant of history of a youthful nation that is today as it was when
Jefferson described it: "In the full tide of successful experiment."
- 10 I would hope that there will come to this building the children of
the Nation. For here is recorded, as William Faulkner expressed it, the
agony and the sweat of the human spirit, the victory of the freedom
and the genius of our country. Here, young children see, with their
own eyes, yes, even touch with their own hands, the ripe fruit of
America's historical harvest.
- 11 Whitney's cotton gin, Singer's sewing machine, McCormick's
reaper, Edison's phonograph, Bell's telephone—they are all here, a part
of this treasure-house of our inheritance.
- 12 The more we understand the meaning of the past, the more we
appreciate the winning of the future.

- 13 I hope that every schoolchild who visits this Capital, every foreign visitor who comes to this First City, and every doubter who hesitates before the onrush of tomorrow will, some way, spend some time in this great museum. In truth, this new museum could become an open window through which could look the children of Asia and Western Europe and South America and the Soviet Union.
- 14 What greater thrust toward peace is there than the invitation to young people of the world, particularly those behind the Iron Curtain, to come visit us and to see this museum of history?
- 15 Why not open our historical doors and let the visitors see what kind of people we really are—and what sort of people we really come from?
- 16 They would instantly realize that we were not always the affluent nation and the powerful nation and the fortunate nation. From the exhibits in this museum they would learn that the demagogues' dingy slogans around the world have no real basis in fact.
- 17 Our ancestors moved across the prairies, working to build something where nothing existed before. Yes, this museum would show to the skeptics and the doubters that what we have today was wrenched out of the earth and the sweat of pioneers who, in the face of a thousand disappointments, refused to ever abandon the American dream.
- 18 We would show the visitors from the newly emerging nations that their labors are not in vain—for the future belongs to those who work for it. Let them go back to their home secure in the knowledge that from coarse and barren beginnings come the fulfillments of hope. They will have seen the evidence here.
- 19 If this museum did nothing more than illuminate our heritage so that others could see a little better our legacy, however so small the glimpse, it would fulfill a most noble purpose.
- 20 I am so glad to be here with you tonight.
- 21 I am always glad to be where America is.

"Remarks at the Dedication of the Smithsonian Institution's Museum of History and Technology"
by Lyndon B. Johnson. In the public domain.

12. Select the word that comes from the Latin root for “light, brightness.”

- 4 My earliest Ⓐ predecessor, George Washington, in a letter to the officers of the American Ⓑ Philosophical Society, founded in Philadelphia by Franklin, wrote these words:
- 5 “If I have a wish Ⓒ ungratified, it is that the arts and sciences may continue to Ⓓ flourish with increasing Ⓔ lustre.”

Answer Key: E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of etymology and derivations to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade level content.

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- 13.** Complete the table to indicate which role each section has in the development of ideas in the passage.

	Paragraph 1	Paragraphs 2–3	Paragraphs 4–7
establishing how museums can be considered patriotic	(A)	(B)	(C)
providing a claim about why the museum should be celebrated	(D)	(E)	(F)
placing the function of museums among humankind’s other accomplishments	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: C, E, G

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 41%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze the impact of multiple text structures and the use of features in text(s).

14. The word “diffusion” comes from the Latin word for “pour out.” Based on this information, what is the meaning of diffusion as it is used in paragraph 7?

- Ⓐ gathering
- Ⓑ leak
- Ⓒ research
- Ⓓ spread

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of etymology and derivations to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade level content.

15. How does Johnson use quotations to support his credibility?

- Ⓐ He implies that he is popular among his peers.
- Ⓑ He provides expert opinions on a topic unfamiliar to him.
- Ⓒ He shows he has considered the opinions of his opponents.
- Ⓓ He suggests that other notable figures would agree with him.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 64%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author's use of rhetoric in a text.

16. How does paragraph 11 support the central idea that the museum will have an impressive collection?

- Ⓐ by listing the more expensive exhibits
- Ⓑ by describing the most popular exhibits
- Ⓒ by highlighting historically important exhibits
- Ⓓ by ranking the inventors responsible for the exhibits

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 76%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s) of historical American speeches and essays.

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17. How do the rhetorical questions in paragraphs 14 and 15 support Johnson’s argument?

- Ⓐ They imply that Johnson is open to hearing suggestions from others.
- Ⓑ They imply that Johnson is telling the audience something they already know.
- Ⓒ They imply that Johnson is confident in his position about the museum’s importance.
- Ⓓ They imply that Johnson thinks some people may benefit more from the museum than others.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author’s use of rhetoric in a text.

18. How does Johnson’s reference to other countries in paragraph 18 support his rhetoric?

- Ⓐ It appeals to logic by identifying which countries need help.
- Ⓑ It appeals to logic by emphasizing which countries he has visited.
- Ⓒ It appeals to emotions by identifying parallels with other countries.
- Ⓓ It appeals to emotions by emphasizing the barriers between countries.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author’s use of rhetoric in a text.

19. Read these paragraphs from the passage.

20 I am so glad to be here with you tonight.

21 I'm always glad to be where America is.

How does the rhetoric in these paragraphs support Johnson's overall purpose?

- Ⓐ The logical appeal provides a new conclusion.
- Ⓑ The logical appeal summarizes the argument.
- Ⓒ The emotional appeal adds a final speculation.
- Ⓓ The emotional appeal creates a personal connection.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author's choices in establishing and achieving purpose(s) in historical American speeches and essays.

20. Select **two** ways in which Johnson creates emotional appeals to support his purpose.

- ☒ Ⓐ He shares his hopes in order to be inspirational.
- ☐ Ⓑ He generalizes about countries in order to educate his audience.
- ☐ Ⓒ He uses the conditional “if” to express uncertainty about the future.
- ☐ Ⓓ He uses the general “they” in order to exclude people he does not like.
- ☒ Ⓔ He uses the plural “we” in order to encourage the audience to agree with him.

Answer Key: A, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author’s choices in establishing and achieving purpose(s) in historical American speeches and essays.

21. How does Johnson’s exaggeration throughout the passage support the central idea that the museum is necessary?

- ☒ (A) It suggests that the museum will have a strong impact on people.
- ☐ (B) It suggests that the museum will last for a long time into the future.
- ☐ (C) It suggests that the museum was created because he believed in it.
- ☐ (D) It suggests that the museum is unlike anything else already in existence.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 74%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s) of historical American speeches and essays.

***from* The Piano Lesson**

by August Wilson

Permissions were not secured for the use of this passage on a public website. For your reference, the citation for the passage and for items 23, 24, and 28 is as follows: August Wilson, *The Piano Lesson* (New York: New American Library, 1988, 1990), Act 1, Scene 2.

22. What does the dialogue in paragraphs 13–15 reveal about Boy Willie?
Select **two** answers.

- Ⓐ He secretly worries that he is doing the wrong thing.
- Ⓑ He is dismissive of others' concerns about his actions.
- Ⓒ He feels the need to keep people from becoming close to him.
- Ⓓ He appreciates hearing other peoples' thoughts before he acts.
- Ⓔ He needs to appear strong and in control in front of other people.

Answer Key: B, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how key elements enhance or add layers of meaning and/or style in a literary text.

23. Read this paragraph from the passage.

20 BERNIECE: That's just what I'm gonna do. Wining Boy, you want me to fry you some pork chops?

How does this paragraph develop the universal themes of honoring the past and caring for family?

- Ⓐ by narrowing Berniece's focus to the family's tangible concerns
- Ⓑ by having Berniece exclude Boy Willie from a family discussion due to his lack of respect
- Ⓒ by showing that Berniece considers the desires of both her living and deceased family members
- Ⓓ by contrasting Berniece's and Boy Willie's willingness to let the other members of the family make the decision

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze and compare universal themes and their development throughout a literary text.

24. Read the sentences from the passage.

“Then that be something else, I’d have to go on and say, well, Berniece using that piano. She building on it. Let her go on and use it.”
(paragraph 21)

What is the meaning of the phrase “building on it” as it is used in the passage?

- Ⓐ designing something on top of
- Ⓑ purchasing something to match it
- Ⓒ establishing something by utilizing it
- Ⓓ constructing something out of the parts of

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 82%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

25. What effect does Berniece’s use of repetition in paragraph 22 have on the passage?

- Ⓐ It helps shift Berniece’s argument from the family’s past to its present.
- Ⓑ It shows that Berniece is unwilling to listen to the arguments of others.
- Ⓒ It reinforces the emotional weight that the piano held for Berniece’s mother.
- Ⓓ It supports the idea that Berniece is the best judge of what should happen to the piano.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 76%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how key elements enhance or add layers of meaning and/or style in a literary text.

26. How does paragraph 22 develop Boy Willie and Berniece’s different perspectives on the family? Select **two** answers.

- Ⓐ by showing that they each remember their childhoods very differently
- Ⓑ by showing that they each identify more closely with one of their parents
- Ⓒ by showing that they have learned competing lessons from their childhoods
- Ⓓ by showing that they have conflicting feelings about the importance of the family
- Ⓔ by showing that they have different reasons for wanting to spend less time with family

Answer Key: B, C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 10%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze coming of age experiences reflected in a text and how the author represents conflicting perspectives.

27. What effect does the connection between Sutter’s Ghost and the piano have on the passage?

- Ⓐ It provides an additional reason for the family to want the piano gone.
- Ⓑ It reinforces the idea that the past has an ongoing influence on the present.
- Ⓒ It indicates that the family only has a limited amount of time to make a decision.
- Ⓓ It suggests that keeping the piano will have unforeseen consequences for everyone.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how key elements enhance or add layers of meaning and/or style in a literary text.

28. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

How does the passage develop the universal themes of accountability to family and the acceptance of responsibility?

- Ⓐ Berniece prefers to focus on taking care of others and ignores Boy Willie's questions about the piano.
- Ⓑ Berniece and Boy Willie each check with other members of the family to try to gain support for their plans.
- Ⓒ Berniece and Boy Willie both want to do what is right for their family but have different ideas of how to do that.
- Ⓓ Boy Willie finds an alternative method of getting money while Berniece refuses to consider their financial obligations.

Part B

Select **two** details from the passage that support the answer in Part A.

- Ⓐ "Just as soon as I get them watermelons out that truck." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓑ "This is me and Berniece's piano. Am I right, Doaker?" (paragraph 10)
- Ⓒ "Money can't buy what that piano cost. You can't sell your soul for money." (paragraph 18)
- Ⓓ "Papa Boy Charles brought that piano into the house. Now, I'm supposed to build on what they left me." (paragraph 21)
- Ⓔ "You always talking about your daddy but you ain't never stopped to look at what his foolishness cost your mama." (paragraph 22)

Answer Key: C and C, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 33%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze and compare universal themes and their development throughout a literary text.

Passage 1: H.R. 51: Making D.C. the 51st State

by Representative Elijah E. Cummings

This is the opening statement of Representative Elijah E. Cummings of Maryland, chairman of the U.S. House Committee on Oversight and Reform, at a hearing about a bill to make certain portions of Washington, D.C., the 51st state of the United States.

1 I am extremely proud that our committee is holding the first hearing on D.C. Statehood in the House of Representatives in more than 25 years. Neither chamber of Congress has ever passed a Statehood bill. I hope ours will be the first.

2 H.R. 51 now has 220 cosponsors, which is a record for any previous D.C. Statehood bill. For the first time in a generation, there is real and sustained momentum behind this effort. This legislation would fulfill the promise of democracy for more than 700,000 Americans who call Washington, D.C., their home.

3 D.C. residents are American citizens. . . . They pay taxes. Not many people know this, but D.C. pays more in total Federal taxes than the residents of 22 states. And it pays more per capita than any state in the Nation.

4 D.C. residents have all of the responsibilities of citizenship, but they have no congressional voting rights and only limited self-government. These fundamental disparities for hundreds of thousands of Americans are inconsistent with the core principles embodied in our Constitution.

5 When our Nation was founded, it was based on the belief that no people should be subjected to taxation without representation or be governed without their consent. The Boston Tea Party was one of the most famous illustrations of this fight, refusing to accept laws and taxes in which they had no say.

6 Everyone on this panel, in this room, and across the country should be able to agree with this core value. . . .

7 There is nothing more fundamental in a democracy than the right to vote. As the Supreme Court has said—and I am quoting the Court—“No right is more precious in a free country than that of having a voice in the election of those who make the laws under which, as good citizens, we must live. Other rights, even the most basic, are illusory if the right to vote is undermined.”

8 In President Dwight D. Eisenhower’s 1956 State of the Union

address, he said this. “Once again, I ask the Congress to join with me in demonstrating our belief in the right of suffrage. I renew my request that the principle of self-government be extended and the right of suffrage granted to the citizens of the District of Columbia.”

9 Today, more than 60 years after President Eisenhower said those words, D.C. residents overwhelmingly support Statehood. In 2016, an astonishing 86 percent voted in favor of becoming a state.

10 The Congress now has an opportunity to live up to the Constitution’s goals. Statehood will give D.C. residents full and equal democratic rights. . . .

11 Today, I urge all members of this panel to rise above our partisan differences and think through this issue on the merits. I urge everyone to have a respectful and robust debate with the fundamental goals of our Founding Fathers at the forefront of our debate.

12 As President Abraham Lincoln declared in the Gettysburg Address, “A true democracy is government of the people, by the people, and for the people.”

Excerpt from “H.R. 51: Making D.C. the 51st State” by Representative Elijah E. Cummings, September 19, 2019. In the public domain.

Passage 2: Equality for the District of Columbia: Discussing the Implications of S. 132, the New Columbia Admission Act of 2013

by Senator Tom Coburn

This is the opening statement of U.S. Senator Tom Coburn of Oklahoma at a hearing about passing a bill to make a new state out of Washington, D.C., called “New Columbia.”

13 Since 1888, there have been hundreds of bills and amendments proposed to address D.C. representation. Since 1964, Congress has held no less than 10 hearings on it.

14 The House debated statehood in 1992. They heard from over a dozen witnesses and got another 20 opinions from every segment of the government.

15 Witnesses identified numerous problems, from constitutional to financial to administrative. The 1992 minority staff report does an excellent job of laying them out.

- 16 Yet here we are again debating this issue, even though it has no chance of success in this chamber, and is dead on arrival in the House.
- 17 This bill makes a state out of the neutral land that houses the Federal government. It's unprecedented.
- 18 Yet little effort was made to hold a hearing that seriously debates this bill.
- 19 More than half the witnesses are D.C. politicians, all with the same agenda and voicing the same interests.
- 20 With the exception of a witness I invited, none of the witnesses here provide an alternate opinion.
- 21 You can learn a lot about the seriousness of this hearing by looking at who is not here.
- 22 Where is the Department of Justice?
- 23 Every Department of Justice that has issued a report or testified about legislated D.C. statehood—(Kennedy, Carter, Reagan, Bush, Sr.) has concluded it is unconstitutional and would come with other extremely complex legal challenges.
- 24 Where is CBO, OMB, the Interior, Transportation, State, Defense, the General Services Administration, and Treasury?
- 25 D.C. statehood would significantly affect the Federal government's operations including: use and access to water and sewer services, utilities, police and fire services, infrastructure, communication networks, D.C. National Guard, D.C.'s unfunded liabilities and other benefits, and ability to control the aesthetics and condition of our nation's capital.
- 26 D.C. statehood would also come at an unknown cost to the U.S.
- 27 Who is representing the interests of other states?
- 28 D.C. statehood would significantly affect the sovereignty of other states, becoming the first among equals.
- 29 Nothing in the bill prevents New Columbia from still getting the special funding D.C. gets, approximately \$674 million each year just by virtue of being the nation's capital.
- 30 D.C. residents got more than eight times the national average of federal aid per capita, and more than two times the next highest state.
- 31 Who is here to represent Virginia and Maryland?
- 32 There is a serious question as to whether Maryland's consent would be necessary to create a new state, since it gave the land to be the Capital.

- 33 The bill even gives New Columbia control over certain land in Virginia and Maryland, a serious affront to their sovereignty.
- 34 D.C. residents suffer an injustice by not having a vote, but Congress can't bypass the constitutional amendment process simply because it's inconvenient.
- 35 The framers¹ designed the district to be an autonomous federal area, separate from any state's influence and different from all other federal land. It is patently false to say the framers could not have predicted the city would thrive: the District was envisioned prior to 1800 as a large, powerful city with 800,000 people—more than D.C. has now, and more than even Paris had at the time.
- 36 President Kennedy's Attorney General² said Congress can't reduce the district's size any more than it can remove a state from the Union.
- 37 Attorney General Kennedy said a small enclave clearly does not meet the concept of the permanent seat of government, which the framers held.
- 38 President Reagan's Attorney General said he would recommend the President veto any bill providing statehood without a constitutional amendment.

¹framers: the authors of the Constitution

²President Kennedy's Attorney General: Robert F. Kennedy

Excerpt from "Equality for the District of Columbia: Discussing the Implications of S. 132, the New Columbia Admission Act of 2013" by Senator Tom Coburn, September 15, 2014. In the public domain.

29. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“Other rights, even the most basic, are illusory if the right to vote is undermined.” (paragraph 7)

What is the meaning of illusory as it is used in this sentence?

- ☒ (A) meaningless
- ☐ (B) simplistic
- ☐ (C) unlawful
- ☐ (D) unwise

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 82%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

30. In paragraphs 5 through 9 of Passage 1, how does Cummings support the central idea that a bill for D.C. statehood is ready to be passed?

- Ⓐ by emphasizing the hope that came from previous bills
- Ⓑ by explaining that the bill will reduce taxes on residents
- Ⓒ by demonstrating the demand for such a bill among citizens
- Ⓓ by claiming that members of Congress are eager to vote for the bill

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s) of historical American speeches and essays.

31. In Passage 1, what strategy does Cummings frequently use to add an emotional appeal to his argument?

- ☒ Ⓐ emphasizing American ideals
- ☐ Ⓑ investigating American history
- ☐ Ⓒ confirming American greatness
- ☐ Ⓓ presenting data about American voters

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author's use of rhetoric in a text.

32. Select **two** approaches that Cummings uses to create a favorable opinion about H.R. 51 in Passage 1.

- Ⓐ sharing the expectation of greater government revenue
- Ⓑ fostering a sense of unified purpose among representatives
- Ⓒ presenting the bill as something that will correct an injustice
- Ⓓ demonstrating that the founders intended to make D.C. a state
- Ⓔ suggesting that passing the bill would help his colleagues get reelected

Answer Key: B, C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author’s choices in establishing and achieving purpose(s) in historical American speeches and essays.

33. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

16 Yet here we are again debating this issue, even though it has no chance of success in this chamber, and is dead on arrival in the House.

How does the phrase “dead on arrival” contribute to the pessimistic mood of the passage?

- Ⓐ It generates fear.
- Ⓑ It inspires outrage.
- Ⓒ It establishes confusion.
- Ⓓ It expresses uselessness.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 78%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how figurative language creates mood in text(s).

34. In Passage 2, what is a reason Coburn uses short rhetorical questions starting in paragraph 22?

- Ⓐ to address complaints in the statehood bill
- Ⓑ to introduce arguments against the statehood bill
- Ⓒ to distract from the strengths of the statehood bill
- Ⓓ to downplay the power of the government to enact the statehood bill

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author's choices in establishing and achieving purpose(s) in historical American speeches and essays.

35. In paragraphs 23–25 of Passage 2, Coburn transitions from a history of failed bills to the effects of making D.C. a state. How does this strengthen his case?

- Ⓐ by establishing that such bills are unconstitutional
- Ⓑ by emphasizing the reasons such bills continue to fail
- Ⓒ by providing a contrast with arguments in favor of such bills
- Ⓓ by suggesting that such bills were never intended to pass as written

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 45%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze the impact of multiple text structures and the use of features in text(s).

36. Read this paragraph from Passage 2.

33 The bill even gives New Columbia control over certain land in Virginia and Maryland, a serious affront to their sovereignty.

What is the meaning of the phrase affront to their sovereignty in this context?

- Ⓐ violation of their laws
- Ⓑ attack on their traditions
- Ⓒ insult to their independence
- Ⓓ outrage against their senators

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

37. Select **two** ways in which Coburn argues that D.C. statehood would be unfair to the American people in Passage 2.

- Ⓐ by noting that not everyone is in favor of statehood
- Ⓑ by pointing out the area is not large enough to be a state
- Ⓒ by focusing on the financial difficulties statehood would create
- Ⓓ by implying that the new state would get preferential treatment
- Ⓔ by stating that the only people who support statehood are politicians

Answer Key: C, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 29%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s) of historical American speeches and essays.

38. How do both speakers use information about early America to make their arguments?

- Ⓐ Both explain why D.C. was made the capital city.
- Ⓑ Both refer to the intentions of American founders.
- Ⓒ Both acknowledge the influence of European governments.
- Ⓓ Both portray Americans during the revolution as demanding.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Compare the development of two opposing arguments on the same topic, evaluating the effectiveness and validity of the claims, and analyzing the ways in which the authors use the same information to achieve different ends.

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39. Complete the table to show how each passage develops its argument.

How Passage Develops Its Argument	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
by appealing to the values of democracy	(A)	(B)	(C)
by referring to principles of the Constitution	(D)	(E)	(F)
by using detailed specifics about related laws	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: A, F, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 23%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Compare the development of two opposing arguments on the same topic, evaluating the effectiveness and validity of the claims, and analyzing the ways in which the authors use the same information to achieve different ends.



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

Algebra 1 EOC Assessment

Test Release: 2024

1. In baseball, a pitcher's earned run average is used to measure how effective the pitcher is. The earned run average, A , is calculated using the formula shown, where E is the number of earned runs and N is the number of innings the pitcher pitched.

$$A = \frac{9E}{N}$$

Which equation correctly solves the formula for the variable E ?

- Ⓐ $E = \frac{A}{9N}$
- Ⓑ $E = \frac{AN}{9}$
- Ⓒ $E = \frac{9A}{N}$
- Ⓓ $E = 9AN$

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.1.2

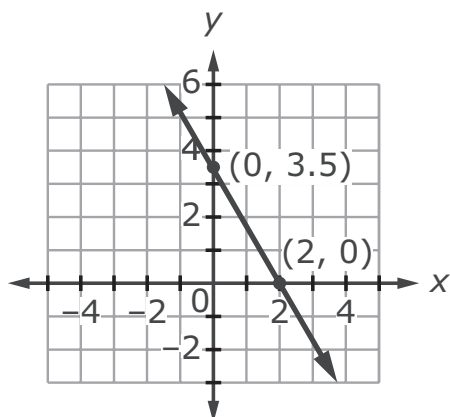
Benchmark Description: Rearrange equations or formulas to isolate a quantity of interest.

2. A function is shown.

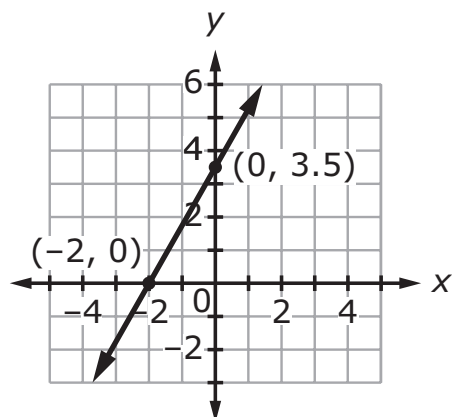
$$7x + 4y = 14$$

Which graph represents the function?

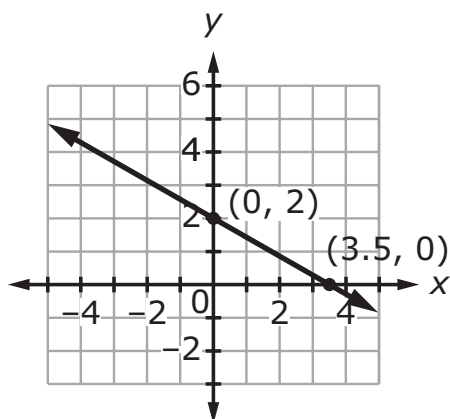
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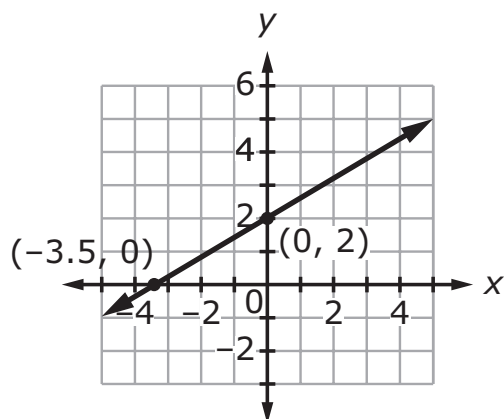
Ⓒ



Ⓑ



Ⓓ



Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.2.4

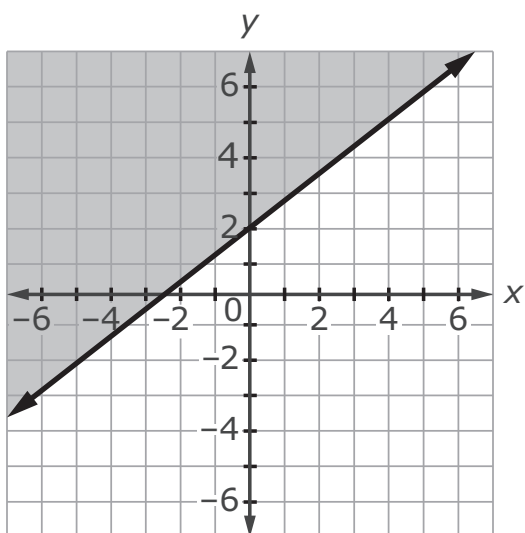
Benchmark Description: Given a table, equation or written description of a linear function, graph that function, and determine and interpret its key features.

3. An inequality is shown.

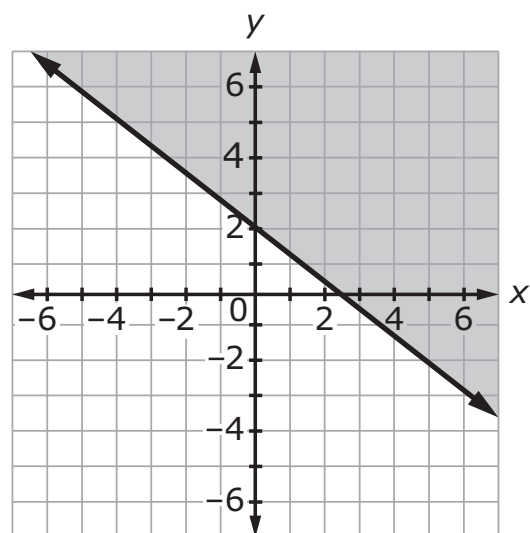
$$4x + 5y \geq 10$$

Which graph represents the solution set of the inequality?

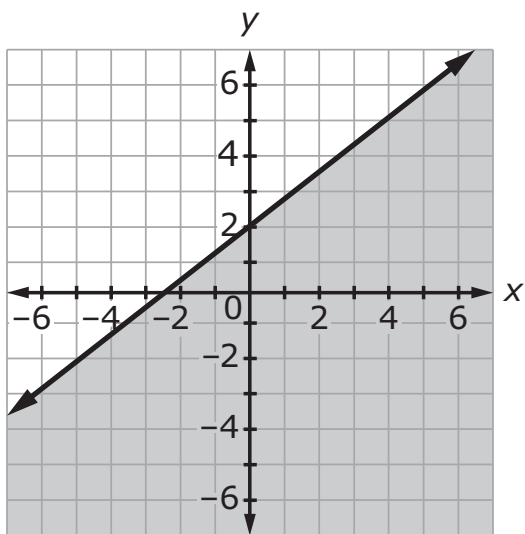
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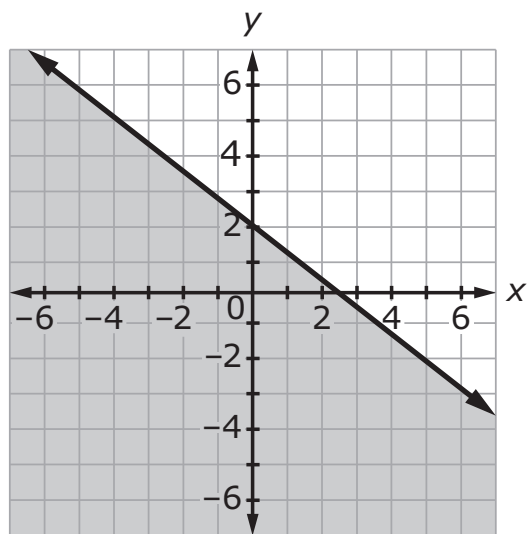
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Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 42%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

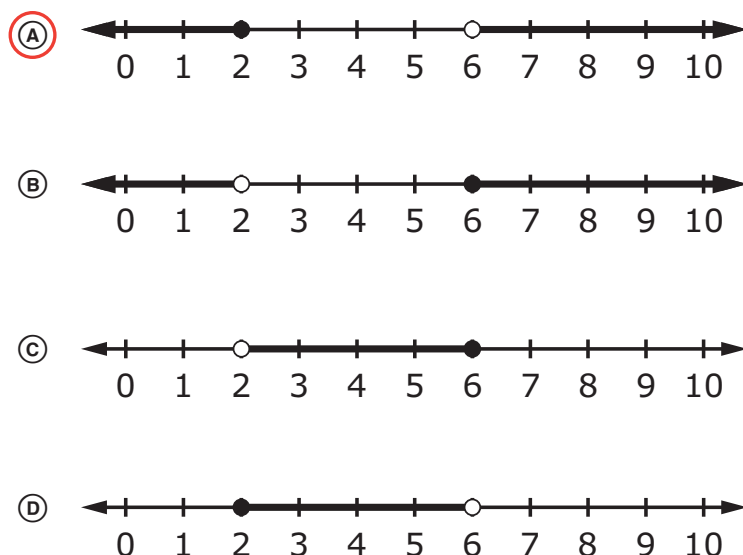
Benchmark: MA.912.AR.2.8

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, graph the solution set to a two-variable linear inequality.

4. A compound inequality is shown.

$$2x - 1 \leq 3 \text{ or } \frac{1}{2}x + 4 > 7$$

Which graph represents the solution set of the compound inequality?



Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.2.6

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, write and solve one-variable linear inequalities, including compound inequalities. Represent solutions algebraically or graphically.

5. An inequality is shown.

$$-3x + 7 \geq -x - 5$$

What is the solution set for x ?

- Ⓐ $\{x \mid x \leq 6\}$
- Ⓑ $\{x \mid x \geq 6\}$
- Ⓒ $\{x \mid x \leq -6\}$
- Ⓓ $\{x \mid x \geq -6\}$

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 38%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.2.6

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, write and solve one-variable linear inequalities, including compound inequalities. Represent solutions algebraically or graphically.

6. What is the sum of $(2x^3 + 4x)$ and $(3x^3 + 5x)$?

- Ⓐ $14x^6$
- Ⓑ $14x^8$
- Ⓒ $5x^3 + 9x$
- Ⓓ $5x^6 + 9x^2$

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.1.3

Benchmark Description: Add, subtract and multiply polynomial expressions with rational number coefficients.

7. A system of equations is shown.

$$\begin{aligned} y &= 2x + 2 \\ 2x + 5y &= 19 \end{aligned}$$

What is the solution to the system?

Ⓐ $\left(\frac{3}{4}, 3\frac{1}{2}\right)$

Ⓑ $\left(1\frac{1}{8}, 4\frac{1}{4}\right)$

Ⓒ $\left(1\frac{2}{3}, 5\frac{1}{3}\right)$

Ⓓ $\left(3\frac{1}{4}, 2\frac{1}{2}\right)$

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 41%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.9.1

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, write and solve a system of two-variable linear equations algebraically or graphically.

8. Which expression is equivalent to $\sqrt{3}$?

Ⓐ $2^{\frac{1}{3}}$

Ⓑ $3^{\frac{1}{2}}$

Ⓒ $\left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^3$

Ⓓ $\left(\frac{1}{3}\right)^2$

Answer Key: B

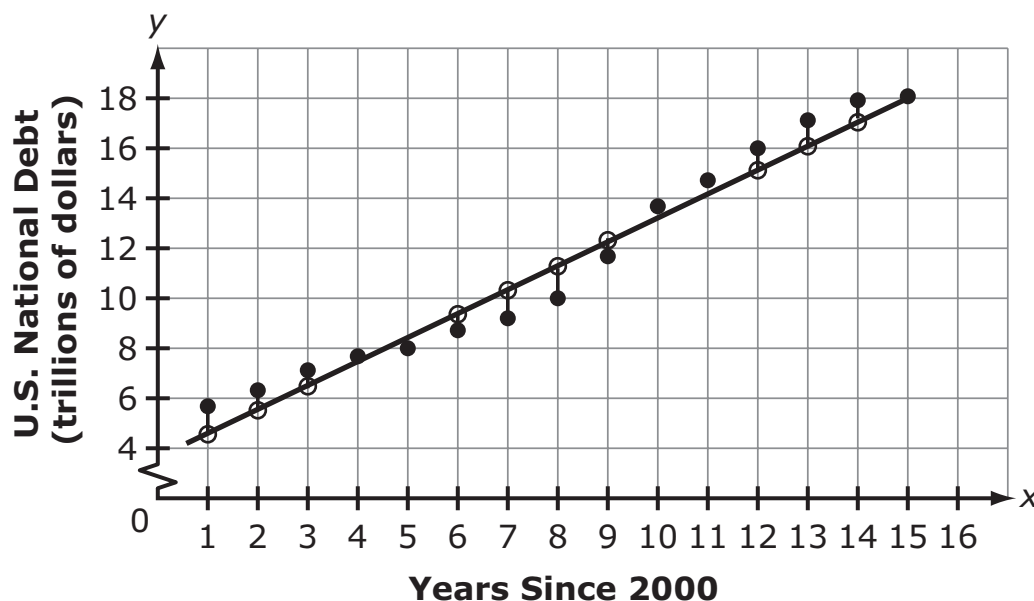
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 45%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.NSO.1.1

Benchmark Description: Extend previous understanding of the Laws of Exponents to include rational exponents. Apply the Laws of Exponents to evaluate numerical expressions and generate equivalent numerical expressions involving rational exponents.

9. A scatter plot of the U.S. national debt from 2001 to 2016, including a linear equation and its residuals modeling the data, is shown.



Which statement correctly interprets the scatter plot?

- (A) The scatter plot shows a weak positive correlation.
- (B) The scatter plot shows a weak negative correlation.
- (C) The scatter plot shows a strong positive correlation.
- (D) The scatter plot shows a strong negative correlation.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.DP.2.6

Benchmark Description: Given a scatter plot with a line of fit and residuals, determine the strength and direction of the correlation. Interpret strength and direction within a real-world context.

10. An equation is shown.

$$3x^2 - 21 = 222$$

What is one exact solution to the equation?

$x =$

9

Answer Key: 9, -9, or any equivalent values

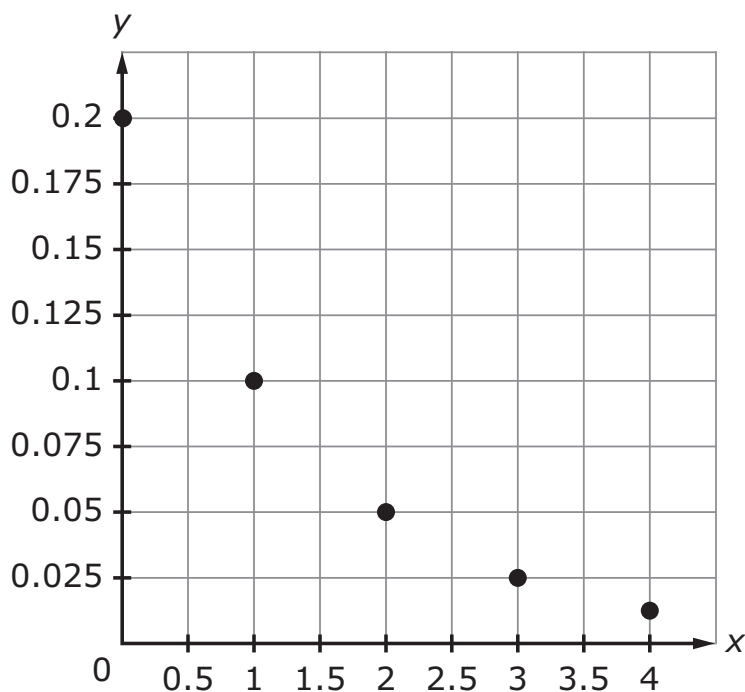
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 34%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.3.1

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, write and solve one-variable quadratic equations over the real number system.

11. Five points from a function, f , are plotted in the first quadrant of the coordinate plane, as shown.



Which equation could represent the function?

- Ⓐ $f(x) = 0.2(1 - 0.1)^x$
- Ⓑ $f(x) = 0.2(1 - 0.5)^x$
- Ⓒ $f(x) = 0.1(1 - 0.05)^x$
- Ⓓ $f(x) = 0.1(1 - 0.25)^x$

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 43%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.5.4

Benchmark Description: Write an exponential function to represent a relationship between two quantities from a graph, a written description or a table of values within a mathematical or real-world context.

12. Which expression is equivalent to $(7k + 2)(5k - 9)$?

- Ⓐ $35k^2 - 18$
- Ⓑ $-18k - 18$
- Ⓒ $35k^2 - 53k - 18$
- Ⓓ $35k^2 - 73k - 18$

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.1.3

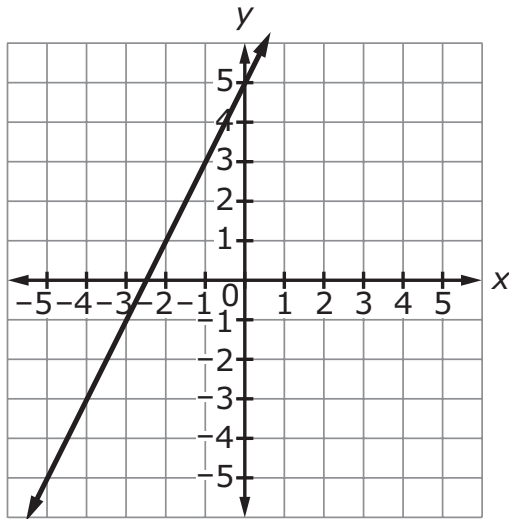
Benchmark Description: Add, subtract and multiply polynomial expressions with rational number coefficients.

13. A function is shown.

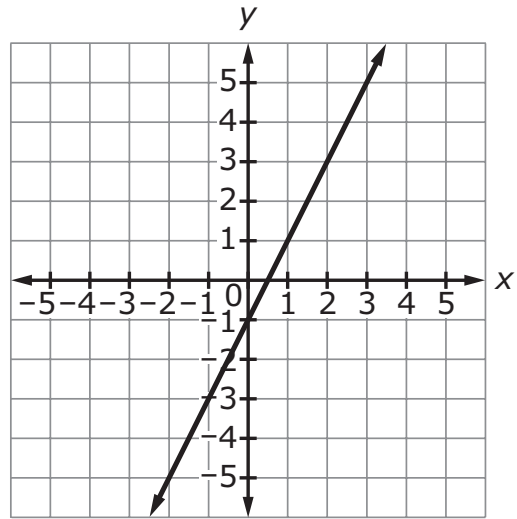
$$y + 1 = 2(x + 3)$$

Which graph represents the function?

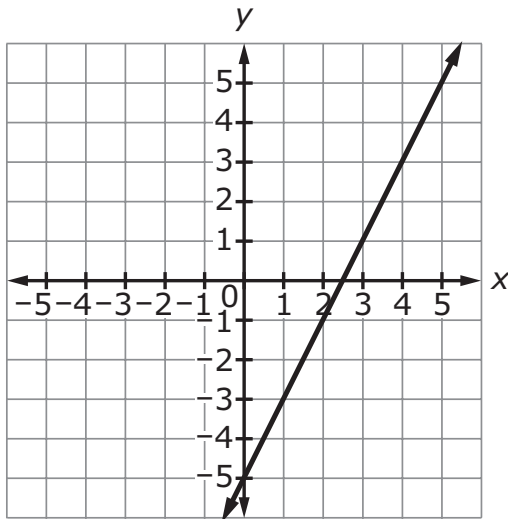
(A)



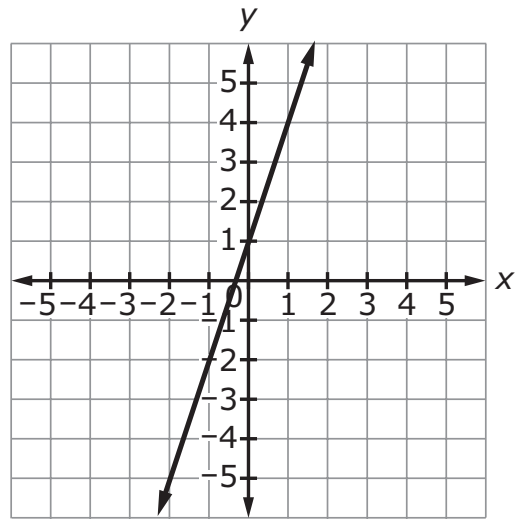
(C)



(B)



(D)



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Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 36%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.2.4

Benchmark Description: Given a table, equation or written description of a linear function, graph that function, and determine and interpret its key features.

- 14.** Garrett buys a large bag of dog food. He feeds his dog 2 cups of dog food each day.

Which statement describes the type of function that represents the amount of dog food in the bag after x days?

- Ⓐ positive linear
- Ⓑ negative linear
- Ⓒ exponential
- Ⓓ quadratic

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 53%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.F.1.8

Benchmark Description: Determine whether a linear, quadratic or exponential function best models a given real-world situation.

15. Which table could represent a quadratic function?

(A)

x	$f(x)$
0	3
1	9
2	27
3	81

(C)

x	$h(x)$
-1	6
0	5
1	6
2	9

(B)

x	$g(x)$
0	-2
1	-4
2	-6
3	-8

(D)

x	$j(x)$
-3	7
-2	7
-1	7
0	7

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 34%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.F.1.1

Benchmark Description: Given an equation or graph that defines a function, classify the function type. Given an input output table, determine a function type that could represent it.

16. Which function has the greatest slope?

Ⓐ $y = \frac{5}{3}x + 1$

Ⓑ $y = -x + 8$

Ⓒ $y = \frac{3}{4}x - \frac{5}{4}$

Ⓓ $y = \frac{3}{2}x + 3$

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.F.1.5

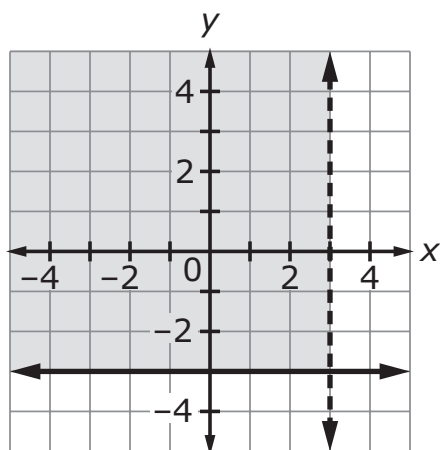
Benchmark Description: Compare key features of linear functions each represented algebraically, graphically, in tables or written descriptions.

17. A system of inequalities is shown.

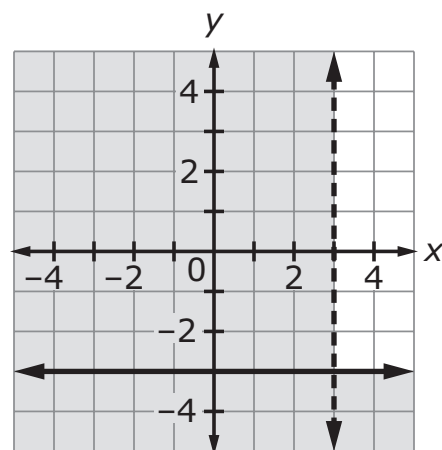
$$\begin{aligned} x &< 3 \\ y &\geq -3 \end{aligned}$$

Which graph represents the solution set?

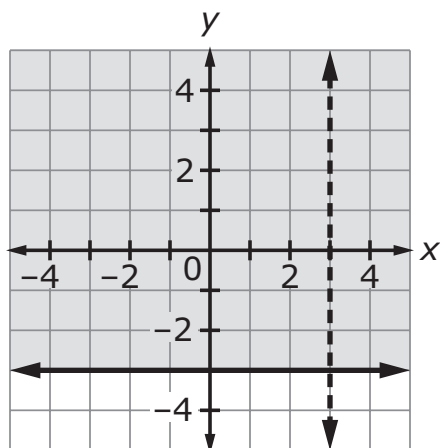
Ⓐ



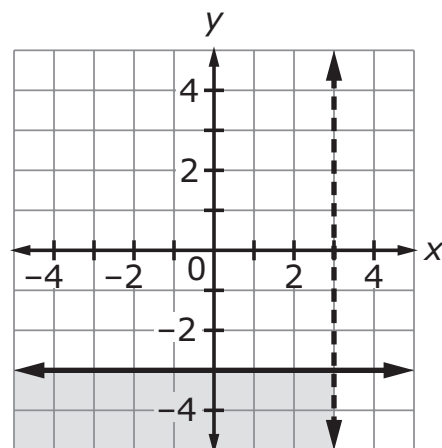
Ⓒ



Ⓑ



Ⓓ



Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.9.4

Benchmark Description: Graph the solution set of a system of two-variable linear inequalities.

- 18.** A ball was dropped from a balcony at a height of 20 feet above level ground. The height, in feet, of the ball after t seconds is modeled by the function shown.

$$y = -16t^2 + 20$$

What is the range of the function in terms of the situation described?

- Ⓐ $0 \leq t$
- Ⓑ $0 \leq y$
- Ⓒ $0 \leq t \leq 20$
- Ⓓ $0 \leq y \leq 20$

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 31%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.3.8

Benchmark Description: Solve and graph mathematical and real-world problems that are modeled with quadratic functions. Interpret key features and determine domain constraints in terms of the context.

19. Which equation models exponential growth?

Ⓐ $y = 2\left(\frac{1}{5}\right)^x$

Ⓑ $y = 2(5.0)^x$

Ⓒ $y = 2\left(1 - \frac{1}{5}\right)^x$

Ⓓ $y = 2(1 - 0.5)^x$

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.5.3

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, classify an exponential function as representing growth or decay.

20. Which function decays exponentially?

Ⓐ $f(x) = \frac{1}{5}x$

Ⓑ $g(x) = 5x$

Ⓒ $h(x) = 5^x$

Ⓓ $j(x) = \left(\frac{1}{5}\right)^x$

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.5.3

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, classify an exponential function as representing growth or decay.

21. A line with a slope of -0.2 passes through the point $(11, 5)$.

Select numbers to complete the equation of the line in point-slope form.

$$y - [\textcircled{A} -0.2 \textcircled{B} 0 \textcircled{C} 5 \textcircled{D} 11] = [\textcircled{A} -0.2 \textcircled{B} 0 \textcircled{C} 5 \textcircled{D} 11]$$

$$(x - [\textcircled{A} -0.2 \textcircled{B} 0 \textcircled{C} 5 \textcircled{D} 11])$$

Answer Key: C, A, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.2.2

Benchmark Description: Write a linear two-variable equation to represent relationships between quantities from a graph, a written description or a table of values within a mathematical or real-world context.

22. An expression is given, where $x \neq 0$.

$$\frac{4x^2 - 18x + 6}{2x}$$

Which expression is equivalent?

- Ⓐ $2x - 9 + \frac{3}{x}$
- Ⓑ $2x^2 - 16x + 4$
- Ⓒ $2x^3 - 9x^2 + 3x$
- Ⓓ $\frac{2}{x^3} - \frac{9}{x^2} + \frac{3}{x}$

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 45%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.1.4

Benchmark Description: Divide a polynomial expression by a monomial expression with rational number coefficients.

23. An equation is given.

$$y = (x - 3)^2 + 1$$

Which type of function does the equation represent?

- Ⓐ cubic
- Ⓑ quadratic
- Ⓒ exponential
- Ⓓ square root

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.F.1.1

Benchmark Description: Given an equation or graph that defines a function, classify the function type. Given an input output table, determine a function type that could represent it.

24. A function is given

$$h(x) = \frac{1}{5}x^2$$

How can be $h(15)$ evaluated?

- Ⓐ by multiplying $\frac{1}{5}$ by the square of 15
- Ⓑ by multiplying the square of $\frac{1}{5}$ by the square of 15
- Ⓒ by multiplying $\frac{1}{5}$ by the square of 15, then dividing by 15
- Ⓓ by multiplying the square of $\frac{1}{5}$ by the square of 15, then dividing by 15

Answer Key: A

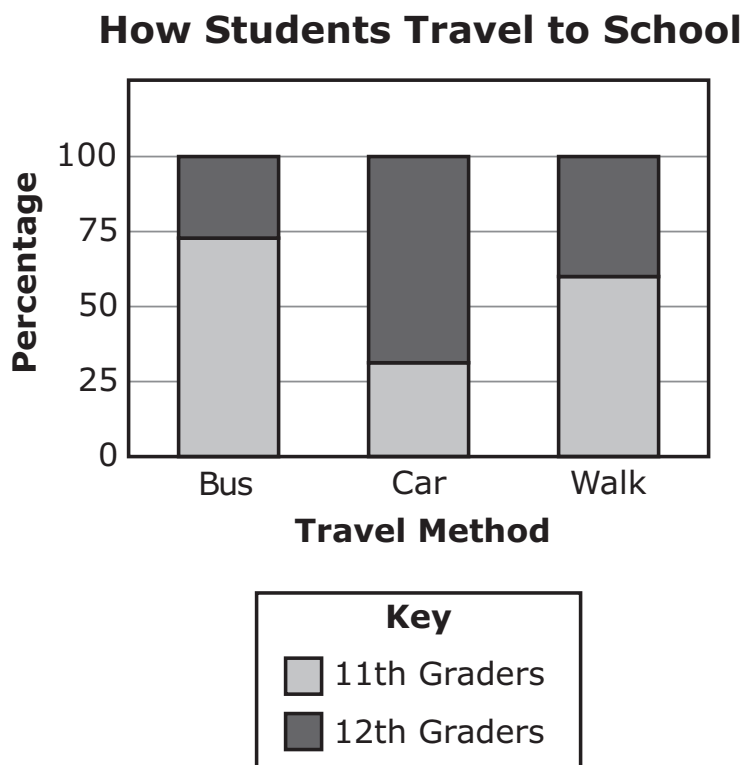
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 48%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.F.1.2

Benchmark Description: Given a function represented in function notation, evaluate the function for an input in its domain. For a real-world context, interpret the output.

25. Maribel asked a random group of upper-class students at her school which grade they are in and how they traveled to school in the morning. The data are shown in the segmented bar chart.



Which pair of terms describes the data?

- (A) bivariate and numerical
- (B) bivariate and categorical
- (C) univariate and numerical
- (D) univariate and categorical

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Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.DP.1.2

Benchmark Description: Interpret data distributions represented in various ways. State whether the data is numerical or categorical, whether it is univariate or bivariate and interpret the different components and quantities in the display.

26. An expression is given.

$$42r^3s^2 - 35r^2s^3$$

Which expression is equivalent?

- Ⓐ $7rs(6s - 5r)$
- Ⓑ $7rs(6rs - 5rs)$
- Ⓒ $7r^2s^2(6r - 5s)$
- Ⓓ $7r^2s^2(6s - 5r)$

Answer Key: C

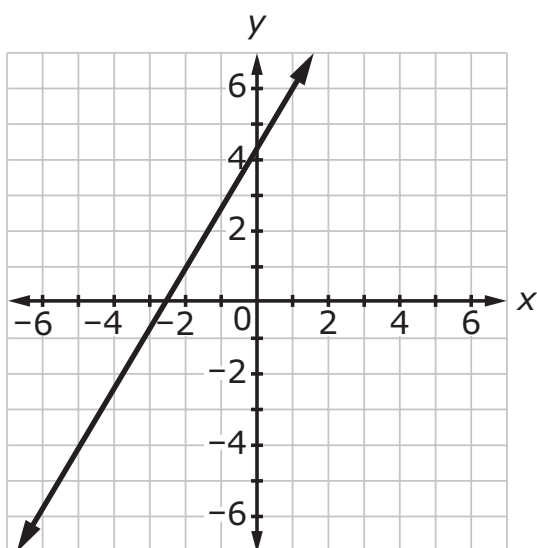
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.1.7

Benchmark Description: Rewrite a polynomial expression as a product of polynomials over the real number system.

27. The graph of a line is shown.



Which equation represents the line?

Ⓐ $y = \frac{3}{5}x - \frac{13}{5}$

Ⓑ $y = \frac{3}{5}x + \frac{13}{3}$

Ⓒ $y = \frac{5}{3}x - \frac{13}{5}$

Ⓓ $y = \frac{5}{3}x + \frac{13}{3}$

Answer Key: D

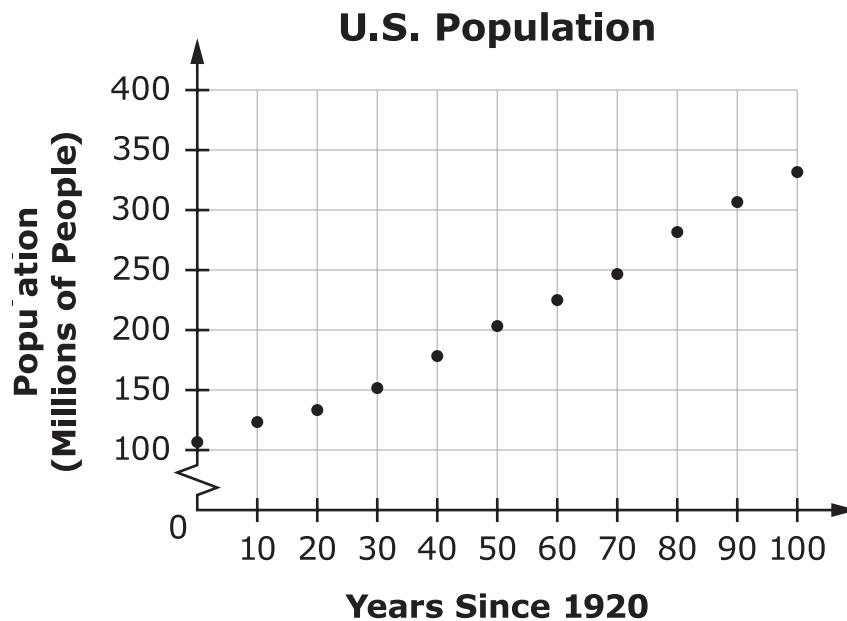
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 36%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.2.2

Benchmark Description: Write a linear two-variable equation to represent relationships between quantities from a graph, a written description or a table of values within a mathematical or real-world context.

28. Darren collects data on the U.S. population from 1920 to 2020. He graphs the population and the number of years since 1920 in the scatter plot shown.



He determines the equation for the line of best fit to be $y = 2.33x + 92.05$ where y represents the population, in millions of people, and x represents the number of years since 1920.

Based on Darren's model, what is the projected U.S. population, in millions of people, for 2040?

371.65

←
→
↶
↷
✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$

Answer Key: 371.65, 372, or any equivalent values

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 27%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.DP.2.4

Benchmark Description: Fit a linear function to bivariate numerical data that suggests a linear association and interpret the slope and y-intercept of the model. Use the model to solve real-world problems in terms of the context of the data.

Florida Test Release Support Document

29. Bashir has \$3410 to invest in two different investment accounts, Account A and Account B. The accounts earn simple interest for one year.

- Account A earns 6% interest.
- Account B earns 2% interest.
- He wants to earn at least \$196 in interest.

Bashir puts x dollars in Account A and y dollars in Account B.

Which system of constraints represents the situation?

- (A) $x + y = 3410$
 $0.02x + 0.06y \geq 196$
- (B) $x + y = 3410$
 $0.06x + 0.02y \geq 196$
- (C) $0.02x + 0.06y = 3410$
 $x + y \geq 196$
- (D) $0.06x + 0.02y \geq 3410$
 $x + y \geq 196$

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 62%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.9.6

Benchmark Description: Given a real-world context, represent constraints as systems of linear equations or inequalities. Interpret solutions to problems as viable or non-viable options.

- 30.** A rental company charges \$2 per hour to rent a bicycle. A table showing the prices of renting one bicycle for different amounts of time is shown.

Time (hours)	Price (dollars)
1	2
2	4
3	6

Which type of function models the price for renting one bicycle as a function of time?

- ☒ (A) increasing linear
- ☐ (B) decreasing linear
- ☐ (C) increasing exponential
- ☐ (D) decreasing exponential

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 76%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.F.1.8

Benchmark Description: Determine whether a linear, quadratic or exponential function best models a given real-world situation.

- 31.** An artist earns a profit from selling y paintings. His profit, P , in dollars, is modeled with the given equation.

$$P = (200y + 23.25) - (10.53y)$$

His profit is the difference in the amount of money he earns from selling his paintings and the cost of making the paintings.

Which expression represents the cost of making y paintings?

- Ⓐ 23.25
- Ⓑ 10.53y
- Ⓒ $200y + 23.25$
- Ⓓ $189.47y + 23.25$

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 39%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.1.1

Benchmark Description: Identify and interpret parts of an equation or expression that represent a quantity in terms of a mathematical or real-world context, including viewing one or more of their parts as a single entity.

- 32.** Cardiac output, D , is the amount of blood that the heart pumps per minute. The value of D can be found using the formula shown, where V is the amount of blood that the heart pumps with each heartbeat and R is the number of heartbeats per minute.

$$D = V \cdot R$$

Complete the equation to represent V in terms of D and R .

$$V = \frac{D}{R}$$

←	→	↶	↷	✖							
1	2	3	D	R							
4	5	6	+	-	•	÷					
7	8	9	<	≤	=	≥	>				
	0		$\square^\square$	$\square_\square$	()		$\sqrt{\square}$	$\sqrt[\square]{\square}$	π	i	
.	-	$\frac{\square}{\square}$	sin	cos	tan	arcsin	arccos	arctan			

Answer Key: $\frac{D}{R}$, or any equivalent expression

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 36%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.1.2

Benchmark Description: Rearrange equations or formulas to isolate a quantity of interest.

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- 33.** Two divers are underwater. One diver is at a depth of 32 meters, while the other diver is at a different depth. The given equation can be used to find the possible depths, x , in meters, of the other diver.

$$|x-32| = 11$$

Enter values to complete the sentence about the other diver's depth, in meters.

The other diver is at a depth of either

21

←→↶↷✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$

or

43

←→↶↷✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$

meters.

Answer Key: The other diver is at a depth of either 21 or 43 meters, or any equivalent values. 21 and 43 may be switched.

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 27%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.4.1

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, write and solve one-variable absolute value equations.

34. The equation of a linear function, q , and a table of values of a linear function, r , are shown.

$$q(x) = 2x - 1$$

x	$r(x)$
0	-2
1	4
2	10
3	16

Which statement correctly compares the slopes and y -intercepts of the two functions?

- Ⓐ Function r has a lesser y -intercept and a slope that is 2 times the slope of function q .
- Ⓑ Function r has a lesser y -intercept and a slope that is 3 times the slope of function q .
- Ⓒ Function r has a greater y -intercept and a slope that is 2 times the slope of function q .
- Ⓓ Function r has a greater y -intercept and a slope that is 3 times the slope of function q .

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 31%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.F.1.5

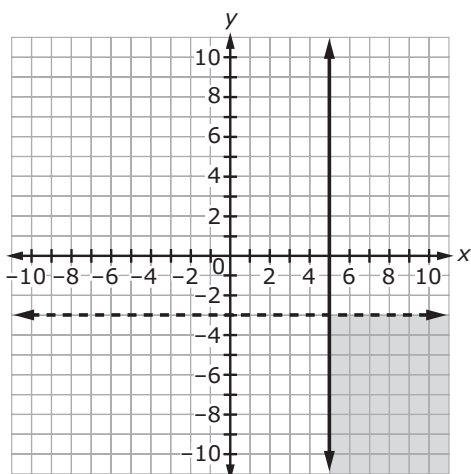
Benchmark Description: Compare key features of linear functions each represented algebraically, graphically, in tables or written descriptions.

35. A system of inequalities is given.

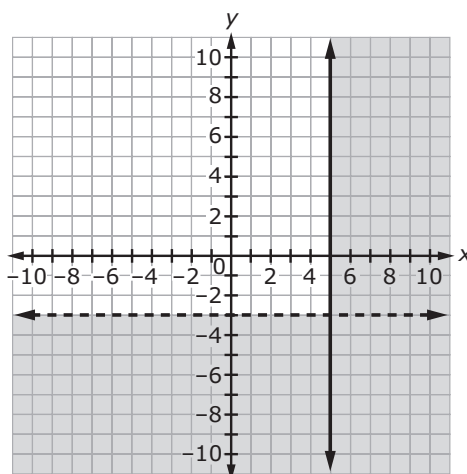
$$\begin{aligned} x &\geq 5 \\ y &< -3 \end{aligned}$$

Which graph represents the solution set?

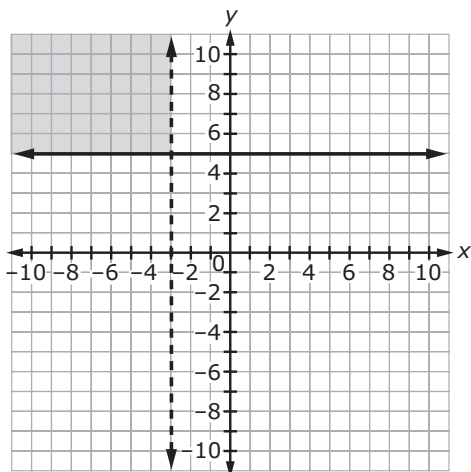
(A)



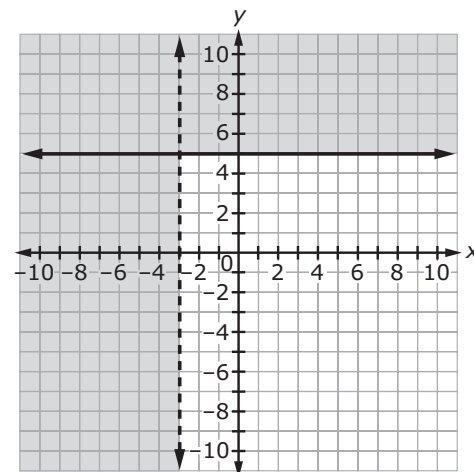
(C)



(B)



(D)



Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 41%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.9.4

Benchmark Description: Graph the solution set of a system of two-variable linear inequalities.

36. An equation is shown.

$$x^2 - 15x = -14$$

What are the two solutions to the equation?

$x =$

1

←
→
↶
↷
✕

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$

$x =$

14

←
→
↶
↷
✕

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$

Answer Key: 1 and 14, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 19%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.3.1

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, write and solve one-variable quadratic equations over the real number system.

37. A function, f , is given.

$$f(x) = x^2 + 12x + 20$$

Select terms to describe the end behavior of the function.

As x approaches $-\infty$, $f(x)$ approaches [☐ A $-\infty$ ☒ B ∞ ☐ C 0] .

As x approaches ∞ , $f(x)$ approaches [☐ A $-\infty$ ☒ B ∞ ☐ C 0] .

Answer Key: B, B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 12%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.3.7

Benchmark Description: Given a table, equation or written description of a quadratic function, graph that function, and determine and interpret its key features.

38. The expression $\sqrt[3]{18} \cdot 5\sqrt[3]{6}$ is equivalent to $15\sqrt[3]{x}$.

What is the value of x ?

4

←
→
↶
↷
✕

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\square}{\square}$

Answer Key: 4, or any equivalent value

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 16%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.NSO.1.4

Benchmark Description: Apply previous understanding of operations with rational numbers to add, subtract, multiply and divide numerical radicals.

- 39.** Margo surveys 150 high school juniors and seniors about their favorite types of dipping sauce. She records the results in the table shown.

Favorite Dipping Sauce

	Barbeque	Honey Mustard	Ranch	Sweet and Sour
Juniors	19	26	23	11
Seniors	7	22	30	12

How many more high school juniors and seniors chose honey mustard sauce than sweet and sour sauce?

25

←
→
↶
↷
✖

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	9
	0	
.	-	$\frac{\Box}{\Box}$

Answer Key: 25, or any equivalent value

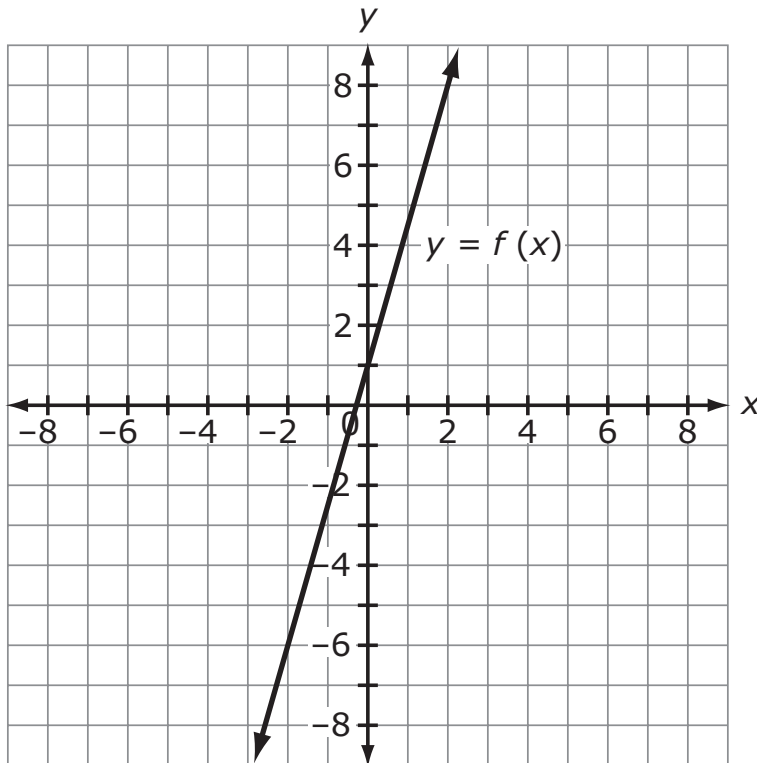
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.DP.3.1

Benchmark Description: Construct a two-way frequency table summarizing bivariate categorical data. Interpret joint and marginal frequencies and determine possible associations in terms of a real-world context.

40. The graph of $y = f(x)$ and a table of values for an exponential function $y = g(x)$ are shown.



x	$g(x)$
-2	0.25
-1	0.5
0	1
1	2
2	4

Which statement correctly compares the graphs of the functions?

- Ⓐ As the values of x increase, $g(x)$ will eventually be greater than $f(x)$.
- Ⓑ As the values of x increase, $f(x)$ will eventually be greater than $g(x)$.
- Ⓒ The value of the y -intercept of $y = f(x)$ is greater than the value of the y -intercept of $y = g(x)$.
- Ⓓ The value of the y -intercept of $y = g(x)$ is greater than the value of the y -intercept of $y = f(x)$.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 40%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.F.1.6

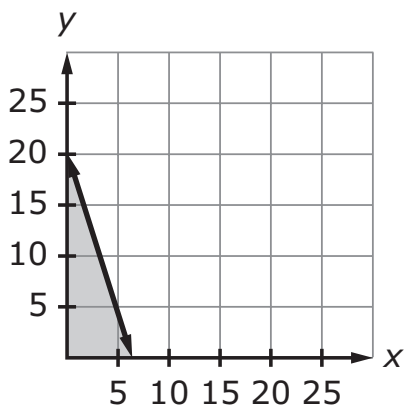
Benchmark Description: Compare key features of linear and nonlinear functions each represented algebraically, graphically, in tables or written descriptions.

- 41.** Sanjay buys x boxes of hot wings and y bottles of soda for a party. The numbers of boxes of hot wings and bottles of soda he can buy with \$40 can be represented with the inequality shown.

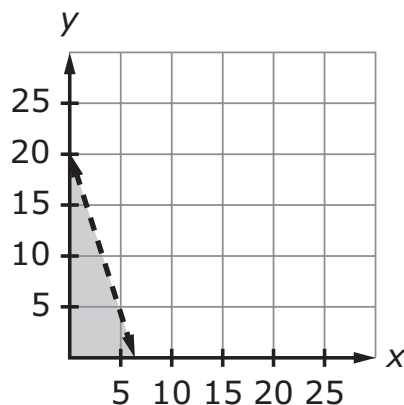
$$40 \geq 6x + 2y$$

Which graph represents all possible solutions for x and y ?

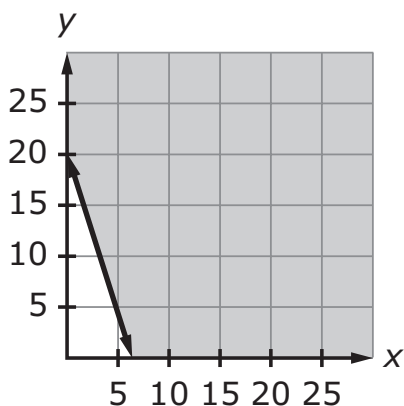
Ⓐ



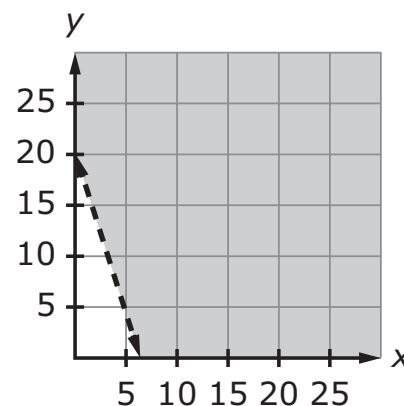
Ⓒ



Ⓑ



Ⓓ



Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 32%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.2.8

Benchmark Description: Given a mathematical or real-world context, graph the solution set to a two-variable linear inequality.

42. Janelle buys blackberries and raspberries to make pies.

- Blackberries cost \$8 per pound.
- Raspberries cost \$9 per pound.
- Janelle can spend a maximum of \$40.

Create an inequality to represent how many pounds of blackberries, b , and raspberries, r , Janelle can buy.

$8b + 9r \leq 40$

←	→	↶	↷	✕										
1	2	3	b	r										
4	5	6	+	-	•	÷								
7	8	9	<	≤	=	≥	>							
	0		$\square^\square$	$\square_\square$	()		$\sqrt{\square}$	$\sqrt[\square]{\square}$	π	i				
.	-	$\frac{\square}{\square}$	sin	cos	tan	arcsin	arccos	arctan						

Answer Key: $8b + 9r \leq 40$, or any equivalent inequality

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 25%

Reporting Category: Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.2.7

Benchmark Description: Write two-variable linear inequalities to represent relationships between quantities from a graph or a written description within a mathematical or real-world context.

- 43.** Cynthia buys some tools. She creates exponential function V to predict the value of her tools after t years. She predicts her tools will have a value of \$380 after 1 year and a value of \$361 after 2 years.

Which equation represents function V ?

- Ⓐ $V(t) = 400(1 - 0.05)^t$
- Ⓑ $V(t) = 399(1 - 0.19)^t$
- Ⓒ $V(t) = 380(1 - 0.05)^t$
- Ⓓ $V(t) = 380(1 - 0.19)^t$

Answer Key: A

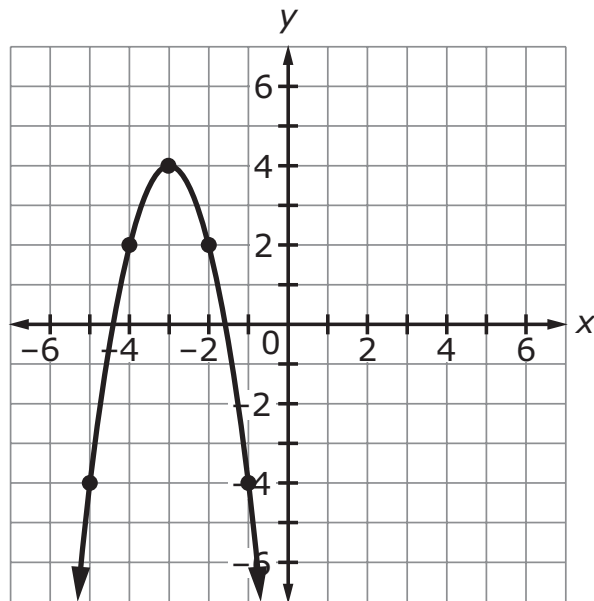
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 14%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.5.4

Benchmark Description: Write an exponential function to represent a relationship between two quantities from a graph, a written description or a table of values within a mathematical or real-world context.

44. The graph of a quadratic function is shown.



Which equation represents the function?

- Ⓐ $y = -2(x + 3)^2 + 4$
- Ⓑ $y = -(x - 3)^2 + 4$
- Ⓒ $y = (x + 3)^2 + 4$
- Ⓓ $y = 6(x + 3)^2 - 4$

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 42%

Reporting Category: Non-Linear Relationships

Benchmark: MA.912.AR.3.4

Benchmark Description: Write a quadratic function to represent the relationship between two quantities from a graph, a written description or a table of values within a mathematical or real-world context.

45. Select all the values that are equivalent to $\frac{\sqrt{24}}{\sqrt{8}}$.

☒ (A) $\sqrt{3}$

☐ (B) $\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$

☐ (C) $\sqrt{16}$

☒ (D) $\frac{2\sqrt{6}}{2\sqrt{2}}$

☐ (E) $\frac{4\sqrt{6}}{\sqrt{8}}$

Answer Key: A, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 15%

Reporting Category: Expressions, Functions, and Data Analysis

Benchmark: MA.912.NSO.1.4

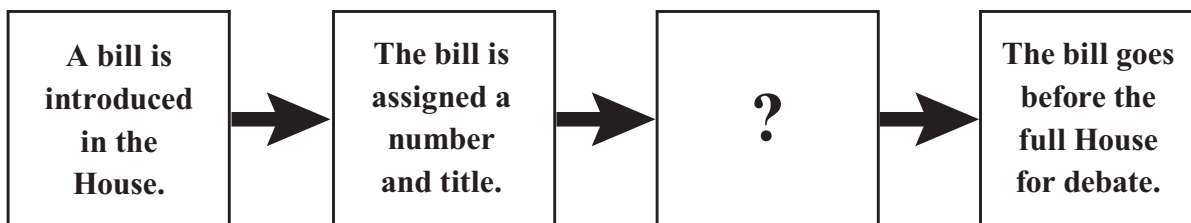
Benchmark Description: Apply previous understanding of operations with rational numbers to add, subtract, multiply and divide numerical radicals.



Civics EOC Assessment

Test Release: 2024

1. The flow chart below shows part of the process in which a bill becomes a state law.



Which action completes the flow chart?

- Ⓐ The bill is sent to committee for study.
- Ⓑ The bill is sent to the governor for support.
- Ⓒ The bill is published in newspapers for comment.
- Ⓓ The bill is reviewed by a judge for constitutionality.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.7

Benchmark Description: Explain the structure, functions and processes of the legislative branch of government.

2. Which is one constitutional requirement to be eligible to be elected as President of the United States?
- Ⓐ a resident for at least 20 years
 - Ⓑ previous government service
 - Ⓒ a member of a political party
 - Ⓓ at least 35 years of age

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 83%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.7

Benchmark Description: Identify the constitutional qualifications required to hold state and national office.

3. The excerpt below is about the U.S. Supreme Court decision in *Gideon v. Wainwright* (1963).

The Court held that the Sixth Amendment's guarantee of counsel is a fundamental right essential to a fair trial and, as such, applies to the states through the Due Process Clause of the Fourteenth Amendment.

Source: Public Domain

How does this U.S. Supreme Court decision protect individual rights?

- Ⓐ It provides defendants a jury of their peers.
- Ⓑ It allows lawyers to call witnesses for defendants.
- Ⓒ It allows defendants to set aside fines they cannot pay.
- Ⓓ It provides defendants legal representation if they cannot afford it.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Roles, Rights, and Responsibilities of Citizens

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.11

Benchmark Description: Analyze the effects of landmark Supreme Court decisions on law, liberty and the interpretation of the U.S. Constitution.

4. Which statement describes separation of powers?

- Ⓐ Civil servants are not subject to political pressure.
- Ⓑ Presidential power is not subject to congressional oversight.
- Ⓒ Civilian authorities have control over the branches of the military.
- Ⓓ Political authority is divided among the branches of the government.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 81%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.9

Benchmark Description: Describe how the U.S. Constitution limits the powers of government through separation of powers, checks and balances, individual rights, rule of law and due process of law.

5. The excerpt below was written by Noah Webster in 1785.

Plan of Policy for improving the Advantages and perpetuating the Union of the American States. In the first place, there must be a supreme power at the head of the union, vested with authority to make laws that respect the states in general and to compel obedience to these laws. Such a power must exist in every society or no man is safe.

Source: Excerpted text from the original publication from 1898/Public Domain

According to the excerpt, which problem did the Articles of Confederation create?

- Ⓐ a lack of checks on legislative powers
- Ⓑ a lack of powers given to state legislatures
- Ⓒ the lack of authority to enforce congressional acts
- Ⓓ the lack of authority to apportion congressional districts

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.7

Benchmark Description: Explain how the weaknesses of the Articles of Confederation led to the writing of the U.S. Constitution.

6. The excerpt below is from the Fifteenth Amendment to the U.S. Constitution.

The right of citizens of the United States to vote shall not be denied or abridged by the United States or by any State on account of race, color, or previous condition of servitude.

Source: National Archives and Records Administration/Public Domain

When it was first ratified, which group of people did this amendment address?

- Ⓐ Chinese immigrants
- Ⓑ Mexican immigrants
- Ⓒ Asian-American men
- Ⓓ African-American men

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 88%

Reporting Category: Roles, Rights, and Responsibilities of Citizens

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.6

Benchmark Description: Analyze how the 13th, 14th, 15th, 19th, 24th and 26th Amendments broadened participation in the political process.

7. Which statement describes the intent of checks and balances?

- Ⓐ The government receives revenue from the people.
- Ⓑ The government receives authority from the people.
- Ⓒ No branch of government can become too powerful.
- Ⓓ No branch of government can apply concurrent powers.

Answer Key: C

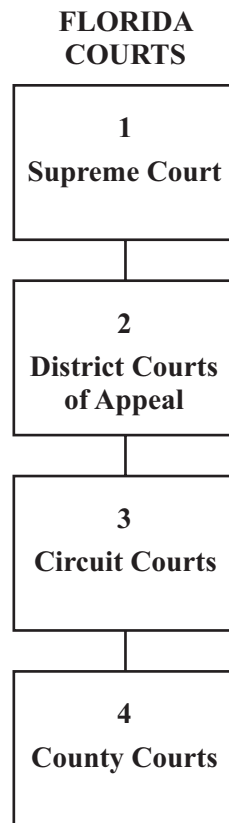
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.9

Benchmark Description: Describe how the U.S. Constitution limits the powers of government through separation of powers, checks and balances, individual rights, rule of law and due process of law.

8. The diagram below illustrates the structure of courts of Florida.



Which numbered court has only original jurisdiction?

- Ⓐ 1
- Ⓑ 2
- Ⓒ 3
- Ⓓ 4

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 29%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.9

Benchmark Description: Explain the structure, functions and processes of the judicial branch of government.

9. What was the main reason President Harry S. Truman went to the United Nations in response to the Communist invasion of South Korea in 1950?
- Ⓐ to advance U.S. political goals in the United Nations
 - Ⓑ to justify U.S. economic support for the United Nations
 - Ⓒ to seek international support for the defense of South Korea
 - Ⓓ to ask troops to prevent a political overthrow of South Korea

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 50%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.4.3

Benchmark Description: Describe examples of the United States' actions and reactions in international conflicts.

10. What role does the Cabinet serve at the federal level?

- Ⓐ It advises the president on national issues and assists in operating the government.
- Ⓑ It works with the political party in power to ensure members support the president's agenda.
- Ⓒ It works with the major news organizations to ensure public support for upcoming legislation.
- Ⓓ It advises government leaders on procedural matters and assists in the passage of legislation.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.8

Benchmark Description: Explain the structure, functions and processes of the executive branch of government.

11. Which statement describes a difference between the duties of state and federal governments?

- Ⓐ The federal government builds roads.
- Ⓑ The federal government mints coins.
- Ⓒ State governments establish courts.
- Ⓓ State governments levy taxes.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 42%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.13

Benchmark Description: Explain government obligations to its citizens and the services provided at the local, state and national levels.

- 12.** The excerpt below is from the Declaration of Rights and Grievances of the First Continental Congress on October 14, 1774.

. . . the British parliament, claiming a power of right to bind the people of America by statutes in all cases . . . imposed taxes on them . . . To these grievous acts and measures, Americans cannot submit . . . we have for the present, only resolved to pursue the following peaceable measures:
1) To enter into a non-importation, non-consumption, and non-exportation agreement or association.

Source: Library of Congress/Public Domain

How did King George III respond to the action described in the excerpt?

- Ⓐ He approved the colonists' decision to use a trade boycott.
- Ⓑ He supported the election of colonial representatives to Parliament.
- Ⓒ He ignored the colonists' demands for change in government policy.
- Ⓓ He repealed the law declaring Parliament could pass laws for the colonies.

Answer Key: C

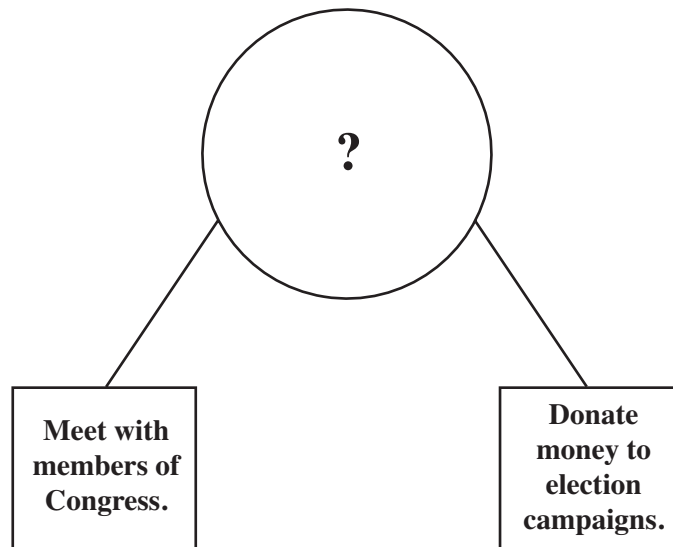
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.5

Benchmark Description: Describe how British policies and responses to colonial concerns led to the writing of the Declaration of Independence.

13. The diagram below shows some activities in the political process.



Which title completes the diagram?

- Ⓐ Ways that Corporations Influence Consumers
- Ⓑ Ways that Citizens Support Personal Businesses
- Ⓒ Ways that Interest Groups Influence Lawmakers
- Ⓓ Ways that Public Officials Support Government Reforms

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.8

Benchmark Description: Examine the impact of media, individuals, and interest groups on monitoring and influencing government.

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- 14.** The chart below compares the constitutions of the United States and Florida.

U.S. Constitution	Florida Constitution
Article I Legislative	Article III Legislative
Article II Executive	Article IV Executive
Article III Judicial	Article V Judiciary

What do these two constitutions have in common?

- Ⓐ They both include the sharing of powers.
- Ⓑ They both include the separation of powers.
- Ⓒ They both are examples of government processes.
- Ⓓ They both are examples of government regulations.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.12

Benchmark Description: Compare the U.S. and Florida constitutions.

15. The excerpt below was published in 1788.

In the . . . republic of America, the power surrendered by the people is first divided between two distinct governments . . . The different governments will control each other, at the same time that each will be controlled by itself.

Source: Library of Congress/Public Domain

Which principle of government is described in this excerpt?

- Ⓐ direct democracy
- Ⓑ judicial review
- Ⓒ rule of law
- Ⓓ federalism

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 36%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.4

Benchmark Description: Explain the relationship between state and national governments as written in Article IV of the U.S. Constitution and the 10th Amendment.

- 16.** Which action did the U.S. government take to help make the world a safer place to live?
- Ⓐ It helped found the North American Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA) in 1994.
 - Ⓑ It withdrew from the International Red Cross in 1863.
 - Ⓒ It helped found the United Nations (UN) in 1945.
 - Ⓓ It withdrew from the European Union in 1993.

Answer Key: C

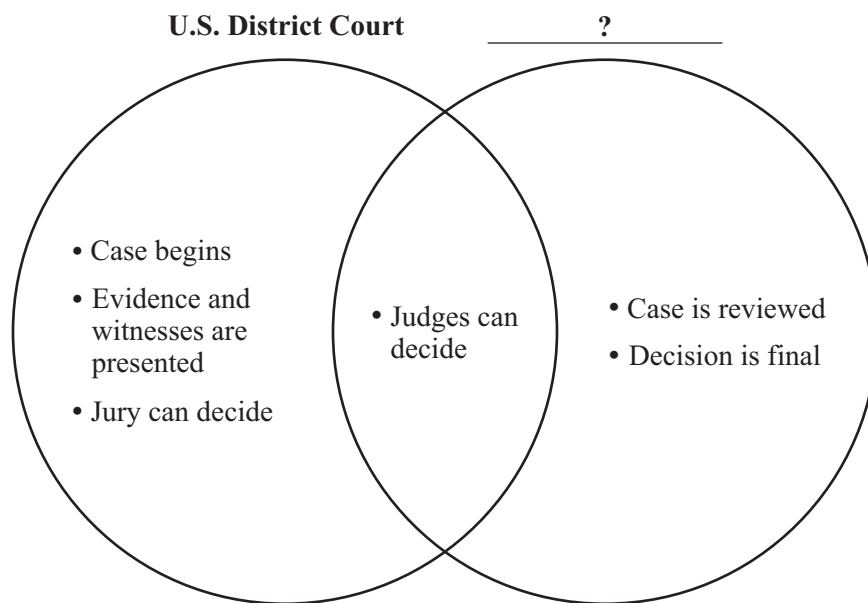
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.4.2

Benchmark Description: Describe the United States' and citizen participation in international organizations.

17. The Venn diagram below compares two types of federal courts.



Which federal court replaces the question mark?

- Ⓐ U.S. Bankruptcy Court
- Ⓑ U.S. Territorial Court
- Ⓒ U.S. Supreme Court
- Ⓓ U.S. Tax Court

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 86%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.9

Benchmark Description: Explain the structure, functions and processes of the judicial branch of government.

18. What was the significance of Thomas Paine’s pamphlet *Common Sense*?

- Ⓐ It was a published document outlining personal rights in Great Britain.
- Ⓑ It was an influential work calling for independence from Great Britain.
- Ⓒ It was a popular almanac instructing colonial farmers.
- Ⓓ It was a written framework of colonial government.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.3

Benchmark Description: Trace the impact that the Magna Carta, Mayflower Compact, English Bill of Rights and Thomas Paine’s *Common Sense* had on colonists’ views of government.

- 19.** The list of questions below is used to determine whether a candidate meets the constitutional requirements to run for a seat in the U.S. House of Representatives.

- What is the candidate's age?
- How long has the candidate been a U.S. citizen?
- ?

Which question completes this list?

- ☒ (A) Which state is the candidate a resident of?
- ☐ (B) Does the candidate have a college degree?
- ☐ (C) Does the candidate have a political background?
- ☐ (D) Which branch of the U.S. Armed Forces is the candidate a veteran of?

Answer Key: A

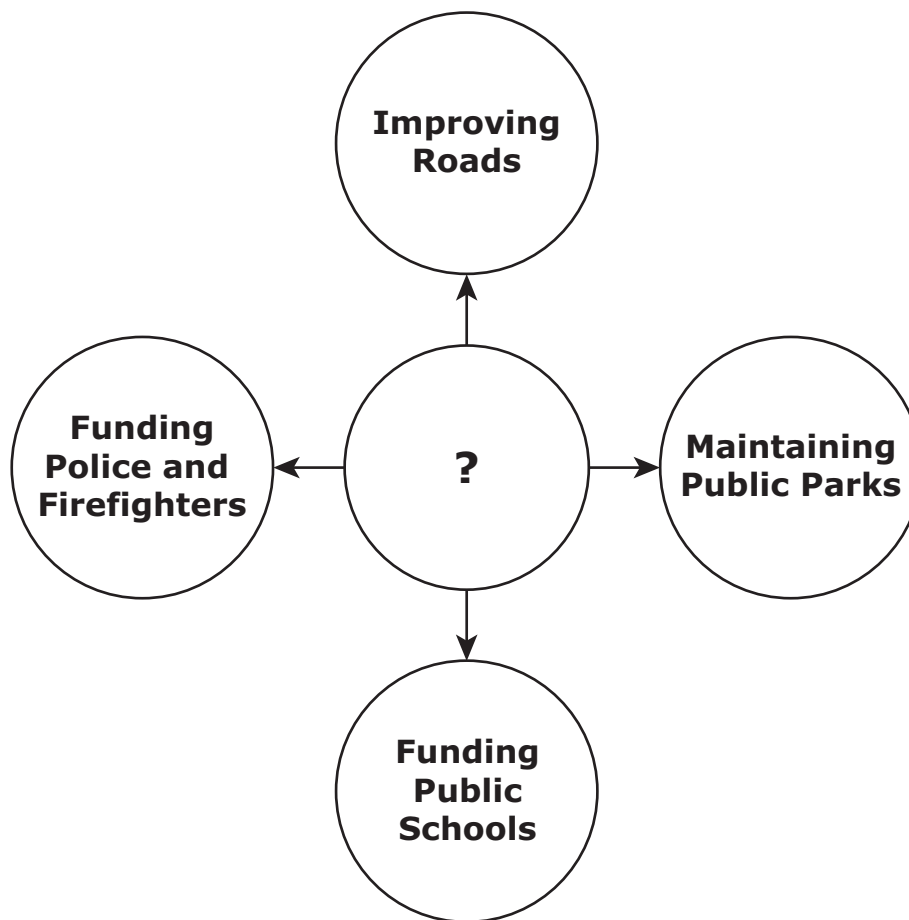
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.7

Benchmark Description: Identify the constitutional qualifications required to hold state and national office.

20. The diagram below shows outcomes of a civic obligation.



Which title describes the civic obligation that would result in these outcomes?

- Ⓐ Responsibility of Government to Enforce Laws
- Ⓑ Role of Voting in Controlling Government
- Ⓒ Role of Taxation in Providing Services
- Ⓓ Importance of Education in Society

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 69%

Reporting Category: Roles, Rights, and Responsibilities of Citizens

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.2

Benchmark Description: Differentiate between obligations and responsibilities of U.S. citizenship, and evaluate their impact on society.

21. The list below describes types of local governments.

The U.S. Census Bureau reported that in 2012 there were 89,004 local governments in the United States. Local governments included the following:

- 3,031 counties
- 19,522 municipalities
- 16,364 townships
- 37,203 special districts
- 12,884 independent school districts

Source: Public Domain/U.S. Census Bureau

Which generalization can be made about governments in the United States based on this list?

- Ⓐ Local governments collect more taxes than the federal government does.
- Ⓑ Local governments serve fewer people than the federal government does.
- Ⓒ The federal government has many more full-time employees than local governments do.
- Ⓓ The federal government has less direct interaction with the people than local governments do.

Answer Key: D

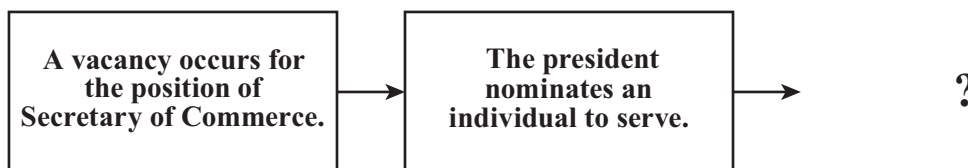
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.13

Benchmark Description: Explain government obligations to its citizens and the services provided at the local, state and national levels.

22. The diagram below describes a political process.



Which statement completes the diagram?

- Ⓐ The Senate votes to confirm or deny the appointment.
- Ⓑ The federal courts vote to confirm or deny the appointment.
- Ⓒ The state governors vote to confirm or deny the appointment.
- Ⓓ The House of Representatives votes to confirm or deny the appointment.

Answer Key: A

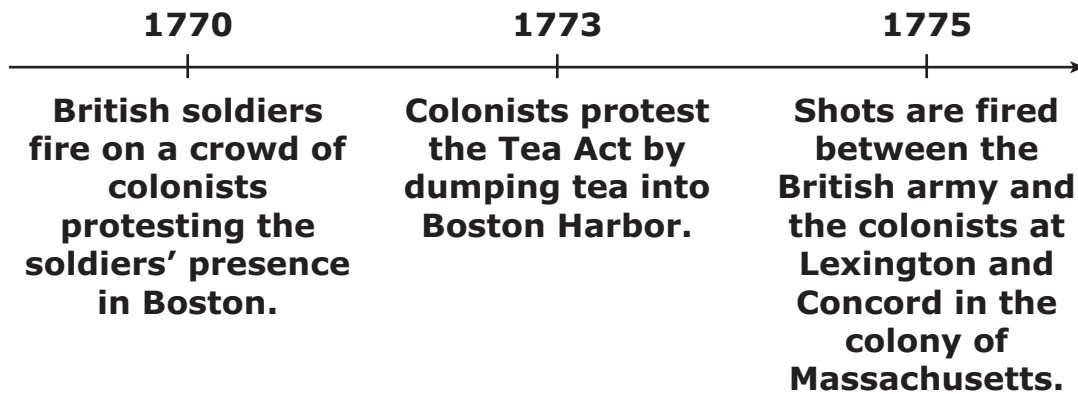
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.7

Benchmark Description: Explain the structure, functions and processes of the legislative branch of government.

- 23.** The timeline below details a series of events that occurred in the American colonies.



Based on this timeline, which conclusion can be drawn about English policies for colonial rule?

- Ⓐ English policies attempted to provoke the colonists into a war against the king.
- Ⓑ English policies compelled the colonists to acknowledge the sovereignty of the king.
- Ⓒ English policies were unable to address the economic downturn experienced by the colonies.
- Ⓓ English policies were unable to peacefully resolve the growing political tensions in the colonies.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 47%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.5

Benchmark Description: Describe how British policies and responses to colonial concerns led to the writing of the Declaration of Independence.

24. Which situation is an example of double jeopardy?

- Ⓐ A person is put on trial without a lawyer and found guilty.
- Ⓑ A person is found guilty after a trial and convicted of multiple crimes.
- Ⓒ A person is found guilty after a trial and receives an unreasonable sentence.
- Ⓓ A person is put on trial and found guilty of a crime for which he or she has already been tried.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Roles, Rights, and Responsibilities of Citizens

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.3

Benchmark Description: Identify and apply the rights contained in the Bill of Rights and other amendments to the U.S. Constitution.

25. How does a federal system of government differ from a unitary system?

- Ⓐ The central government passes laws in a federal system.
- Ⓑ States hold some government powers in a federal system.
- Ⓒ The central government collects taxes in a federal system.
- Ⓓ Voters elect some government leaders in a federal system.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 42%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.2

Benchmark Description: Explain the advantages of a federal system of government over other systems in balancing local sovereignty with national unity and protecting against authoritarianism.

26. The chart below shows functions of the legislative and executive branches in foreign policy.

FUNCTION IN FOREIGN POLICY

Legislative Branch	Executive Branch
?	Negotiate treaties

Which function completes the chart?

- Ⓐ Coin money
- Ⓑ Declare war
- Ⓒ Regulate pollution
- Ⓓ Punish counterfeiters

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.3

Benchmark Description: Describe the structure and function of the three branches of government established in the U.S. Constitution.

27. Why are people required to pass a U.S. citizenship test as part of the naturalization process?

- Ⓐ to create a safer society
- Ⓑ to create a healthier society
- Ⓒ to encourage a more informed citizenry
- Ⓓ to encourage a more privileged citizenry

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Roles, Rights, and Responsibilities of Citizens

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.1

Benchmark Description: Define the term “citizen,” and explain the constitutional means of becoming a U.S. citizen.

28. The photograph below was taken during the March on Washington for Jobs and Freedom in 1963.



Source: Library of Congress/Public Domain

Based on this photograph, which generalization can be made about how participating in this type of activity influences government?

- Ⓐ Participation demonstrates public concerns to elected officials.
- Ⓑ Participation restricts civil rights through organized assemblies.
- Ⓒ Participation discourages multiple perspectives about pending legislation.
- Ⓓ Participation increases money spent on advertising during election campaigns.

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Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.8

Benchmark Description: Examine the impact of media, individuals, and interest groups on monitoring and influencing government.

- 29.** The excerpt below is from President Abraham Lincoln’s Gettysburg Address.

. . . government of the people by the people for the people . . .

Source: Public Domain/National Archives and Records Administration

Which form of government does this excerpt describe?

- Ⓐ autocratic
- Ⓑ communist
- Ⓒ oligarchy
- Ⓓ republic

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze the advantages of the United States’ constitutional republic over other forms of government in safeguarding liberty, freedom and a representative government.

- 30.** The excerpt below is from a speech delivered by Alexander Hamilton in 1788.

Good constitutions are formed upon a comparison of the liberty of the individual with the strength of government: If the tone of either be too high, the other will be weakened too much.

Source: Library of Congress/Public Domain

How is Hamilton's opinion evident in the U.S. Constitution?

- Ⓐ by protecting individuals from strong leaders
- Ⓑ by sheltering government from social influences
- Ⓒ by joining the powers of individuals and government
- Ⓓ by balancing the powers of individuals and government

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 69%

Reporting Category: Roles, Rights, and Responsibilities of Citizens

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.4

Benchmark Description: Explain how the U.S. Constitution and the Bill of Rights safeguard individual rights.

31. Which action is an example of a foreign-policy decision?

- Ⓐ Congress passes a bill establishing Italian heritage month.
- Ⓑ Congress approves funds to modernize housing on a military base in Florida.
- Ⓒ The State Department honors a former U.S. ambassador to India with a Distinguished Service Award.
- Ⓓ The State Department issues a U.S. presidential permit for a bridge to be built from Michigan to Canada.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 48%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.4.1

Benchmark Description: Explain the relationship between U.S. foreign and domestic policy.

32. The political cartoon below is from a 1910 newspaper.



Source: Library of Congress—Chronicling America/Public Domain

This political cartoonist would likely argue that this situation involves a violation of which type of law?

- Ⓐ civil law
- Ⓑ juvenile law
- Ⓒ constitutional law
- Ⓓ administrative law

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 53%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.10

Benchmark Description: Identify sources and types of law.

33. Which document was an agreement by early American settlers that provided for self-government?

- Ⓐ The U.S. Constitution
- Ⓑ The Mayflower Compact
- Ⓒ The Articles of Confederation
- Ⓓ The Declaration of Independence

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.3

Benchmark Description: Trace the impact that the Magna Carta, Mayflower Compact, English Bill of Rights and Thomas Paine’s Common Sense had on colonists’ views of government.

34. The excerpt below is from Article II of the U.S. Constitution.

Article. II.

Section. 4.

The President, Vice President and all civil Officers of the United States, shall be removed from Office on Impeachment for, and Conviction of, Treason, Bribery, or other high Crimes and Misdemeanors.

Source: Library of Congress/Public Domain

How has the excerpt affected society in the United States?

- ☒ (A) No one is outside the law.
- ☐ (B) No one is without legal representation.
- ☐ (C) Everyone is subject to a grand jury indictment.
- ☐ (D) Everyone is guaranteed equal representation in government.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.11

Benchmark Description: Define the rule of law and recognize its influence on the development of legal, political and governmental systems in the United States.

35. The scenario below describes a local problem.

- 1) A storm destroys the bleachers at the local high school's football field.
- 2) The school board announces that it does not have the funds to replace the bleachers.
- 3) Student leaders announce their desire to have the bleachers replaced.
- 4) ?
- 5) Students attend a town council meeting to discuss the replacement of the bleachers.
- 6) The town council votes to fund replacement of the bleachers.

Which course of action should replace the question mark?

- Ⓐ Students call on athletes to boycott practices.
- Ⓑ Students collect signatures on a petition.
- Ⓒ Students organize a boycott of classes.
- Ⓓ Students disrupt a public meeting.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.10

Benchmark Description: Explain the process for citizens to address a state or local problem by researching public policy alternatives, identifying appropriate government agencies to address the issue and determining a course of action.

36. Which statement describes a difference between civil law and criminal law?

- Ⓐ Only civil cases can be appealed to the highest court.
- Ⓑ Criminal cases involve offenses harmful to the public.
- Ⓒ Civil cases involve offenses punishable by jail time.
- Ⓓ Only criminal cases are ruled on by a jury.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 64%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.10

Benchmark Description: Identify sources and types of law.

37. The actions described below are from the Declaration of Independence.

He has called together legislative bodies at places unusual, uncomfortable, and distant . . .
He has dissolved Representative Houses repeatedly . . .

Source: National Archives and Records Administration/Public Domain

How did these actions affect the colonists?

- Ⓐ Colonists were unable to pay their taxes.
- Ⓑ Colonists were unable to petition the king.
- Ⓒ Colonists were unable to participate in their government.
- Ⓓ Colonists were unable to play a part in community service.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.6

Benchmark Description: Analyze the ideas and grievances set forth in the Declaration of Independence.

38. How was the demand for women’s suffrage settled?

- Ⓐ A petition was addressed to the U.S. Supreme Court.
- Ⓑ An amendment was added to the U.S. Constitution.
- Ⓒ The U.S. President issued an executive order.
- Ⓓ The U.S. Congress passed a law.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Roles, Rights, and Responsibilities of Citizens

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.6

Benchmark Description: Analyze how the 13th, 14th, 15th, 19th, 24th and 26th Amendments broadened participation in the political process.

39. The poster below was published in 1943.



Source: National Archives and Records Administration/Public Domain

What was the purpose of this type of poster?

- Ⓐ to get people to buy a certain product
- Ⓑ to get people to act a certain way
- Ⓒ to get people to be sympathetic
- Ⓓ to get people to be caring

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Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 42%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.9

Benchmark Description: Analyze media and political communications and identify examples of bias, symbolism, and propaganda.

40. The passage below describes an event from the 1940s.

In 1947, the House Committee on Un-American Activities, an investigative congressional committee, held hearings regarding suspected communist propaganda in Hollywood films. By this time, many people in the U.S. government believed that communist ideas and actions were a danger to the American way of life. The witnesses brought before the committee were asked, “Are you now or have you ever been a member of the Communist Party?” A group of ten writers and directors labeled “unfriendly witnesses” refused to answer this question or name the names of other possible Communist Party members. They became known as the Hollywood Ten.

Which protection from the Bill of Rights did the Hollywood Ten attempt to use during these hearings?

- Ⓐ No person shall be compelled to testify against himself or herself.
- Ⓑ The accused shall be confronted with the witnesses against him or her.
- Ⓒ No person shall be subject for the same offense to be twice put in jeopardy.
- Ⓓ The accused shall have the compulsory process for obtaining witnesses in his or her favor.

Answer Key: A

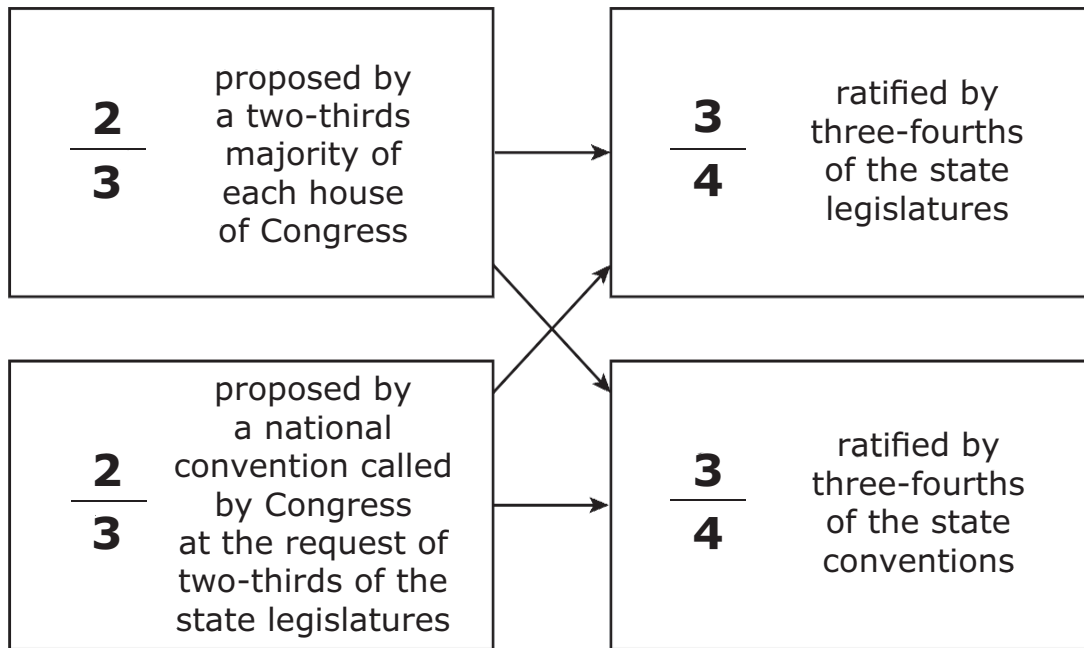
Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 53%

Reporting Category: Roles, Rights, and Responsibilities of Citizens

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.2.3

Benchmark Description: Identify and apply the rights contained in the Bill of Rights and other amendments to the U.S. Constitution.

41. The diagram below illustrates a process outlined in the U.S. Constitution.



Which title describes this process?

- ☒ (A) The Amendment Process
- ☐ (B) The Nomination Process
- ☐ (C) The Lawmaking Process
- ☐ (D) The Appellate Process

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.5

Benchmark Description: Explain the amendment process outlined in Article V of the U.S. Constitution.

42. Which constitutional issue is associated with the 1966 U.S. Supreme Court case of *Miranda v. Arizona*?

- Ⓐ rights of the government
- Ⓑ rights of the accused
- Ⓒ freedom of religion
- Ⓓ freedom of speech

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Roles, Rights, and Responsibilities of Citizens

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.11

Benchmark Description: Analyze the effects of landmark Supreme Court decisions on law, liberty and the interpretation of the U.S. Constitution.

43. Why do both the U.S. President and the U.S. Senate have the power to approve judges to the federal courts?

- ☒ Ⓐ to ensure that the branches work together
- ☐ Ⓑ to expand the power of the executive branch
- ☐ Ⓒ to increase the power of the legislative branch
- ☐ Ⓓ to ensure that the branches seek voter support

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 64%

Reporting Category: Organization and Function of Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.3.3

Benchmark Description: Describe the structure and function of the three branches of government established in the U.S. Constitution.

44. The information below is about the Marshall Plan.

When World War II ended in 1945, Europe lay in ruins: its cities were shattered; its economies were devastated; its people faced famine. . . . To meet this emergency, Secretary of State George Marshall proposed, in a speech at Harvard University on June 5, 1947, that European nations create a plan for their economic reconstruction and that the United States provide economic assistance. On December 19, 1947, President Harry Truman sent Congress a message that followed Marshall's ideas to provide economic aid to Europe. Congress overwhelmingly passed the Economic Cooperation Act of 1948, and on April 3, 1948, President Truman signed the act that became known as the Marshall Plan.

Source: Public Domain/National Archives and Records Administration

Which was a long-term result of the Marshall Plan on these European countries?

- Ⓐ Many have economies that are dependent on the United States.
- Ⓑ Many have been strong allies of the United States.
- Ⓒ Most have been strong supporters of communists.
- Ⓓ Most have parliamentary governments.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.4.3

Benchmark Description: Describe examples of the United States' actions and reactions in international conflicts.

45. During the ratification process, which complaint did the Anti-Federalists have with the U.S. Constitution?

- ☒ (A) It failed to protect individual rights.
- ☐ (B) It failed to recognize regional differences.
- ☐ (C) It failed to provide for fair local representation.
- ☐ (D) It failed to create a strong central government.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.10

Benchmark Description: Compare the viewpoints of the Federalists and the Anti-Federalists regarding ratification of the U.S. Constitution and including a bill of rights.

46. Why is it important to understand that U.S. domestic and foreign policies can be closely linked?

- Ⓐ Many U.S. government regulations influence both national and international businesses.
- Ⓑ Many U.S. government decisions influence both national and international actions.
- Ⓒ Many U.S. government laws involve both national and international procedures.
- Ⓓ Many U.S. government actions involve both national and international citizens.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 45%

Reporting Category: Government Policies and Political Processes

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.4.1

Benchmark Description: Explain the relationship between U.S. foreign and domestic policy.

47. The excerpt below was published by Montesquieu in 1748.

When the legislative and executive powers are united in the same person . . . there can be no liberty . . . Again, there is no liberty, if the power of judging be not separated from the legislative and executive powers.

Source: Excerpts from original publication published in 1823 titled: “The Spirit of Laws,” Vol. 1/Public Domain

How did these ideas influence the writers of the U.S. Constitution?

- Ⓐ The Constitution establishes a two-house legislature.
- Ⓑ The Constitution grants executive power over foreign policy.
- Ⓒ The Constitution makes the legislature the strongest branch of government.
- Ⓓ The Constitution distributes power among the three branches of government.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze how Enlightenment ideas, including Montesquieu’s view of separation of powers and John Locke’s theories related to natural law and Locke’s social contract, influenced the Founding.

48. Which purpose of the government as stated in the Preamble to the U.S. Constitution influenced the creation of a national court system?

- ☒ (A) establish justice
- ☐ (B) insure domestic tranquility
- ☐ (C) promote the general welfare
- ☐ (D) secure the blessings of liberty

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Origins and Purposes of Law and Government

Benchmark: SS.7.CG.1.8

Benchmark Description: Explain the purpose of the Preamble to the U.S. Constitution.



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Grade 4 B.E.S.T. Writing

Test Release: 2024

Grades 4–6 **B.E.S.T. Writing** **Expository Rubric**



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

The Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking (B.E.S.T.) Writing Rubric is a scoring tool that describes the characteristics of a written response for each score point within each domain. The rubric may assist educators with evaluating the strengths and weaknesses of student responses based on the test-based writing prompt/task included in the practice test (when available) as well as responses based on other text-based writing prompts/tasks educators choose in a classroom setting.

The B.E.S.T. Writing tests for all grade-levels (4–10) will be administered as computer-based assessments. Paper-based assessments will be available for students with an IEP or 504 plan that specifies the need for a paper-based accommodation.

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Florida Test Release Support Document

Grades 4-6 Expository Rubric Responses are scored holistically by domain and earn scores by demonstrating <i>most</i> of the descriptors in a given score point.*			
Score Point	Purpose/Structure	Development	Language
4 Above grade-level accomplishment demonstrated.	- Central idea is focused on the task and consistently maintained throughout. - Organizational structure strengthens the response and allows for advancement of the central idea. - Varied transitional strategies connect ideas within and among paragraphs, enhancing the progression of the response. - Effective introduction and conclusion enhance the essay.	- Skillful development demonstrates thorough understanding of the topic. - Effective elaboration may include original student writing combined with (but may not be limited to) paraphrasing, text evidence, examples, definitions, narrative, and/or rhetorical** techniques as appropriate to support the central idea. - Smoothly integrated, relevant evidence from multiple sources lends credibility to the essay. - Evidence is appropriately cited.	- Integration of academic vocabulary strengthens and furthers ideas. - Skillful use of varied sentence structure contributes to fluidity of ideas. - Use of standard English grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling demonstrates consistent command of the communication of ideas. - Tone and/or voice strengthens the overall response.
3 Within the range of grade-level performance.	- Central idea is focused on the task and generally maintained throughout. - Organizational structure is logical and allows for advancement of the central idea. - Varied transitional strategies connect ideas within and among paragraphs. - Sufficient introduction and conclusion contribute to a sense of completeness.	- Logical development demonstrates understanding of the topic. - Adequate elaboration may include (but may not be limited to) a combination of original student writing with paraphrasing, text evidence, examples, definitions, narrative, and/or rhetorical** techniques as appropriate to support the central idea. - Relevant, integrated evidence from multiple sources lends credibility to the exposition. - Evidence is appropriately cited.	- Integration of academic vocabulary demonstrates clear expression of ideas. - Sentence structure is varied and demonstrates grade-appropriate language facility. - Use of grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling demonstrates grade-appropriate command of standard English conventions. - Tone and/or voice is appropriate for the overall response.
2 Approaching the range of grade-level performance.	- Central idea may be unclear, loosely related, or insufficiently sustained within the task. - Organizational structure may be repetitive or inconsistent, disrupting the advancement of ideas. - Transitions attempt to connect ideas but may lack variety. - Introduction and conclusion may be present but repetitive, simplistic, or otherwise ineffective.	- Development may demonstrate partial or incomplete understanding of the topic. - Elaboration may attempt to develop the central idea but may rely heavily on the sources, provide loosely related information, be repetitive or otherwise ineffective. - Evidence may be partially integrated and/or related to the topic but unsupportive of or disconnected from the exposition. - Lacks appropriate citations.	- Vocabulary and word choice may be imprecise or basic, demonstrating partial command of expression of ideas. - Sentence structure may be partially controlled, somewhat simplistic, or lacking grade-appropriate language facility. - Inconsistent use of correct grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling may contain multiple distracting errors, demonstrating partial command of standard English conventions. - Tone and/or voice may be inconsistent. - May be grammatically accurate but too brief to demonstrate grade-appropriate command of language skills.
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*Citation is not a holistic consideration. Without citation, the highest score possible in *Development* is a 2.

**Grade 6

Writing Prompt

Write an expository essay about how trained dogs can help others.

Your expository essay must be based on this prompt and topic, and it must incorporate ideas and information found in the sources provided.

Use your best writing to complete an essay that

- is focused on your central idea;
- combines evidence from multiple sources with your own elaboration to develop your ideas;
- is organized and includes transitions within and among ideas;
- provides citations for quoted material and source ideas; and
- demonstrates correct use of grammar and language appropriate to the task.

Write your multiparagraph essay to an academic audience in the space provided.

Read the “Trained Dogs” sources.

Trained Dogs

Source 1: Working Like a Dog

by Amy Tao

- 1 Dogs have been helping people for thousands of years—guiding, guarding, finding, fetching, hauling, and hugging!
- 2 Seeing Eye dogs are trained to be the eyes for people who cannot see. They let their owners know when something is blocking the way, where stairs or sidewalks end, when it’s safe to cross the street, and more.
- 3 Dogs guide animals too. They work hard herding sheep or goats, helping farmers move their flocks from pen to pasture and back home again.
- 4 Some farm dogs guard the sheep instead of herding. They blend in with the flock and watch for danger. If a wolf or other enemy comes too close, they’ll bark and scare it away.
- 5 With their super noses, dogs are great at sniffing out lost or hidden items. Some of the things they’re trained to find include missing people, **endangered** plants and animals, and bedbugs and other pests.
- 6 Lots of dogs like to play fetch. For some, fetching is their job too. It’s hard for [a person] in a wheelchair to reach things sometimes. [Service dogs are] happy to help.
- 7 One of the best ways to move loads across snowy ground is by dogsled. Way before trucks, trains, or planes were invented, people relied on strong dogs to pull carts and sleds packed with supplies.
- 8 Certified therapy dogs regularly visit patients at many hospitals. Hugging and petting a friendly dog might not cure you, but it just might make you feel better when you’re sick or lonely.

Glossary

endangered: at risk of disappearing forever

“Working Like a Dog” by Amy Tao, from Click. Copyright © 2018 by Carus Publishing. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 2: Shyla, the Seeing Eye Puppy

by Susan Yoder Ackerman

This source describes what it is like to raise and train a seeing eye service dog.

9 Last year, when my big brother Jed got Shyla, he said I could help take care of her. He said the whole family needed to help. Shyla was the cutest little black Labrador retriever puppy, but we didn't get her just because she was soft and playful. . . . Jed said that in about a year, we'd give Shyla back to The Seeing Eye. And then she'd be ready to learn to be a dog guide for someone who can't see. A year seemed like a long time back then. Now it feels way too short.

10 "She can sleep in my bed," I told Jed, but he said Shyla could never sleep on any furniture, not even the couch. He rolled out his sleeping bag and snuggled down with her on the floor by his bed. I put my sleeping bag on the other side of her.

11 "Remember, Courtney, everything we do for Shyla is because of the blind person she'll work for later on," Jed said to me. He had his arm around Shyla and his eyes were closed. Funny how Jed is usually so shy, but he could talk forever about Shyla. "If her blind person wakes up in the night and needs her, Shyla will have to be right there on the floor by the bed."

12 When I woke up early the next morning, Jed was already heading out the back door with Shyla in his arms. I hurried to go along. I thought maybe we'd all play in the yard before breakfast. But Jed said no. It wasn't playtime. Our puppy needed to learn to go to the bathroom outside. Jed brought her back in right away, saying "Good dog!" . . .

13 Everything was more fun with Shyla around. Even dinner time. Jed trained Shyla to lie on the floor near his left foot every time he ate. "That's where the blind person will need her to be," he explained. . . .

14 After Shyla was 13 weeks old and had her puppy shots, we took her everywhere—on a leash, of course. That was so she wouldn't be scared of anything. Like the roar of the engine when the school bus turned around the corner of our street. Or crowds of strangers.

15 When Shyla saw a squirrel **frisking** up a tree or a raccoon snuffling around at the edge of the garden, we held the leash and taught her to keep walking forward. How could she help a blind person if she ran off to follow every animal she saw? . . .

16 Jed said we had to show Shyla lots of things, to help her learn the difference between dangerous things and normal things. When she's a

guide dog, if she sees some danger a blind person can't see, like a car coming fast instead of stopping for a red light, she mustn't lead her owner there—even if she is told to.

17 Full-grown Seeing Eye dogs and their owners are allowed to go into any public place, even a restaurant. But restaurants can say no to puppies. When we ate out, we took Shyla whenever we could. I like to think of her walking calmly into a nice restaurant someday, with her blind owner holding onto the stiff leather handle on her harness. I can picture Shyla lying on the floor next to her owner, ready to help.

18 Last week our year was up. Shyla went back to The Seeing Eye. She was so big and brave. Mom said it was like she was going off to college.

Glossary

frisking: skipping or leaping

Excerpt from "Shyla, the Seeing Eye Puppy" by Susan Yoder Ackerman, from Click. Copyright © 2002 by Carus Publishing. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 3: Animals on My Mind

by Susan Wroble

This source discusses oxytocin, which is a hormone, something natural that your body produces. Oxytocin makes people feel safe and happy.

19 When you pet your dog or snuggle with a purring cat, your body and brain calm down. Why? Scientists are studying the effects of human-animal interactions to try to find out.

The Cuddle Chemical

20 In the United States, more than two-thirds of families have pets. Researchers asked children about their most important relationships. Kids listed pets right along with their immediate family and best friends. And you may not be surprised at this finding: many kids rely more on their dogs for comfort than on their siblings. . . .

21 Imagine cuddling with your dog and staring into his soft brown eyes. You get a feeling of happiness from the release of oxytocin—

and so does your dog. This helps create a strong attachment called a human-animal bond.

The Waffle Study

- 22 A team of researchers in Denver conducted a study on the human-animal bond. . . . [A]round the hospital, people called it “the Waffle study.” The study had nothing to do with breakfast foods. Instead, Waffle is a highly trained dog. She works with human partner Elizabeth Holman. Holman is a psychologist who helps people with emotions and behavior. In the study, each patient received two visits. Holman and Waffle visited once together, and Holman visited once alone. When Waffle came along, she usually jumped up on the hospital bed. The patients snuggled with Waffle while they talked with Holman. Before, during, and after each visit, staff monitored patients. . . .
- 23 The results showed that visits with Holman helped the patients. They had fewer signs of stress after talking to her. But patients were even calmer after they’d met with both Holman and Waffle. The study proved that having a dog like Waffle in a hospital can reduce stress. And this helps keep patients healthy.

Excerpt from “Animals on My Mind” by Susan Wroble, from Muse. Copyright © 2018 by Carus Publishing. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company via Copyright Clearance Center.



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

Grade 5 B.E.S.T. Writing

Test Release: 2024

Grades 4–6 **B.E.S.T. Writing** **Argumentation Rubric**



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

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**Grade 6

Writing Prompt

Write an argumentative essay about whether technology has positive or negative effects in schools.

Your argumentative essay must be based on this prompt and topic, and it must incorporate ideas and evidence found in the sources provided.

Use your best writing to complete an essay that

- is focused on your claim;
- combines evidence from multiple sources with your own elaboration to develop your ideas;
- is organized and includes transitions within and among ideas;
- provides citations for quoted material and source ideas; and
- demonstrates correct use of grammar and language appropriate to the task.

Write your multiparagraph essay to an academic audience in the space provided.

Read the “Classroom Technology” sources.

Classroom Technology

Source 1: Could You Live without Your Phone?

by Kathryn Hulick

- 1 What would you do with your time if you couldn’t use a cell phone, computer, or other digital device? . . .
- 2 Many schools and other organizations have tried some form of a “tech timeout” or “unplug challenge.” In these experiments, groups of people give up their digital devices for a few days.
- 3 The experts running these challenges argue that technology often distracts us from more important things—like face-to-face conversations, creative projects, and enjoying the outdoors. Ideally, taking away technology would increase your enjoyment of the real world, here and now.
- 4 Sometimes that’s what happens. Esther Laver . . . voluntarily took part in an experiment where she gave up social media for as long as she could. She lasted two weeks. “I really didn’t mind being without it,” she told *The Guardian*. “I got to sleep earlier. It was nice having more time.”
- 5 But other teens feel that tech breaks just aren’t worth it. [Student] Tim Chai decided not to attend a certain summer camp because he wouldn’t be allowed to bring his phone or computer. “I just thought it was too much for me to handle,” he told the Associated Press.
- 6 Boredom is one issue for [students] like Chai, but the biggest problem is disconnecting from friends. Janice De Costa . . . gave up social media for one week. “I had a lot of anxiety in the evenings on the first couple of days,” she told *The Guardian*. “I didn’t know what was going on. . . . One of my best friends from secondary school had a birthday party, and I missed it.”

Excerpt from “Could You Live without Your Phone?” by Kathryn Hulick, from *Muse*. Copyright © 2017 by *Muse*. Reprinted by permission of Cricket Media via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 2: Keeping Up in the Classroom

by Skip Newcastle

- 7 Do you know what an abacus is? Sometimes called a “counting frame,” it is a tool that people once used to do simple math before the number system we have now. With beads that slide and rattle around on rows of thin sticks, it looks like a children’s toy. For many years, this is how people learned addition and subtraction.
- 8 It may be hard to imagine for today’s learners, though, who can just turn to a calculator or even their phones to add and subtract. Technology has certainly come a long way since the ancient Romans and their math tools. Beyond just math, however, technology is everywhere in classrooms and schools around the world. It changes how teachers teach and how students learn.
- 9 For starters, the same tool that students may want to use to look up information about the habitats of gorillas or the diet of a polar bear can also be the very tool that distracts students from doing their work. After all, as of 2017, the average person has 60–90 apps downloaded on his or her cell phone or tablet and uses 9 of those apps every day. You can bet that some of those apps are games. You can also bet that when a teacher isn’t looking, there are students who try to play games, look at the Internet, or message their friends instead of doing their assigned task.
- 10 For teachers, it means they have to spend more time setting rules and taking away distractions. It can also be a struggle for teachers to create lesson plans that are educational and interesting to students at the same time. As many students will tell you, too, kids are often more aware of how to use new technology than their teachers. This can lead to frustrated teachers who try to use technology that fails or needs outside support, and it can become a big time-waster in classrooms where every second of a lesson is valuable.
- 11 Some teachers have also become concerned about how much they see students using technology, rather than their brains, to problem solve. Instead of trying to think through a complex math problem or have a discussion where they form their own opinions, students can start to rely on search engines to provide their answers or opinions.
- 12 Beyond teachers and students, too, entire schools can find it difficult to keep up with technology, which is always changing. Just when you think your school has the most recent version of a new online social studies game or math puzzle, a more recent version comes out. This means the old version might not be able to be used, and it can lead to even more time wasted waiting for updates.

Updates often cost money, too, so it can become costly to stay current in the classroom.

- 13 But for every concern that people have about technology in the classroom, there are reasons it is valuable to keep up. For starters, technology is always changing. Outside schools and classrooms, **innovation** happens every day. For students to be well-rounded, they need to have some knowledge about how to use technology. There are plenty of educators who argue that they have a responsibility to not just use technology in their classrooms, but also to show students the right ways to use it.
- 14 Technology can also help connect students in many ways. Students and teachers can video conference with students in another country. Using **virtual reality**, students can experience what it's like to hike along a trail at the Grand Canyon or explore the Great Wall of China.
- 15 When teachers include technology in their lessons, it can make school exciting for some students who might not have enjoyed learning before. Every student learns in a different way, and interactive computer games can give students opportunities to learn new skills and be excited about learning.

Glossary

innovation: a new idea, device, or method

virtual reality: electronic equipment that creates a computer-made environment that can be interacted with in a seemingly real or physical way

"Keeping Up in the Classroom" by Skip Newcastle. Written for educational purposes.

Source 3: A Tool That Can Help or Hinder

by Mary Kate Brown

- 16 The classroom has evolved over time, perhaps nothing transforming it more than the introduction of technology. Technology allows for a type of flexible learning that is unique to twenty-first-century classrooms.
- 17 Traditional chalkboards can be replaced with digital whiteboards. Towers of textbooks can be traded in for electronic books on compact tablets. Lesson plans can include links to videos and images that

make lessons come to life. The use of technology in the classroom has greatly affected the way students learn—some say for better, and others say for worse.

- 18 Today’s students have grown up with technology. Many of them knew how to navigate their way through apps and games before they could even tie their shoes. Putting a student in a classroom without technology can be likened to putting a fish in sand and expecting it to swim. Technology is a part of these students’ everyday lives. They expect it.
- 19 Not only are students familiar with technology, but it can be customized to be familiar with them. In other words, technology allows for **customization** that can support different kinds of learners. For example, Ryan Greene, an Instructional Design and Technology graduate, uses technology in his classroom to give students a more personalized experience.
- 20 “Kids who might want to draw during the entire class can now create an **infographic** to demonstrate their capabilities and understanding of the content, which I might not have previously seen or assessed,” Greene said.
- 21 Technology can benefit teachers, too. For example, some teachers use online surveys or quizzes to get instant feedback. In a matter of moments, teachers can measure students’ knowledge of a topic. That is, when the technology works. Most people know all too well the frustration of error messages and crashed browsers.
- 22 As engaging as technology might be, some people worry that it **hinders** more than it helps. One study suggested that students who were using laptops in a classroom struggled to pay attention to the lesson. It also showed that those students were likely to earn lower grades. Why? They were distracted. The problem, however, some experts say, is not the tool, but the user. These experts say that students need to learn how to make the choice to pay attention—laptop or not.
- 23 Regardless of one’s position on the use of technology in education, the fact remains that the future expects people to have this life skill. The demand for workers who know how to use technology to research, create, and communicate is only expected to increase in coming years.
- 24 Technology is nothing more than a tool. Whether classrooms rely heavily on technology or don’t use it at all, all learning environments have one thing in common. It is the teacher, not the tool, who engages students in meaningful learning. And it is the student who is ultimately responsible to learn.

Glossary

customization: a change made to something in order to fit the needs of the person who uses it

infographic: a collection of images, charts, and text that gives an easy-to-understand overview of a topic

hinders: slows down or makes difficult

"A Tool That Can Help or Hinder" by Mary Kate Brown. Written for educational purposes



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**Grade 6

Writing Prompt

Write an argumentative essay about whether it is better to spend time with people online or in person.

Your argumentative essay must be based on this prompt and topic, and it must incorporate ideas and evidence found in the sources provided.

Use your best writing to complete an essay that

- is focused on your claim;
- combines evidence from multiple sources with your own elaboration to develop your ideas;
- is organized and includes transitions within and among ideas;
- provides citations for quoted material and source ideas; and
- demonstrates correct use of grammar and language appropriate to the task.

Write your multiparagraph essay to an academic audience in the space provided.

Read the “Online Friends” sources.

Online Friends

Source 1: The New Types of Friendship

by Mariah Sharples

- 1 When Cassie Myers moved from Boston to Seattle, she knew that there would be a period of adjusting to her new home. “It’s scary knowing that you have to make new friends when everyone has known each other for years.” Luckily, however, she won’t be completely alone. If Cassie needs advice, her friends from Boston are only a text message away.
- 2 “On the first day of school, my friends in Boston helped me pick out my outfit,” Cassie says. “It helped me feel confident. And I looked awesome.” Cassie now has a new group of friends in Seattle, but she keeps in touch with her old ones daily.
- 3 In the past, friendships like Cassie’s would have been difficult, delayed by the mail or Internet speed. Now, cell phones and messaging apps can bridge 3,000 miles. With the average tween spending six hours daily interacting with digital technology, it makes sense that maintaining friendships would be a part of that time. In digital space, it doesn’t really matter if your friend is across town or across the country.
- 4 Online spaces are also serving the same purpose for tweens as the mall did for their parents. Describing the time he spends in a popular online video game, blogger Owen Williams wrote, “Even for friends that live close, in the same city, we catch up far more often through the game, popping on for a few quick rounds and talking about what’s new at the same time.”
- 5 Researchers call this a “third place.” The idea is that kids interact at home (the first place) and at school (the second place). Having a third place is important because it gives people a way to hang out and build friendships. Social scientists are finding that, for tweens and teens, the Internet is often a valid third place. The idea that spending time online means being alone is outdated for many people under 18.
- 6 The Internet can bring people together through shared interests too. Antonio Vargas went to an anime and manga convention with his parents last spring and came back with the screen names of five new friends. “We have a group chat where we talk about our favorite characters and give each other recommendations,” he said. “It’s cool because my friends from school don’t like anime. They don’t

have to listen to me ramble anymore because I can just message my convention friends about it.”

- 7 Antonio’s two types of friendships might look odd from the outside, but he likes it this way. “I think I have more friends than a lot of people,” he said. “They’re just more spread out.”

“The New Types of Friendship” by Mariah Sharples. Written for educational purposes.

Source 2: How Family Card Games Teach Math, Memory and Self-Confidence

by Sue Shellenbarger

- 8 Card games can teach math and memory skills, as well as strategic thinking, psychologists and sociologists say. Also, the conversation and friendly rivalry that come with sitting down to play cards can strengthen family ties. Family games also can build children’s confidence: The rules are the same for everyone, and it is fun to play a game in which anyone can win.

- 9 “To be able to compete against parents and sometimes win is symbolically important to kids. They get a sense that ‘my time is coming,’ a little foretaste of not being under the parent’s thumb,” says William Doherty, professor of family social science at the University of Minnesota in St. Paul. Children also can learn to win and lose gracefully, he says—“to be happy but not gloat, and to lose and not pout.”

- 10 Card games generally aren’t rocket science, but for many families, the ease and fun are half the point. Mary Brett and her husband Craig, a cardiologist, have kept their four children, ages 15 to 21, interested in playing cards by making sure the children see their parents enjoying the game. “We can make fun of each other and not take it too seriously,” says Ms. Brett, of Cape Elizabeth, Maine. Dr. Brett sometimes dons crazy hats to lighten the mood. Their 15-year-old daughter Bridget says, “Seeing my parents go back and forth, I will tell you, is one of the funniest things I’ve ever seen.” . . .

- 11 Card-playing has honed her children’s memory skills and taught them to plan competitive strategies in advance, Ms. Brett says. Bridget, who struggled with basic math as a young child, says playing cards helped her gain confidence and skill.

- 12 At a time when children’s schedules are packed and digital distractions are everywhere, youthful card sharks are increasingly rare. “A whole generation of consumers didn’t learn to play cards the way an entire prior generation did,” says P.J. Katien, vice president, sales and marketing, for the U.S. Playing Card Co. . . .

- 13 Both card and board games are linked in research to better math skills in small children. Both create opportunities for face-to-face play, conversation, taking turns and following rules. . . .
- 14 Traditional card games can be more engaging in other ways, however. For small children, card games tend to provide more counting and matching practice. Shuffling and dealing cards can instill greater manual dexterity.¹ And skilled card-playing often calls for more nuanced social skills, such as bluffing one’s opponents into unwise bets. Some grandparents impress youngsters with their skills in counting cards—remembering which cards have been played so they can anticipate opponents’ next move.
- 15 Fifteen-year-old Matthew Siegel says learning to keep a poker face while playing Texas Hold ‘em with his grandfather, 78-yearold Victor Spetalnick of Valley Stream, N.Y., has served him well at school. “I’ve had my share of being teased, and keeping a straight face and not looking like it’s getting on your nerves is helpful,” says Matthew, of Armonk, N.Y. . . .
- 16 Playing cards is an easy way for several different generations to sit down together, and grandparents and parents say games afford an unusual opportunity to bond with children. “It’s much better than sitting across the table from one of your kids and saying, ‘Tell me about your day,’” says Ms. Copeland, the author [of *Family Fun Night* and other parenting books]. “You learn so much more about each other in the context of a playful setting.” Carl Harnick, 80, and his wife Fran, 77, have maintained a family card-playing tradition for years by making it part of a biweekly ritual of baby-sitting for their two grandchildren, Isabella Harnick, 15, and her brother Ben, 10. The four go out for dinner and ice cream, and then they play Kings in the Corners, a variation on solitaire, says Mr. Harnick of Lake Success, N.Y., a retired accountant. Ms. Harnick, a retired teacher, says the best part of cardplaying is the conversation: “We learn about their friends and what’s going on at school.”
- 17 Isabella says playing cards has changed her views on competition. An avid soccer player, she has occasionally seen opponents have a meltdown if they miss a goal, she says—an attitude she has come to regard as “ridiculous.”
- 18 “You don’t win everything in cards. You can’t expect to win everything in life either,” she says.

¹manual dexterity: the ability to use one’s hands for small, coordinated movements

Source 3: This Year, Make an Investment in Your Friendships

by Carl Richards

- 19 Over a year ago I moved to New Zealand with my family. It has been amazing in so many ways, but I do have to admit to being lonely sometimes.
- 20 I miss my friends. I miss the friends who have celebrated with me during moments of great joy and have mourned with me when times were tough.
- 21 There is a sense of connection that comes from sharing one another's burdens that is impossible to replicate with a "like" or a tweet. Deep friendship requires an investment of time and energy, and that seems harder now that there are so many shallow, counterfeit versions of friendship that give us the false sense of being connected but lack any depth.
- 22 To address this feeling, I've decided to invest in friendship and human connection this year. And it feels contrived.¹ Who needs a plan for friendship?!
- 23 But the reality is that these investments won't happen without me being purposeful about it. So I've started by scheduling time to connect with old friends and then more time to develop friendships with people who I want to know better. In some cases, it's a monthly video chat, while in others it's just a little note to remind myself to call someone out of the blue.
- 24 Brad Feld, a partner at the venture capital firm Foundry Group, has been scheduling an annual trip with his father for years. They pick a place, schedule a weekend and go. There's not a ton on the agenda. They take walks, take naps and eat chocolate ice cream twice a day, since that is his father's favorite food. Now, he takes time away from investing in companies to take an annual trip with his three oldest male friends too.
- 25 Part of the reason I find these kinds of investments in real connection so enticing is that I can measure the returns they've paid for me in the past. They quite literally make my life richer, and I've noticed a deeper sense of well-being when I have invested more than usual. One additional unexpected payoff: I seem to do higher quality work when I connect more with interesting people. I think they inspire me to do better and be better.

¹contrived: forced or fake



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

Grade 7 B.E.S.T. Writing

Test Release: 2024

Grades 7–10 **B.E.S.T. Writing** **Argumentation Rubric**



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

The Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking (B.E.S.T.) Writing Rubric is a scoring tool that describes the characteristics of a written response for each score point within each domain. The rubric may assist educators with evaluating the strengths and weaknesses of student responses based on the text-based writing prompt/task included in the practice test (when available) as well as responses based on other text-based writing prompts/tasks educators choose in a classroom setting.

The B.E.S.T. Writing tests for all grade levels (4–10) will be administered as computer-based assessments. Paper-based assessments will be available for students with an IEP or 504 plan that specifies the need for a paper-based accommodation.

The B.E.S.T. Writing Assessment were administered for the first time during the spring 2023 administration as a field test given to a representative sample of Florida students. Beginning with the 2023–24 school year, B.E.S.T. Writing has been administered once per year during the spring; however, it is not associated with any of the three progress monitoring events.

Florida Test Release Support Document

Grades 7-10 Argumentation Rubric Responses are scored holistically by domain and earn scores by demonstrating <i>most</i> of the descriptors in a given score point.*			
Score Point	Purpose/Structure	Development	Language
4 Above grade-level accomplishment demonstrated.	- Position** is focused on the task and consistently maintained throughout. - Organizational structure strengthens the response and allows for the advancement of the argument. - Purposeful transitional strategies connect ideas within and among paragraphs, creating cohesion. - Effective introduction and conclusion enhance the essay.	- Skillful development demonstrates thorough understanding of the topic. - Effective elaboration may include original student writing combined with (but may not be limited to) paraphrasing, text evidence, examples, definitions, narrative, and/or rhetorical techniques as appropriate to enhance the argument. - Smoothly integrated, relevant evidence from multiple sources lends credibility to the argument. - Grade-level expectations for counterclaim(s) are fully addressed. - Evidence is appropriately cited.	- Integration of academic vocabulary strengthens and furthers ideas. - Skillful use of varied sentence structure contributes to fluidity of ideas. - Use of standard English grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling demonstrates consistent command of the communication of ideas. - Tone and/or voice strengthens the overall argument.
3 Within the range of grade-level performance.	- Position** is focused on the task and generally maintained throughout. - Organizational structure is logical and allows for the advancement of the argument. - Purposeful transitional strategies connect ideas within and among paragraphs. - Sufficient introduction and conclusion contribute to a sense of completeness.	- Logical development demonstrates understanding of the topic. - Adequate elaboration may include (but may not be limited to) a combination of original student writing with paraphrasing, text evidence, examples, definitions, narrative, and/or rhetorical techniques as appropriate to support the argument. - Relevant, integrated evidence from multiple sources lends credibility to the argument. - Grade-level expectations for counterclaim(s) are sufficiently addressed. - Evidence is appropriately cited.	- Integration of academic vocabulary demonstrates clear expression of ideas. - Sentence structure is varied and demonstrates grade-appropriate language facility. - Use of grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling demonstrates grade-appropriate command of standard English conventions. - Tone and/or voice is appropriate for the overall argument.
2 Approaching the range of grade-level performance.	- Position** may be unclear, loosely related, or insufficiently sustained within the task. - Organizational structure may be repetitive or inconsistent, disrupting the advancement of ideas. - Transitions attempt to connect ideas but may lack purpose and/or variety. - Introduction and conclusion may be present but repetitive, simplistic, or otherwise ineffective.	- Development may demonstrate partial or incomplete understanding of the topic. - Elaboration may attempt to develop the argument but may rely heavily on the sources, provide loosely related information, be repetitive or otherwise ineffective. - Evidence may be partially integrated and/or related to the topic but unsupportive of or disconnected from the argument. - Grade-level expectations for counterclaim(s) are insufficiently addressed. - Lacks appropriate citations.	- Vocabulary and word choice may be imprecise or basic, demonstrating partial command of expression of ideas. - Sentence structure may be partially controlled, somewhat simplistic, or lacking grade-appropriate language facility. - Inconsistent use of correct grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling; may contain multiple distracting errors, demonstrating partial command of standard English conventions. - Tone and/or voice may be inconsistent. - May be grammatically accurate but too brief to demonstrate grade-appropriate command of language skills.
1 Below grade-level performance demonstrated.	- Position** may be absent, ambiguous, or confusing, demonstrating lack of awareness of task. - Demonstrates little or no discernible organizational structure. - Transitions may be absent or confusing. - Introduction and conclusion may be unrelated to the response and/or create confusion. - Too brief to demonstrate knowledge of purpose, structure, or task.	- Response may demonstrate lack of understanding of the topic and/or lack of development. - Elaboration may consist of confusing ideas or demonstrate lack of knowledge of elaborative techniques. - Evidence from the sources may be absent, vague, and/or confusing. - Counterclaim(s) are absent or confusing. - Lacks appropriate citations. - Too brief to demonstrate knowledge of elaboration, topic, or sources.	- Vocabulary and word choice may be vague, unclear, or confusing. - Sentence structure may be simplistic or confusing. - Use of grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling may contain a density and variety of severe errors, demonstrating lack of command of standard English conventions, often obscuring meaning. - Tone and/or voice may be inappropriate. - Brevity with errors demonstrates lack of command of language skills.

*Citation is not a holistic consideration. Without citation, the highest score possible in Development is 2.

**Claim in Grade 7 benchmarks

Writing Prompt

Write an argumentative essay about whether or not plastic water bottles should be banned.

Your argumentative essay must be based on this prompt and topic, and it must incorporate ideas and evidence found in the sources provided.

Use your best writing to complete an essay that

- is focused on your claim;
- combines evidence from multiple sources with your own elaboration to develop your ideas;
- acknowledges at least one counterclaim;
- is organized and includes transitions within and among ideas;
- provides citations for quoted material and source ideas; and
- demonstrates correct use of grammar and language appropriate to the task.

Write your multiparagraph essay to an academic audience in the space provided.

Read the “Bottled Water Ban” sources.

Bottled Water Ban

Source 1: Why Tap Water Is Better Than Bottled Water

by Solvie Karlstrom and Christine Dell’Amore

- 1 Bottled water is a drain on the environment: The U.S. public goes through about 50 billion water bottles a year, and most of those plastic containers are not recycled, according to Elizabeth Royte’s 2008 book *Bottlemania: How Water Went on Sale and Why We Bought It*.
- 2 Transporting the bottles and keeping them cold also burns fossil fuels, which give off greenhouse gases. And groundwater pumping by bottled-water companies draws heavily on underground aquifers and harms watersheds, according to the Sierra Club, an environmental nonprofit. And according to some estimates, it takes up to three liters of water to produce one liter of bottled water.
- 3 Yet more than U.S. \$100 billion is spent every year on bottled water globally. In many cities in developing countries where there is not a safe source of tap water,¹ bottled water becomes a somewhat trusted option.
- 4 But in the U.S., where tap water is federally regulated and often screened for dangerous pollutants, the public drinks 21 gallons (79 liters) of bottled water per capita per year on average, according to the Columbia Water Center at Columbia University’s Earth Institute in New York. The bottled-water industry is so successful, it has outpaced milk, coffee, and juice in number of gallons of drinks. . . .

Water Bottle Bans

- 5 Though the sale and consumption of bottled water is still on the rise, certain policymakers and activists have taken steps to reduce it and encourage people to drink tap. In September 2009, the Australian city of Bundanoon became the first city in the world to completely ban² bottled water from its stores’ shelves, installing water fountains around the city instead.
- 6 Among U.S. cities that have taken action are San Francisco and

¹tap water: water that comes from a faucet or sink

²ban: to restrict or prohibit by law

Seattle, which no longer buy water for city use, and Chicago, which added a five-cent tax on each bottle. Several restaurants in those cities have also given up bottled for filtered tap. Other cities are also considering taking action. . . .

Health Costs

- 7 Not only does bottled water contribute to excessive waste, but it costs us a thousand times more than water from our faucet at home, and it's likely no safer or cleaner, experts say. A 2008 investigation by the nonprofit Environmental Working Group found some bottled water is sullied with untested industrial chemicals and may not necessarily be cleaner than tap water. . . .
- 8 More than 80 percent of recyclable plastic bottles end up in landfills each year. They do not break down naturally and release toxic chemicals when they finally do decompose, according to the Columbia Water Center.

Excerpt from "Why Tap Water Is Better Than Bottled Water" by Solvie Karlstrom and Christine Dell'Amore. Copyright © 2010 by National Geographic. Reprinted by permission of National Geographic via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 2: Bottled Water Is Silly—But So Is Banning It

by Charles Fishman

- 9 I remember the moment when the silliness of bottled water became vividly clear to me. . . .
- 10 It's refreshing, it's appealing, but it is pure indulgence. . . .
- 11 In fact, unless you're struggling in the aftermath of a natural disaster, unless you live in a developing world nation without safe tap water, all bottled water really falls into that category: luxury, indulgence, convenience.
- 12 That's okay, of course, lots of things I like are indulgences. . . .
- 13 There is a fresh burst of controversy about bottled water on college campuses, specifically, around whether bottled water should be sold in the dining halls of U.S. and Canadian universities. Last week, the University of Vermont became the latest of 15 campuses in the U.S. and Canada to ban the sale of bottled water, according to figures from the Association for the Advancement of Sustainability in Higher Education (AASHE).

- 14 Dozens more campuses have active campaigns to discourage bottled water purchases—including giving out free reuseable water bottles to students, and providing elegant, easy-to-use bottle filling stations. (Try to fill a water bottle from a water fountain sometime—you’ll be lucky to get halfway full.)
- 15 Over the weekend, [National Public Radio’s] food blog had a story about college students squaring off against the bottled water industry which drew more than 100 comments. . . .
- 16 The essay doesn’t answer the question, but I will: Of course bottled water shouldn’t be banned.
- 17 Virtually all the bans are the result of well-intentioned student activism on campus.
- 18 But I don’t understand how campuses can ban sale of bottled water while continuing to sell Coke, Pepsi, Mountain Dew, Vitamin Water and Red Bull. . . .
- 19 The reasoning runs something like this: Water is available on campus—from taps, from spigots, from filtered water-filling stations. Students and staff don’t need it delivered in plastic bottles. Coke and Red Bull aren’t available the same way. (Although sodas, of course, are often delivered on tap in dining halls.)
- 20 The environmental contrail¹ from bottled water (which I wrote about in a magazine story that took me to both Fiji and Poland Spring, Maine) is astonishing. It takes a fleet equivalent to 40,000 18-wheelers just to deliver the bottled water Americans buy every week.
- 21 But how is the fleet of trucks delivering water in bottles any different than the fleets delivering caramel-colored, caffeinated water in bottles? It takes 2.5 liters of water to produce every liter of Coke products.
- 22 I can understand cities banning the purchase of bottled water with city funds for city offices—as San Francisco, Seattle, and New York have done. That’s about both money and symbolism. Those cities run tap water systems—why would their employees need bottled water paid for by taxpayers? . . .
- 23 Indeed, you can start with the fact that buying water in a bottle makes absolutely no economic sense. The water in a half-liter bottle typically costs 3,000 times what the same amount of water from a spigot costs. Buy a single bottle of Poland Spring for \$1.29 at the college store, and you can refill the bottle every day for 8 years—college plus medical school!—before the tap water costs what the original Poland Spring cost.

¹contrail: what is left behind

- 24 The very university food service systems that proudly announce bottled water bans offer products with at least as much environmental impact that also have all kinds of dietary impact. Froot Loops at breakfast? Chocolate chip cookies at dinner? Frozen yogurt on tap 16 hours a day? . . .
- 25 The bottled water debate is a great way of waking people up to the big water issues almost every community faces—scarcity, purity, reuse, sustainability. But the conversation has to move on from bottled water to the water supply itself.
- 26 Banning bottled water doesn't really teach anyone anything.

Excerpt from "Bottled Water Is Silly—But So Is Banning It" by Charles Fishman. Copyright © 2012 by National Geographic. Reprinted by permission of National Geographic via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 3: We're Now at a Million Plastic Bottles per Minute—91% of Which Are Not Recycled

by Trevor Nace

- 27 Every person reading this has used a plastic bottle. . . . Plastic, in the recent decades, has become a staple of convenience and a modern lifestyle. . . .
- 28 Several recent reports indicate the dire global situation associated with the world's plastic use. Two statistics jump out immediately. One, that globally humans buy a million plastic bottles per minute. The second, 91% of all plastic is not recycled. On top of that, it is estimated that over half a trillion plastic bottles will be sold in 2020.
- 29 This presents an overwhelming challenge in responding to an exponential increase in recyclable yet un-recycled products.
- 30 Plastic bottles are commonly made from polyethylene terephthalate (PET), which takes 400 years to naturally decompose. . . .
- 31 Most plastic, bottles included, ends up in either the ocean or in a landfill. Let's look at the potential impacts of storing vast amounts of plastic waste in both locations.

Plastic in the Ocean

- 32 It is estimated that by 2050 the ocean will contain more plastic by weight than fish. The plastic that finds its way into the oceans inevitably will pose a risk of ingestion by sea birds, fish, marine

mammals, etc. It's not uncommon to see articles of sea life found dead with significant amounts of plastic in their stomachs. . . .

- 33 Recent studies point to increasing amounts of plastic within the seafood you and I eat on a regular basis. A recent study by Ghent University in Belgium, for example, found that people who regularly eat seafood ingest up to 11,000 tiny pieces of plastic each year. Another study by Plymouth University found that one-third of all fish caught in the UK contained tiny pieces of plastic. . . .

Plastic in Landfills

- 34 Landfills are another major sink for plastic bottles globally and present a wholly different set of issues. . . . Based on current projections, it is estimated that 12 billion metric tons of plastic will find a home in landfills by 2050.
- 35 On the positive side, we are able to more directly manage landfills compared to plastic in oceans. . . .
- 36 One thing is clear, the ever-growing demand for plastic is unlikely to be abated soon. Globally, we will have to manage the increasing risk of plastics in our environment and the harmful consequences that lie therein.

Excerpt from "We're Now at a Million Plastic Bottles per Minute—91% of Which Are Not Recycled" by Trevor Nace. Copyright © 2018 by Forbes. Reprinted by permission of Forbes via Copyright Clearance Center.



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

Grade 8 B.E.S.T. Writing

Test Release: 2024

Grades 7–10 **B.E.S.T. Writing** **Argumentation Rubric**



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

The Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking (B.E.S.T.) Writing Rubric is a scoring tool that describes the characteristics of a written response for each score point within each domain. The rubric may assist educators with evaluating the strengths and weaknesses of student responses based on the text-based writing prompt/task included in the practice test (when available) as well as responses based on other text-based writing prompts/tasks educators choose in a classroom setting.

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Florida Test Release Support Document

Grades 7-10 Argumentation Rubric Responses are scored holistically by domain and earn scores by demonstrating <i>most</i> of the descriptors in a given score point.*			
Score Point	Purpose/Structure	Development	Language
4 Above grade-level accomplishment demonstrated.	- Position** is focused on the task and consistently maintained throughout. - Organizational structure strengthens the response and allows for the advancement of the argument. - Purposeful transitional strategies connect ideas within and among paragraphs, creating cohesion. - Effective introduction and conclusion enhance the essay.	- Skillful development demonstrates thorough understanding of the topic. - Effective elaboration may include original student writing combined with (but may not be limited to) paraphrasing, text evidence, examples, definitions, narrative, and/or rhetorical techniques as appropriate to enhance the argument. - Smoothly integrated, relevant evidence from multiple sources lends credibility to the argument. - Grade-level expectations for counterclaim(s) are fully addressed. - Evidence is appropriately cited.	- Integration of academic vocabulary strengthens and furthers ideas. - Skillful use of varied sentence structure contributes to fluidity of ideas. - Use of standard English grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling demonstrates consistent command of the communication of ideas. - Tone and/or voice strengthens the overall argument.
3 Within the range of grade-level performance.	- Position** is focused on the task and generally maintained throughout. - Organizational structure is logical and allows for the advancement of the argument. - Purposeful transitional strategies connect ideas within and among paragraphs. - Sufficient introduction and conclusion contribute to a sense of completeness.	- Logical development demonstrates understanding of the topic. - Adequate elaboration may include (but may not be limited to) a combination of original student writing with paraphrasing, text evidence, examples, definitions, narrative, and/or rhetorical techniques as appropriate to support the argument. - Relevant, integrated evidence from multiple sources lends credibility to the argument. - Grade-level expectations for counterclaim(s) are sufficiently addressed. - Evidence is appropriately cited.	- Integration of academic vocabulary demonstrates clear expression of ideas. - Sentence structure is varied and demonstrates grade-appropriate language facility. - Use of grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling demonstrates grade-appropriate command of standard English conventions. - Tone and/or voice is appropriate for the overall argument.
2 Approaching the range of grade-level performance.	- Position** may be unclear, loosely related, or insufficiently sustained within the task. - Organizational structure may be repetitive or inconsistent, disrupting the advancement of ideas. - Transitions attempt to connect ideas but may lack purpose and/or variety. - Introduction and conclusion may be present but repetitive, simplistic, or otherwise ineffective.	- Development may demonstrate partial or incomplete understanding of the topic. - Elaboration may attempt to develop the argument but may rely heavily on the sources, provide loosely related information, be repetitive or otherwise ineffective. - Evidence may be partially integrated and/or related to the topic but unsupportive of or disconnected from the argument. - Grade-level expectations for counterclaim(s) are insufficiently addressed. - Lacks appropriate citations.	- Vocabulary and word choice may be imprecise or basic, demonstrating partial command of expression of ideas. - Sentence structure may be partially controlled, somewhat simplistic, or lacking grade-appropriate language facility. - Inconsistent use of correct grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling; may contain multiple distracting errors, demonstrating partial command of standard English conventions. - Tone and/or voice may be inconsistent. - May be grammatically accurate but too brief to demonstrate grade-appropriate command of language skills.
1 Below grade-level performance demonstrated.	- Position** may be absent, ambiguous, or confusing, demonstrating lack of awareness of task. - Demonstrates little or no discernible organizational structure. - Transitions may be absent or confusing. - Introduction and conclusion may be unrelated to the response and/or create confusion. - Too brief to demonstrate knowledge of purpose, structure, or task.	- Response may demonstrate lack of understanding of the topic and/or lack of development. - Elaboration may consist of confusing ideas or demonstrate lack of knowledge of elaborative techniques. - Evidence from the sources may be absent, vague, and/or confusing. - Counterclaim(s) are absent or confusing. - Lacks appropriate citations. - Too brief to demonstrate knowledge of elaboration, topic, or sources.	- Vocabulary and word choice may be vague, unclear, or confusing. - Sentence structure may be simplistic or confusing. - Use of grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling may contain a density and variety of severe errors, demonstrating lack of command of standard English conventions, often obscuring meaning. - Tone and/or voice may be inappropriate. - Brevity with errors demonstrates lack of command of language skills.

*Citation is not a holistic consideration. Without citation, the highest score possible in Development is 2.

**Claim in Grade 7 benchmarks

Writing Prompt

Write an argumentative essay about whether or not competition is an effective way to motivate children.

Your argumentative essay must be based on this prompt and topic, and it must incorporate ideas and evidence found in the sources provided.

Use your best writing to complete an essay that

- is focused on your position;
- combines evidence from multiple sources with your own elaboration to develop your ideas;
- rebuts at least one counterclaim with reasoning;
- is organized and includes transitions within and among ideas;
- provides citations for quoted material and source ideas; and
- demonstrates correct use of grammar and language appropriate to the task.

Write your multiparagraph essay to an academic audience in the space provided.

Read the “Competition” sources.

Competition

Source 1: The Competing Views on Competition

by Matt Richtel

- 1 Is it better to teach children tough life lessons, like the thrill of victory is sweeter if you have known the agony of defeat? Or is it better simply to let a child win, and allow victory to be part of the fun? Is there a strategy that promotes happiness and performance, even if you’re only playing Candyland?
- 2 “The evidence overwhelmingly suggests that competition is destructive, particularly, but not exclusively, for children,” said Alfie Kohn, an author and speaker whose views on the negative aspects of competition are widely followed in the field of parenting. “It’s a toxic way to raise children.”
- 3 He added, “The absence of competition seems to be a prerequisite for excellence in most endeavors, contrary to received wisdom.”
- 4 Mr. Kohn is, not surprisingly, a lightning rod. It’s hard to reconcile his views with the realities of modern life, from presidential races to Olympic ones, where there are only three medal winners, and some stand taller than others. It would seem to be a parent’s job to prepare children for the reality of scarce resources and rewards.
- 5 Many scholars agree that competition is necessary, ingrained and essential. Studies have shown that under certain conditions, competition can improve performance and happiness. People are better off when they are trying to win (rather than trying not to lose), and when they are confident. It also helps if the stakes are very low and the motivation is not just to win, but to achieve mastery. . . .
- 6 John Tauer is a psychology professor at the University of St. Thomas, in St. Paul, Minn., where he studies competition and coaches the men’s basketball team. “When I hear solutions that say let’s eliminate competition,” Mr. Tauer said, “that’s not realistic.”
- 7 “Not everybody gets to be a doctor,” he added, by way of example. “You don’t get away from competition unless you go to a system where everybody gets to do what they want whenever they want.”
- 8 In a series of studies over a five-year period, he looked at how children ages 9 to 14 performed shooting free throws in three situations: when one player was pitted against another (direct

competition); when two players worked together to get the highest combined score (cooperation); and when two players joined forces to try to score more than another pair (cooperation combined with competition).

9 The combination of cooperation and competition resulted in greater satisfaction and often in higher scores as well. “It’s as consistent of a finding as we’ve had,” Dr. Tauer said. “Kids prefer the combination of competition and cooperation. It’s a significant increase in enjoyment.”
...

10 Next, I sought the advice of a tennis champion, Erik van Dillen, who as a teenager in the late 1960s was the best player in the country. He went on to win the Davis Cup in 1972, as Stan Smith’s doubles partner, and beat a young John McEnroe at Wimbledon. . . .

11 The emphasis on competition, he told me, somewhat misses the point—even at the level of champions. The greatest players he has known and played against, he said, are problem solvers. When they play against other greats, they relish the challenge of solving a difficult problem. Winning or losing is simply a measure of whether or not they have solved the problem.

12 He has watched them carry those same problem-solving skills into the rest of their lives, he said, and he hasn’t noticed any diminished sense of self-esteem when they lose or any heightened sense of self when they win.

Excerpt from “The Competing Views on Competition” by Matt Richtel, from the New York Times.
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Source 2: Behind the Scenes of Teenage Writing Competitions

by Jen Karetnick

13 Every spring, some teenage hearts leap with the kind of joy that [best-selling author] Paulo Coelho describes as “sometimes a blessing, but . . . often a conquest.” Others break all over the Internet.

14 “The entire [teen writing] community seize[s] up,” says Yasmin Belkhyr, who graduated from a small private high school in New York last year. “You look down your newsfeed, message your friends constantly, ‘Did you hear back? Did you win? Did they call?’ waiting with this heavy feeling deep in your stomach, refreshing your email, or checking your phone over and over.”

- 15 On a mid-March day at noon, the New York City-based Scholastic Art & Writing Awards announces which teenage writers, in grades 7 through 12, have won national silver or gold medals in categories including poetry, short story, and personal essay/memoir. Writers are invited to collect their awards at a special ceremony at Carnegie Hall in early June, and certain submissions, such as senior portfolios, can each win as much as \$10,000 in scholarship cash. Either way, medals can translate into invitations to attend choice summer camps and colleges. The program has been operating for nearly a century and boasts alumni such as Sylvia Plath and Truman Capote.
- 16 Belkhyr, who won four Gold Medals in 2013 and another two last year, now edits *Winter Tangerine*, a literary publication that she founded in 2013 that features the work of teens alongside that of more-established writers. “If you win, then you talk to the other winners, congratulating and praising them. If you lose, then you read through your submission, noting mistakes that weren’t there five minutes before, wondering where you went wrong,” she adds. “You tell yourself, ‘It doesn’t really matter. I’ll survive.’ But a squeaky voice in the back of your head is saying, ‘So-and-so won. They’re obviously way better than you. Why are you even trying?’” . . .
- 17 Previously, just a select few, often identified by AP English teachers, would enter these competitions, as would a handful of secret bedroom scribblers. But organizers say teens have been showing much greater interest in the past several years—and the quality of competition is on the rise. That’s in part because of recruitment. YoungArts, for instance, retains personnel to travel around the country and make presentations in high schools.
- 18 The increase in literary rank and file also means that more student writers are losing than ever before. . . .
- 19 But Brent Busboom, a public-school teacher in Reno, still encourages his students to go for it—among other reasons, because winning a competition can help sell parents on their child’s chosen career. Busboom points to a student who was poised to become a doctor or lawyer like his parents when he decided to enter a writing competition. “Winning an award legitimized his talent,” he says. “Last I heard, he was doing a master’s degree in writing at Columbia. Whether he would have gone into writing regardless is an open question.” . . .
- 20 For many young writers, engaging in such a contest comes with other benefits. Many of them use it as an opportunity to connect with like-minded peers. In the process, they gather tips and inspiration, says Brandon Young, a 16-year-old writer from Melbourne, Australia, who leads an online peer writing group called Inked Voices. “The desire to tell a good story comes before winning a mere competition.”

- 21 Of course, it can be hard for teens to take loss in stride. . . .
- 22 For some young writers, that pressure can be far more insidious¹ than the pain of rejection. The competitive spirit may persuade parents to hire well-known writers to tutor, edit, or even rewrite their children’s work. It may even lead minors down the path of plagiarism. . . .
- 23 Frain [a student from Princeton University] and several other teens I spoke with singled out a former teen writer who received to recognition from both Scholastic and YoungArts, and who they say stole a poem nearly “word-for-word” from an undergraduate Yale literary magazine. Despite eventually being caught, “he’s still considered a rising star,” Frain says. Belkhyr has witnessed similar problems; she’s involved in a current dispute with a student who she says copied from her for years. “If it gets to a point where you feel like you need to steal someone’s intellectual work,” she says, “you need to seriously reconsider why you write.”

¹insidious: harmful

Excerpt from “Behind the Scenes of Teenage Writing Competitions” by Jen Karetnick, from *The Atlantic*. Copyright © 2015 by the Atlantic Monthly. Reprinted by permission of the Atlantic Monthly via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 3: Science Fairs Aren’t So Fair

by Hana Schank

- 24 Last year, one mother’s satirical science-fair poster titled “How Much Turmoil Does the Science Project Cause Families?” went viral as parents around the country vented their anger toward this most frustrating of school assignments. Science-fair angst has even made it into children’s literature, with myriad books about stressed-out kids and failed projects.
- 25 Much of the parental anger seems to stem from the fact that the bulk of science fairs ask children to produce something, in some cases competitively, that is well beyond their abilities. Last year my son, who was in third grade at the time, came home with a sheet of paper from his school that listed three categories for appropriate projects: developing a hypothesis and conducting an experiment to test that theory, inventing something new, or researching “something specific.” The guidelines listed “whales” as an example of something specific. Given that my son was 8 years old, the idea that he could, on his own, do any single one of these things seemed ludicrous.
- 26 Even the easiest of these items—researching a topic—is nearly

impossible for a child who hasn't yet mastered the ability to browse the Internet. . . .

- 27 These events often turn out to be a competition among parents—not children. And many children don't have the luxury of parents who have the time to engage with their schoolwork. This dynamic became obvious to me the night before last year's fair, when I spent over an hour building a model of DNA out of licorice and gummy bears. . . .
- 28 Shree Bose, who won Google's first science fair in 2011 and is now a junior at Harvard, told me that she started noticing signs of parental over-involvement when she was in elementary school: children with beautifully presented boards and sophisticated, completed projects that were clearly the work of adults. And at the higher-level competitions, she again vied against students whose projects, she said, clearly benefitted from the help of parents.
- 29 "I had a state science fair once where my project was pretty simple but I had done it myself," she said. "The kid next to me had the exact same project except with [what looked like] five more years of work. And I thought: I'm definitely going to lose. And then his dad came by. He was a professor and the son had worked in his lab."
- 30 In addition to favoring kids whose parents can either spend time or money (or both) on a project, many science fairs seem to include little in the way of actual science. A scientific experiment, by definition, includes an exploration of the unknown. But at the three fairs I've attended over the last several years, the unknown rarely makes an appearance. At my son's fair last year, at least a handful of students did the popular "experiment" in which the "scientist" waters plants with three different liquids—one of which is typically soda or detergent—to determine which is best for plant growth.
- 31 "Were you surprised that water made the plant grow?" I asked one child after she presented her experiment.
- 32 "No," she said.

Excerpt from "Science Fairs Aren't So Fair" by Hana Schank, from *The Atlantic*. Copyright © 2015 by the Atlantic Monthly. Reprinted by permission of the Atlantic Monthly via Copyright Clearance Center.



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

Grade 9 B.E.S.T. Writing

Test Release: 2024

Grades 7–10 **B.E.S.T. Writing** **Expository Rubric**



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

The Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking (B.E.S.T.) Writing Rubric is a scoring tool that describes the characteristics of a written response for each score point within each domain. The rubric may assist educators with evaluating the strengths and weaknesses of student responses based on the text-based writing prompt/task included in the practice test (when available) as well as responses based on other text-based writing prompts/tasks educators choose in a classroom setting.

The B.E.S.T. Writing tests for all grade levels (4–10) will be administered as computer-based assessments. Paper-based assessments will be available for students with an IEP or 504 plan that specifies the need for a paper-based accommodation.

The B.E.S.T. Writing Assessment were administered for the first time during the spring 2023 administration as a field test given to a representative sample of Florida students. Beginning with the 2023–24 school year, B.E.S.T. Writing has been administered once per year during the spring; however, it is not associated with any of the three progress monitoring events.

Florida Test Release Support Document

Grades 7-10 Expository Rubric Responses are scored holistically by domain and earn scores by demonstrating <i>most</i> of the descriptors defined in a given score point.*			
Score Point	Purpose/Structure	Development	Language
4 Above grade-level accomplishment demonstrated.	- Central idea is focused on the task and consistently maintained throughout. - Organizational structure strengthens the response and allows for the advancement of the central idea. - Purposeful transitional strategies connect ideas within and among paragraphs and create cohesion. - Effective introduction and conclusion enhance the essay.	- Skillful development demonstrates thorough understanding of the topic. - Effective elaboration may include original student writing combined with (but may not be limited to) paraphrasing, text evidence, examples, definitions, narrative, and/or rhetorical techniques as appropriate to support the central idea. - Smoothly integrated, relevant evidence from multiple sources lends credibility to the essay. - Evidence is appropriately cited.	- Integration of academic vocabulary strengthens and furthers ideas. - Skillful use of varied sentence structure contributes to fluidity of ideas. - Use of standard English grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling demonstrates consistent command of the communication of ideas. - Tone and/or voice strengthens the overall response.
3 Within the range of grade-level performance.	- Central idea is focused on the task and generally maintained throughout. - Organizational structure is logical and allows for advancement of the central idea. - Purposeful transitional strategies connect ideas within and among paragraphs. - Sufficient introduction and conclusion contribute to a sense of completeness.	- Logical development demonstrates understanding of the topic. - Adequate elaboration may include (but may not be limited to) a combination of original student writing with paraphrasing, text evidence, examples, definitions, narrative, and/or rhetorical techniques as appropriate to support the central idea. - Relevant, integrated evidence from multiple sources lends credibility to the exposition. - Evidence is appropriately cited.	- Integration of academic vocabulary demonstrates clear expression of ideas. - Sentence structure is varied and demonstrates grade-appropriate language facility. - Use of grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling demonstrates grade-appropriate command of standard English conventions. - Tone and/or voice is appropriate for the overall response.
2 Approaching the range of grade-level performance.	- Central idea may be unclear, loosely related or insufficiently sustained within the task. - Organizational structure may be repetitive or inconsistent, disrupting the advancement of ideas. - Transitions attempt to connect ideas but may lack purpose and/or variety. - Introduction and conclusion may be present but repetitive, simplistic, or otherwise ineffective.	- Development may demonstrate partial or incomplete understanding of the topic. - Elaboration may attempt to develop the central idea but may rely heavily on the sources, provide loosely related information, be repetitive or otherwise ineffective. - Evidence may be partially integrated and/or related to the topic but disconnected from the exposition. - Lacks appropriate citations.	- Vocabulary and word choice may be imprecise or basic, demonstrating partial command of expression of ideas. - Sentence structure may be partially controlled, somewhat simplistic, or lacking grade-appropriate language facility. - Inconsistent use of correct grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling may contain multiple distracting errors, demonstrating partial command of standard English conventions. - Tone and/or voice may be inconsistent. - May be grammatically accurate but too brief to demonstrate grade-appropriate command of language skills.
1 Below grade-level performance demonstrated.	- Central idea may be absent, ambiguous, or confusing, demonstrating lack of awareness of task. - Demonstrates little or no discernible organizational structure. - Transitions may be absent or confusing. - Introduction and conclusion may be unrelated to the response and/or create confusion. - Too brief to demonstrate knowledge of purpose, structure, or task.	- Response may demonstrate lack of understanding of the topic and/or lack of development. - Elaboration may consist of confusing ideas or demonstrate lack of knowledge of elaborative techniques. - Evidence from sources may be absent, vague, and/or confusing. - Lacks appropriate citations. - Too brief to demonstrate knowledge of elaboration, topic, or sources.	- Vocabulary and word choice may be vague, unclear, or confusing. - Sentence structure may be simplistic or confusing. - Use of grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling may contain a density and variety of severe errors, demonstrating lack of command of standard English conventions, often obscuring meaning. - Tone and/or voice may be inappropriate. - Brevity with errors demonstrates lack of command of language skills.

*Citation is not a holistic consideration. Without citation, the highest score possible in *Development* is a 2

Writing Prompt

Write an expository essay about considerations that should be made when using or developing uses for artificial intelligence (AI).

Your expository essay must be based on this prompt and topic, and it must incorporate ideas and information found in the sources provided.

Use your best writing to complete an essay that

- is focused on your central idea;
- combines evidence from multiple sources with your own elaboration to develop your ideas;
- is organized and includes transitions within and among ideas;
- provides citations for quoted material and source ideas; and
- demonstrates correct use of grammar and language appropriate to the task.

Write your multiparagraph essay to an academic audience in the space provided.

Read the “Artificial Intelligence” sources.

Artificial Intelligence

Source 1: Teaching A.I. Systems to Behave Themselves

by Cade Metz

- 1 At OpenAI, the artificial intelligence lab founded by Tesla’s chief executive, Elon Musk, machines are teaching themselves to behave like humans. But sometimes, this goes wrong.
- 2 Sitting inside OpenAI’s San Francisco offices on a recent afternoon, the researcher Dario Amodei showed off an autonomous system that taught itself to play Coast Runners, an old boat-racing video game. The winner is the boat with the most points that also crosses the finish line.
- 3 The result was surprising: The boat was far too interested in the little green widgets that popped up on the screen. Catching these widgets meant scoring points. Rather than trying to finish the race, the boat went point-crazy. It drove in endless circles colliding with other vessels, skidding into stone walls and repeatedly catching fire.
- 4 Mr. Amodei’s burning boat demonstrated the risks of the A.I. techniques that are rapidly remaking the tech world. . . . But as these machines train themselves through hours of data analysis, they may also find their way to unexpected, unwanted and perhaps even harmful behavior.
- 5 That’s a concern as these techniques move into online services, security devices and robotics. Now, a small community of A.I. researchers, including Mr. Amodei, is beginning to explore mathematical techniques that aim to keep the worst from happening.
- 6 At OpenAI, Mr. Amodei and his colleague Paul Christiano are developing algorithms that can not only learn tasks through hours of trial and error, but also receive regular guidance from human teachers along the way.
- 7 With a few clicks here and there, the researchers now have a way of showing the autonomous system that it needs to win points in Coast Runners while also moving toward the finish line. They believe that these kinds of algorithms—a blend of human and machine instruction—can help keep automated systems safe. . . .
- 8 In some ways, what these scientists are doing is a bit like a parent teaching a child right from wrong.

- 9 Many specialists in the A.I. field believe a technique called reinforcement learning—a way for machines to learn specific tasks through extreme trial and error—could be a primary path to artificial intelligence. Researchers specify a particular reward the machine should strive for, and as it navigates a task at random, the machine keeps close track of what brings the reward and what doesn't. When OpenAI trained its bot to play Coast Runners, the reward was more points. . . .
- 10 In some cases, researchers are working to ensure that systems don't make mistakes on their own, as the Coast Runners boat did. They're also working to ensure that hackers and other bad actors can't exploit hidden holes in these systems. Researchers like Google's Ian Goodfellow, for example, are exploring ways that hackers could fool A.I. systems into seeing things that aren't there.
- 11 Modern computer vision is based on what are called deep neural networks, which are pattern-recognition systems that can learn tasks by analyzing vast amounts of data. By analyzing thousands of dog photos, a neural network can learn to recognize a dog. This is how Facebook identifies faces in snapshots, and it's how Google instantly searches for images inside its Photos app.
- 12 But Mr. Goodfellow and others have shown that hackers can alter images so that a neural network will believe they include things that aren't really there. Just by changing a few pixels in the photo of [an] elephant, for example, they could fool the neural network into thinking it depicts a car.
- 13 That becomes problematic when neural networks are used in security cameras. Simply by making a few marks on your face, the researchers said, you could fool a camera into believing you're someone else.
- 14 "If you train an object-recognition system on a million images labeled by humans, you can still create new images where a human and the machine disagree 100 percent of the time," Mr. Goodfellow said. "We need to understand that phenomenon."

Excerpt from "Teaching A.I. Systems to Behave Themselves" by Cade Metz. Copyright © 2017 by the New York Times. Reprinted by permission of the New York Times via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 2: AI, radiology and the future of work

by the *Economist* Staff

- 15 Analysing medical images is a natural fit for “deep learning,” an artificial-intelligence (AI) technique which first attracted attention for its ability to teach computers to recognise objects in pictures. A variety of companies hope that bringing AI into the clinic will make diagnosis faster and cheaper. The machines may even be able to see nuances that humans cannot, assessing how risky a patient’s cancer is simply by looking at a scan. . . .
- 16 In fact the application of AI to medicine suggests that the story is more complicated. Machine learning will indeed change many fields, allowing the rapid analysis of enormous piles of data to uncover insights that people might overlook. But it is not about to make humans redundant. And radiology, the very field that is used as a cautionary tale about the robocalypse, shows why.
- 17 One is the nature of AI itself. The field is suffused with hype. Some papers show artificial radiologists outperforming the ones in white coats. Others, though, still put the humans ahead. The machines may eventually take an unambiguous lead. But it is important to remember that AI, for the foreseeable future, will remain “narrow,” not general. No human is as good at mental arithmetic as a \$10 pocket calculator, but that is all the calculator can do. Deep learning is broader. . . . Instead of wondering whether AI can replace a job, it is better to ponder whether it could replace humans at a specific task.

The human touch

- 18 That leads to a second reason for optimism: the nature of work. Most jobs involve many tasks, even if that is not always obvious to outsiders. Spreadsheets have yet to send the accountants to the dole queue,¹ because there is more to accountancy than making columns of figures add up. Radiologists analyse a lot of images. But they also decide which images should be taken, confer on tricky diagnoses, discuss treatment plans with their patients, translate the conclusions of the research literature into the messy business of real-life practice, and so on. Handing one of those tasks to a computerised helper leaves radiologists not with a redundancy cheque, but with more time to focus on other parts of their jobs—often the rewarding ones.
- 19 A third reason for optimism is that automation should also encourage demand. Even in the rich world, radiology is expensive. If machines can make it more efficient, then the price should come

¹dole queue: number of unemployed and claiming government benefits

down, allowing its benefits to be spread more widely and opening up entire new applications for medical imaging.

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Source 3: IKEA¹ furniture and the limits of AI

by the *Economist* Staff

- 20 Computers have already proved better than people at playing chess and diagnosing diseases. But now a group of artificial intelligence researchers in Singapore have managed to teach industrial robots to assemble an IKEA chair—for the first time uniting the worlds of Allen keys² and Alan Turing.³ Now that machines have mastered one of the most baffling ways of spending a Saturday afternoon, can it be long before AIs rise up and [overtake] human beings? . . .
- 21 The research also holds a serious message. It highlights a deep truth about the limitations of automation. Machines excel at the sorts of abstract, cognitive tasks that, to people, signify intelligence—complex board games, say, or differential calculus. But they struggle with physical jobs, such as navigating a cluttered room, which are so simple that they hardly seem to count as intelligence at all. The IKEAbots are a case in point. It took a pair of them, pre-programmed by humans, more than 20 minutes to assemble a chair that a person could knock together in a fraction of the time.
- 22 AI researchers call that observation Moravec’s paradox, and have known about it for decades. It does not seem to be the sort of problem that could be cured with a bit more research. Instead, it seems to be a fundamental truth: physical dexterity is computationally harder than playing Go⁴. . . .
- 23 That is something to bear in mind when thinking about the much-hyped effects of AI and automation, especially as AI moves out of the abstract world of data and information and into the real world of things you can drop on your foot. . . . Lots of jobs have physical aspects that robots struggle with. Machines may soon be able to

¹IKEA: a company famous for making assemble-at-home furniture with multistep instructions

²Allen keys: simple hand tools used to turn bolts and screws

³Alan Turing: computer scientist influential to the development of theoretical computer science

⁴Go: board game requiring intense strategy and concentration

drive delivery vans, for instance. But, at least for now, they could well fail to carry a parcel to a flat⁵ at the top of a flight of slippery stairs, especially if the garden was patrolled by a dangerous dog.

⁵flat: apartment

Excerpt from “IKEA furniture and the limits of AI” from the Economist . Copyright © 2018 by the Economist Newspaper Limited, London (April 21, 2018). Reprinted by permission of the Economist via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 4: A.I. as Talent Scout: Unorthodox Hires

by Noam Scheiber

24 One day this fall, Ashutosh Garg, the chief executive of a recruiting service called Eightfold.ai, turned up a résumé that piqued his interest.

25 It belonged to a prospective data scientist, someone who unearths patterns in data to help businesses make decisions, like how to target ads. But curiously, the résumé featured the term “data science” nowhere.

26 Instead, the résumé belonged to an analyst at Barclays¹ who had done graduate work in physics at the University of California, Los Angeles. Though his profile on the social network LinkedIn indicated that he had never worked as a data scientist, Eightfold’s software flagged him as a good fit. He was similar in certain key ways, like his math and computer chops, to four actual data scientists whom Mr. Garg had instructed the software to consider as a model.

27 The idea is not to focus on job titles, but “what skills they have,” Mr. Garg said. “You’re really looking for people who have not done it, but can do it.” . . .

28 For years, employers and online intermediaries have used algorithms to help fill job openings, but their methods were often crude. A computer would identify key words on résumés, then determine whether those words corresponded to text in job descriptions.

29 While this approach can be more efficient than manually searching a site like LinkedIn, it has drawbacks. Applicants can game the process by larding their résumés with terms the machines are

¹Barclays: a British bank and financial services company

likely to be looking for. Conversely, poorly worded job listings could cause computers to overlook qualified candidates.

30 But recent advances in a form of artificial intelligence known as deep learning have made the machines used by some companies, like Eightfold and the online job hub ZipRecruiter, far more powerful. Instead of simply scanning words on a page and matching them to words in a job description, a machine can now identify skills and aptitudes that don't explicitly appear on a candidate's résumé.

31 To illustrate, Mr. Garg points out that about 90 percent of software engineers at the financial software company Intuit in Mountain View, Calif., know the programming language Java, according to data Eightfold has analyzed. That means the machine is on safe ground inferring that an Intuit software engineer knows Java, even if he or she doesn't list the skill on a résumé. . . .

32 The software tool can be especially powerful to an employer intent on expanding a search beyond candidates with conventional experience and qualifications. In that case, a recruiter can specify criteria (like industry and location, and even how likely the candidate is to accept an offer) that would turn up less traditional résumés.

33 Claudia Villanueva, a recruiting and diversity official at AdRoll Group, which helps clients with digital ads and marketing, said she recently used Eightfold when trying to fill a financial-planning position. The top candidate had experience in industries the tech world often shuns, like manufacturing. But the Eightfold algorithm flagged her as a winner.

34 "The tech industry sometimes has a hard time moving past tech experience," Ms. Villanueva said. "We keep hiring the same people in the industry. To me this is a really interesting example of how we broke that cycle a bit."

Excerpt from "A.I. as Talent Scout: Unorthodox Hires, and Maybe Lower Pay" by Noam Scheiber.
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THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

Grade 10 B.E.S.T. Writing

Test Release: 2024

Grades 7–10 B.E.S.T. Writing Argumentation Rubric



THE B.E.S.T. STANDARDS

Benchmarks for Excellent Student Thinking

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Florida Test Release Support Document

Grades 7-10 Argumentation Rubric Responses are scored holistically by domain and earn scores by demonstrating <i>most</i> of the descriptors in a given score point.*			
Score Point	Purpose/Structure	Development	Language
4 Above grade-level accomplishment demonstrated.	- Position** is focused on the task and consistently maintained throughout. - Organizational structure strengthens the response and allows for the advancement of the argument. - Purposeful transitional strategies connect ideas within and among paragraphs, creating cohesion. - Effective introduction and conclusion enhance the essay.	- Skillful development demonstrates thorough understanding of the topic. - Effective elaboration may include original student writing combined with (but may not be limited to) paraphrasing, text evidence, examples, definitions, narrative, and/or rhetorical techniques as appropriate to enhance the argument. - Smoothly integrated, relevant evidence from multiple sources lends credibility to the argument. - Grade-level expectations for counterclaim(s) are fully addressed. - Evidence is appropriately cited.	- Integration of academic vocabulary strengthens and furthers ideas. - Skillful use of varied sentence structure contributes to fluidity of ideas. - Use of standard English grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling demonstrates consistent command of the communication of ideas. - Tone and/or voice strengthens the overall argument.
3 Within the range of grade-level performance.	- Position** is focused on the task and generally maintained throughout. - Organizational structure is logical and allows for the advancement of the argument. - Purposeful transitional strategies connect ideas within and among paragraphs. - Sufficient introduction and conclusion contribute to a sense of completeness.	- Logical development demonstrates understanding of the topic. - Adequate elaboration may include (but may not be limited to) a combination of original student writing with paraphrasing, text evidence, examples, definitions, narrative, and/or rhetorical techniques as appropriate to support the argument. - Relevant, integrated evidence from multiple sources lends credibility to the argument. - Grade-level expectations for counterclaim(s) are sufficiently addressed. - Evidence is appropriately cited.	- Integration of academic vocabulary demonstrates clear expression of ideas. - Sentence structure is varied and demonstrates grade-appropriate language facility. - Use of grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling demonstrates grade-appropriate command of standard English conventions. - Tone and/or voice is appropriate for the overall argument.
2 Approaching the range of grade-level performance.	- Position** may be unclear, loosely related, or insufficiently sustained within the task. - Organizational structure may be repetitive or inconsistent, disrupting the advancement of ideas. - Transitions attempt to connect ideas but may lack purpose and/or variety. - Introduction and conclusion may be present but repetitive, simplistic, or otherwise ineffective.	- Development may demonstrate partial or incomplete understanding of the topic. - Elaboration may attempt to develop the argument but may rely heavily on the sources, provide loosely related information, be repetitive or otherwise ineffective. - Evidence may be partially integrated and/or related to the topic but unsupportive of or disconnected from the argument. - Grade-level expectations for counterclaim(s) are insufficiently addressed. - Lacks appropriate citations.	- Vocabulary and word choice may be imprecise or basic, demonstrating partial command of expression of ideas. - Sentence structure may be partially controlled, somewhat simplistic, or lacking grade-appropriate language facility. - Inconsistent use of correct grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling; may contain multiple distracting errors, demonstrating partial command of standard English conventions. - Tone and/or voice may be inconsistent. - May be grammatically accurate but too brief to demonstrate grade-appropriate command of language skills.
1 Below grade-level performance demonstrated.	- Position** may be absent, ambiguous, or confusing, demonstrating lack of awareness of task. - Demonstrates little or no discernible organizational structure. - Transitions may be absent or confusing. - Introduction and conclusion may be unrelated to the response and/or create confusion. - Too brief to demonstrate knowledge of purpose, structure, or task.	- Response may demonstrate lack of understanding of the topic and/or lack of development. - Elaboration may consist of confusing ideas or demonstrate lack of knowledge of elaborative techniques. - Evidence from the sources may be absent, vague, and/or confusing. - Counterclaim(s) are absent or confusing. - Lacks appropriate citations. - Too brief to demonstrate knowledge of elaboration, topic, or sources.	- Vocabulary and word choice may be vague, unclear, or confusing. - Sentence structure may be simplistic or confusing. - Use of grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and/or spelling may contain a density and variety of severe errors, demonstrating lack of command of standard English conventions, often obscuring meaning. - Tone and/or voice may be inappropriate. - Brevity with errors demonstrates lack of command of language skills.

*Citation is not a holistic consideration. Without citation, the highest score possible in Development is 2.

**Claim in Grade 7 benchmarks

Writing Prompt

Write an argumentative essay about whether the benefits of self-driving cars outweigh the drawbacks.

Your argumentative essay must be based on this prompt and topic, and it must incorporate ideas and evidence found in the sources provided.

Use your best writing to complete an essay that

- is focused on your position;
- combines evidence from multiple sources with your own elaboration to develop your ideas;
- rebuts counterclaims with evidence;
- is organized and includes transitions within and among ideas;
- provides citations for quoted material and source ideas; and
- demonstrates correct use of grammar and language appropriate to the task.

Write your multiparagraph essay to an academic audience in the space provided.

Read the “Driverless Cars” sources.

Driverless Cars

Source 1: Getting road-trip ready, and no driver needed

by Maria Temming

- 1 A new kind of navigation system could help self-driving cars hit the road and get out of town.
- 2 Cars that do not need a human driver are called autonomous. Controlled by computers, they navigate using detailed 3-D maps. Some companies are testing such cars in big cities. They use maps marking every curbside and off-ramp with almost centimeter-level precision. But few places have been mapped in such detail. The places that have not include smaller cities, towns and millions of miles of open road. That has left most areas off-limits to driverless cars. But not for long, if some researchers have their way.
- 3 Researchers at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) in Cambridge asked: What if self-driving vehicles could get around another way? Intrigued by the challenge, they developed a new navigation system to guide autonomous vehicles without such detailed maps. This tech could help driverless cars drive almost anywhere. . . .
- 4 The new system charts a course down unfamiliar roads much as a human driver would. It continually scans its surroundings to gauge how close it is to the edges of the road. Instead of human eyes, it uses a laser sensor. At the same time, the car follows GPS directions to its destination from a tool like a mapping app. Along the way, it notes traffic rules. These may include speed limits and where stoplights exist.
- 5 The MIT team test-drove a car equipped with this system on a one-lane road. The road wound through a forest in Devens, Mass. This remote location lacks those detailed maps, so other driverless cars would be lost here. The vehicle slowly cruised along a 1 kilometer (roughly half-mile) stretch of road without needing any human assistance. The researchers plan to build a version of this system to also spot lane markings painted on streets. That would allow the car to drive on roads with more lanes, Ort says.
- 6 Right now, the new system assumes that a car has a clear path down the road, notes Teddy Ort. He’s a roboticist at MIT who worked on the new system. But the new system could be paired with other computer programs that can sense obstacles. These might use lasers

to detect in-road objects such as other vehicles or pedestrians. That should help the car navigate roads with heavier traffic.

7 The technology might be useful for future self-driving cars on cross-country road trips, says Raghvendra Cowlagi[, a] mechanical engineer at Worcester Polytechnic Institute, or WPI, in Massachusetts. Still, he warns, for weaving through city traffic even these vehicles would probably still need meticulous 3-D maps.

8 Alexander Wyglinski is an electrical and computer engineer at WPI. . . . The new system may need other kinds of sensors to work in less than ideal conditions, he suspects. Laser sensors don't work well in rain or snow, for instance. So these cars might need other technologies to navigate safely in bad weather.

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Source 2: Self-driving cars and trucks could leave many jobs in the dust

by David R. Baker and Carolyn Said

9 Millions of Americans make a living by driving trucks, delivery vans, taxis and ride-hailing cars. When technology takes the wheel, what will happen to their livelihoods? . . .

10 Even Tesla CEO Elon Musk, whose company is pushing hard to develop autonomous vehicles, has warned that the technology could cost jobs.

11 "If you have self-driving cars, then what happens to the 12 percent of the population whose job it is to drive a car or drive a truck?" Musk said at a forum in May. Self-driving vehicles, he said, are just one example of how artificial intelligence could create a "tremendous upheaval in terms of employment." . . .

12 Many ride-hailing drivers are dubious about their future but figure they will have time to devise a Plan B.

13 "Most drivers know (autonomous cars) are coming; it's just a matter of when," said Christian Perea, who drives part time for Uber and Lyft in San Francisco and writes for the Rideshare Guy blog. (Lyft is also pursuing driverless taxis through a partnership with General Motors.)

14 "But I don't think it will be a situation where robots show up one day and clean house within five minutes. It will happen slowly

enough for me and others to adapt and find other ways of earning money,” Perea said.

- 15 Most Lyft and Uber drivers work part time, studies show. Many drivers already plan to transition to other work, as spates of price cuts by Uber and Lyft have hurt their income, Perea said. . . .

Biggest potential hit

- 16 Labor leader Andy Stern sees the biggest potential hit to America’s 3.5 million truck drivers. “Commercial truck driving is going to be the leading edge of a tsunami of labor displacement,” said Stern, former president of the Service Employees International Union. “It’s not something the next generation is going to have to deal with—it’s going to happen in the next decade.”

- 17 Truck drivers, he noted, support a vast web of workers whose own jobs may be imperiled.

- 18 “We’re talking millions of jobs: the drivers themselves, but also the people in insurance, repairs, restaurants, hotels,” Stern said. “I think it’s incredibly irresponsible that no one’s making plans for this.”

- 19 Of course, not everyone agrees that self-driving technology will render truckers and cabbies obsolete. Many truckers say they cannot envision being replaced by robots.

- 20 “Can a computer drive an 80,000-pound machine at 80 miles per hour?” asked Manuel Silveira, a 22-year industry veteran who drives a big rig between Oakdale, in California’s Central Valley, and the Port of Oakland. He and several other drivers interviewed at the port last week said their top concern isn’t their work; it’s how safe the technology might be.

- 21 “Driving a truck is not a simple task,” said Gurmit Singh, an owner-operator based in Fresno. “We’re not going to sleep well (with autonomous vehicles on the road) unless they have special lanes on the highway.”

- 22 In fact, even the companies developing autonomous trucks say they will not supplant drivers.

- 23 German auto giant Daimler, the world’s leading truck manufacturer, which has been testing its own autonomous truck in Nevada, pitches its Inspiration Truck system as a way to maintain consistent speeds, stay in lanes and brake as needed.

- 24 It has no plans to create trucks that can drive without human intervention, Derek Rotz, director of advanced engineering for Daimler Trucks North America, said in an email.

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Source 3: Self-driving cars might cut costs but make traffic worse, researchers say

by Joan Lowy

- 25 Self-driving cars are expected to usher in a new era of mobility, safety and convenience. The problem, say transportation researchers, is that people will use them too much.
- 26 Experts foresee robot cars chauffeuring children to school, dance class and baseball practice. . . . Commuters will be able to work, sleep, eat or watch movies on the way to the office. People may stay home more because they can send their cars to do things like pick up groceries they’ve ordered online.
- 27 Researchers believe the number of miles driven will skyrocket. It’s less certain whether that will mean a corresponding surge in traffic congestion, but it’s a clear possibility.
- 28 Gary Silberg, an auto-industry expert at accounting firm KPMG, compares it to the introduction of smartphones. “It will be indispensable to your life,” he said. “It will be all sorts of things we can’t even think of today.” . . .
- 29 Based on focus groups in Atlanta, Denver and Chicago, KPMG predicts autonomous “mobility-on-demand” services—think Uber and Lyft without a driver—will result in double-digit increases in travel by people in two age groups: those over 65, and those 16 to 24.
- 30 Vehicles traveled a record 3.1 trillion miles in the U.S. last year. Increased trips in autonomous cars by those two age groups would boost miles traveled by an additional 2 trillion miles annually by 2050, KPMG calculated. If self-driving cars without passengers start running errands, the increase could be double that.
- 31 And if people in their middle years, when driving is at its peak, also increase their travel, that yearly total could reach 8 trillion miles. “This could be massive,” Silberg said.
- 32 Driverless cars are expected to make travel both safer and cheaper. With human error responsible for 90 percent of traffic accidents, they’re expected to sharply reduce accidents, driving down the cost of insurance and repairs.
- 33 But the biggest cost of car travel is drivers’ time, said Don MacKenzie, a University of Washington transportation researcher. That

cost comes down dramatically when people can use their travel time productively on other tasks.

34 A study by MacKenzie and other researchers published in the journal *Transportation Research: Part A* estimates that the vehicles can cut the cost of travel by as much as 80 percent. That in turn drives up miles traveled by 60 percent.

35 “You are talking about a technology that promises to make travel safer, cheaper, more convenient. And when you do that, you’d better expect people are going to do more of it,” MacKenzie said.

Excerpt from “Self-driving cars might cut costs but make traffic worse, researchers say” by Joan Lowy. Copyright © 2018 by Joan Lowy. Reprinted by permission of the Seattle Times via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 4: How self-driving car or adaptive cruise control could ease traffic jams

by Dalvin Brown

36 Driving around on summer weekends or heading out on vacation, travelers often find themselves caught in a “phantom” traffic jam that defies explanation.

37 . . . [A] National Science Foundation study reveals that having a single self-driving car on the road can reduce congestion by influencing the traffic flow of at least 20 human-controlled automobiles around it. In fact, simply using the cruise control systems that are installed in many everyday vehicles can put a dent in traffic snarls, a follow-up study in collaboration with Ford found.

38 “In some circumstances, adaptive cruise control is enough to mitigate some of the breaking traffic disturbances you would regularly see,” said Raphael Stern, a graduate research assistant at Vanderbilt University and a lead researcher on the study.

39 He said that these “phantom jams” are not actually mysterious at all. They are caused by people. As one driver hits the brakes or slows down, the vehicles behind them often make adjustments too aggressively. This sets off a chain reaction that eventually leads to congestion.

40 “Humans are not perfect at driving,” said Daniel Work, associate professor of civil and environmental engineering at Vanderbilt, who led the study. “When traffic gets dense enough, small mistakes by one driver get amplified by the drivers behind them.”

41 Self-driving features help by ensuring automobiles move at a constant speed.

- 42 “The idea is that the cars with self-driving features smooth out the flow by driving at the average speed,” Work said. “Simply put, when the cars ahead are racing toward a traffic jam, you want to drive slightly slower.”
- 43 Backed by the National Science Foundation, the researchers involved in the study began looking for opportunities to improve mobility systems in 2016.
- 44 The team rented 21 passenger vehicles including sedans, SUVs and trucks, then arranged them on a circular track along with one car that was fully self-driving enabled. A driver was behind the wheel of each.
- 45 “When all the vehicles were driven by humans, we would see these stop-and-go waves,” Stern said. “But when we activated the autonomous vehicle, the stop-and-go waves stabilized.”
- 46 Ford caught wind of it and wanted to add adaptive cruise control to the equation, partnering with the scientists to re-create the simulation using 36 random drivers, Ford vehicles and a closed test track.
- 47 The results: Vehicles using adaptive cruise control reduced the impact of a braking event smoother than those vehicles without the activated technology.
- 48 Stern said that even though the study was in a controlled environment, motorists can expect to see “tangible benefits” in everyday driving situations.
- 49 In addition to fewer traffic jams, having self-driving cars on the road can reduce the total fuel consumption of all the vehicles driving through phantom waves by 40 percent, the researchers said.
- 50 “It’s not going to get you to your destination faster, but it will get you there with less fuel consumed, lower risk of accidents due to fewer braking events and presumably lower stress,” Work said.

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